

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

with the STMicroelectronics L6790A

## **Worked design**

90 to 264 Vac, 47 to 63 Hz  
25 V / 26.3 A = 657.5 W

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## Before you start

The L6790A behaviour described here comes from a **draft** datasheet dated 30 April 2026. That draft has items marked TBD and at least one place where it contradicts itself. Check every controller constant against the released datasheet before the design goes to production.

The worked design has not been built. None of its numbers is measured: each is calculated or read from a component datasheet.

The figures were drawn for this note, except the power-stage, controller and compensator drawings of Chapter 6, which come from the ST L6790A design spreadsheet; their captions say so. Where a figure follows the argument of a published application note, the caption says so too.

## Revision history

| Version | Date           | Change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| V1.0    | August 2026    | First issue. Worked design: 25 V / 26.3 A, 657.5 W.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| V1.1    | September 2026 | Background section on LLC and power factor correction added, with circuit figures. Transformer design, the closed form for $f_{sw}(\theta)$ , the compensator design method, the gain-margin check and the input capacitor added. Worked design moved to the $N_p:N_s = 15:2$ transformer. |
| V1.2    | September 2026 | Renamed single-stage PFC LLC throughout. Verification margins defined. Worked values moved out of the design procedure and into the design example, where each one names the equation it comes from and shows the numbers put into it.                                                     |
| V1.3    | September 2026 | Design example on one transformer (ETD 49/25/16DG) with the winding and pin assignment drawn. Compensator chapter rewritten with the loop equations, the op-amp equivalent of the TL431 network and a worked loop design. Text shortened throughout. Korean edition published with it.     |

## Conventions

- Frequencies are switching frequencies unless written  $f_l$ , the line frequency.
- $f_n = f_{sw}/f_r$ , the switching frequency normalised to the series resonance; gain curves are drawn against it. Other documents may write  $f_s$  for  $f_{sw}$ .
- $M$  is the gain of the resonant network: the output referred to the primary over the fundamental of the drive.  **$M = 1$  at the series resonance** at any load.
- $Z_0 = \sqrt{L_r/C_r}$  and  $Q = Z_0/R_{ac}$ :  $Q = 0$  is no load; larger  $Q$  is more power and a flatter curve.
- $V_{o,eff} = V_{out} + N_{rect} V_r$  with  $N_{rect}$  the number of rectifier drops in the conduction path: 1 for a centre tap, 2 for a full bridge.
- $n$  is the model turns ratio in the gain equation;  $n_T$  the wound ratio with the leakage in  $L_r$ .
- $\lambda = L_r/L_m$ ; older literature uses  $m = 1 + 1/\lambda$ .
- $\theta$  is the line phase angle, zero at the mains zero crossing. “Equivalent input” is what the tank sees after topology morphing, not the mains voltage.

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# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 1 Introduction

A conventional universal-input LLC supply has two stages: a boost power-factor corrector that holds a 400 V bus, and an LLC converter that steps the bus down. The bus capacitor stores the energy a unity-power-factor input cannot deliver evenly, and it gives the LLC an almost constant input, so the tank covers only a narrow gain range.

A **single-stage PFC LLC** removes the boost stage and the bus capacitor. The rectified mains feeds the resonant tank directly. The input is then a 100/120 Hz half sine, the gain the tank must provide follows the input through the line cycle, and the output capacitor must absorb what the bus capacitor used to. Most two-stage design habits do not apply.

This note explains how the converter works and how to design one with the STMicroelectronics **L6790A**. One design runs through it: **90 to 264 Vac in, 25 V / 26.3 A = 657.5 W out**.

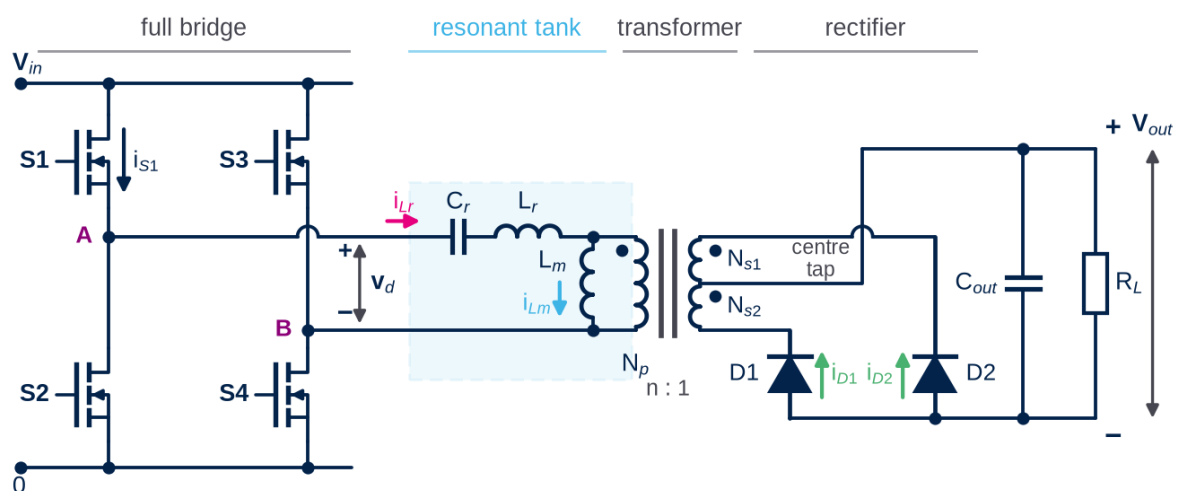
**Scope.** Power stage, resonant tank, transformer, output bank, controller network and voltage loop. Not covered: EMI filter, layout, safety approval.

## 2 The two converters this one is made of

This chapter covers an ordinary LLC and ordinary power factor correction. Readers who know both can skip to Section 3.

### 2.1 What an LLC converter is

An LLC converter is a square-wave generator driving a resonant network, which feeds a transformer and a rectifier. The switches only set the frequency. There is no duty cycle and no programmed inductor current.



**Figure 1:** An LLC stage. The switches set the frequency; the tank sets the power; the transformer sets the voltage. The bridge output  $v_d = v_A - v_B$  drives the tank. Each arrow is the positive direction of a current plotted in Figure 2.

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The three tank elements are the series inductance  $L_r$ , the magnetising inductance  $L_m$  of the transformer, and the series capacitance  $C_r$ .  $L_m$  is the transformer's own inductance and  $L_r$  is usually its leakage inductance, so only  $C_r$  is always an added part.

## 2.2 Why an LLC, and not something simpler

Compared with a forward or flyback converter, an LLC gives:

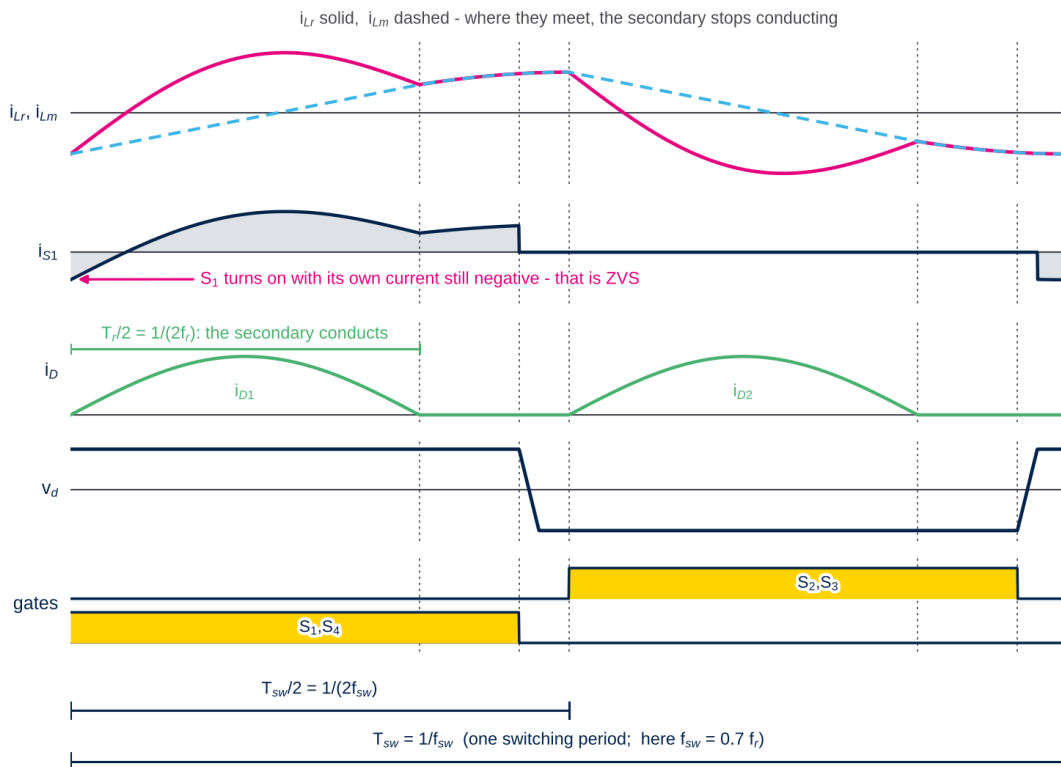
- **Soft switching at every load.** The primary switches turn on at zero voltage, and below resonance the rectifiers turn off at zero current. The magnetising current that discharges the mid-point flows at any load, so ZVS is not lost at light load.
- **Higher frequency**, because switching loss no longer limits it, so smaller magnetics and filters.
- **The leakage inductance is used as  $L_r$**  instead of needing a snubber, and there is no output inductor.

The costs: the frequency moves with line and load, the magnetising current circulates at any load so light-load efficiency is modest, and the design comes from a gain curve, not from a duty-cycle expression.

## 2.3 What resonance is for

In a hard-switched converter the energy in each switch's output capacitance is lost at every turn-on, and that loss limits the frequency.

An LLC running **in its inductive region** presents an inductive load to the bridge, so the tank current lags the drive voltage. In the dead time that lagging current discharges the mid-point by itself, and the next switch turns on at zero volts. **That is zero-voltage switching**; Section 2.10 gives the condition.



**Figure 2: One switching period below resonance. The difference between  $i_{Lr}$  and  $i_{Lm}$  crosses to the secondary. The switch turns on while its current is still negative; that current has already discharged the mid-point. The secondary conducts for the resonant half period  $T_r/2 = 1/(2f_r)$ ; the bridge changes over every  $T_{sw}/2 = 1/(2f_{sw})$ , which below resonance is the longer of the two.**

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

The condition is *inductive operation*, not a fixed frequency. Below the capacitive boundary the current leads, the bridge hard-switches into a low impedance, and parts are destroyed rather than heated. The boundary moves with load (Section 2.9).

## 2.4 How the circuit becomes $M(f_n, Q)$

The gain curve comes from three simplifications, each of which discards something.

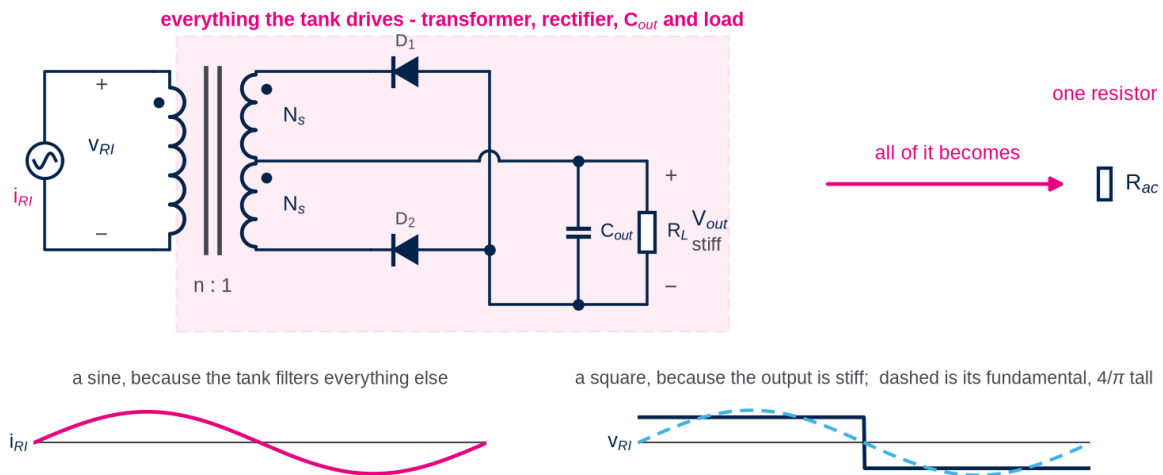


Figure 3: Why the rectifier and load can be one resistance. The output is stiff, so the tank sees a square voltage  $v_{RI}$ ; the tank passes only the fundamental, so the current  $i_{RI}$  is a sine. At the fundamental the pair takes the same power as a resistor.

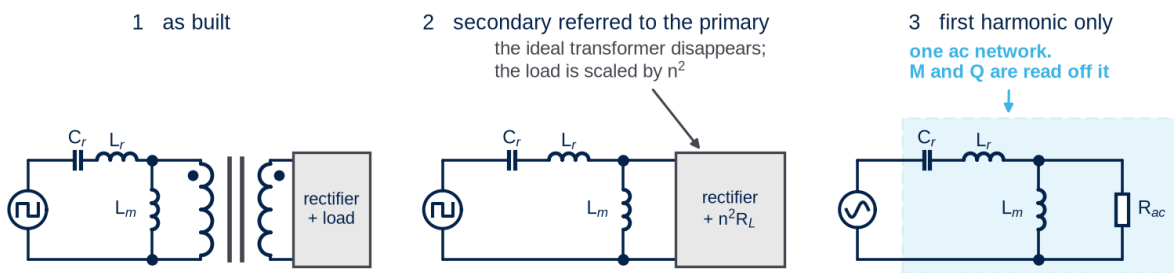


Figure 4: The reduction in three steps: as built; secondary referred to the primary; fundamental only. The result is one ac network with gain  $M$  and damping  $Q$ .

- **Refer the secondary to the primary.** The load resistance is multiplied by  $n^2$ .
- **Replace the rectifier and output filter by one resistor.** At the fundamental they look like one.
- **Keep only the fundamental of the drive.** This is the *first harmonic approximation*. It is why an LLC design ends with a simulation or a measurement, not with the equations.

Two numbers describe the remaining network:

- **The gain  $M$ :** the voltage across  $R_{ac}$  over the fundamental that drives it.  $C_r$  and  $L_r$  cancel at the series resonance  $f_r$ , so  **$M = 1$  there at any load**. Below  $f_r$  the tank can step up; above it, only down.
- **The quality factor  $Q = Z_0/R_{ac}$ ,** with  $Z_0 = \sqrt{L_r/C_r}$ .  **$Q$  rises with output power.** At  $Q = 0$  the curve is tall and peaked; load flattens it.

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With  $f_n$  normalised to the series resonance and  $\lambda$  the ratio of the two inductances:

## Equation 1

$$f_n = \frac{f_{sw}}{f_r}, \quad Z_0 = \sqrt{\frac{L_r}{C_r}}, \quad Q = \frac{Z_0}{R_{ac}}, \quad \lambda = \frac{L_r}{L_m}$$

$M(f_n, Q)$  always means the gain of this reduced circuit.

## 2.5 The two resonances

While the secondary conducts, the reflected output voltage clamps  $L_m$ , leaving the series resonance

## Equation 2

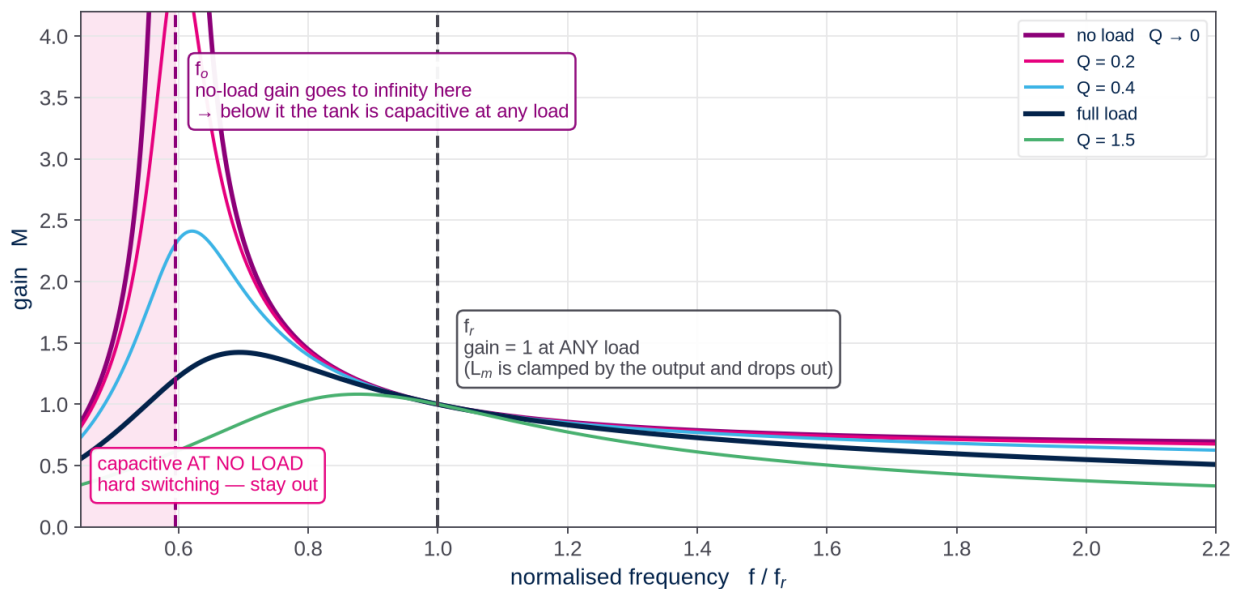
$$f_r = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{L_r C_r}}$$

When the secondary is off, both inductances resonate:

## Equation 3

$$f_o = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{(L_r + L_m) C_r}}$$

At  $f_r$  the gain is 1 for any load. At  $f_o$  the no-load gain is unlimited. The tank can boost between the two; above  $f_r$  it cannot.



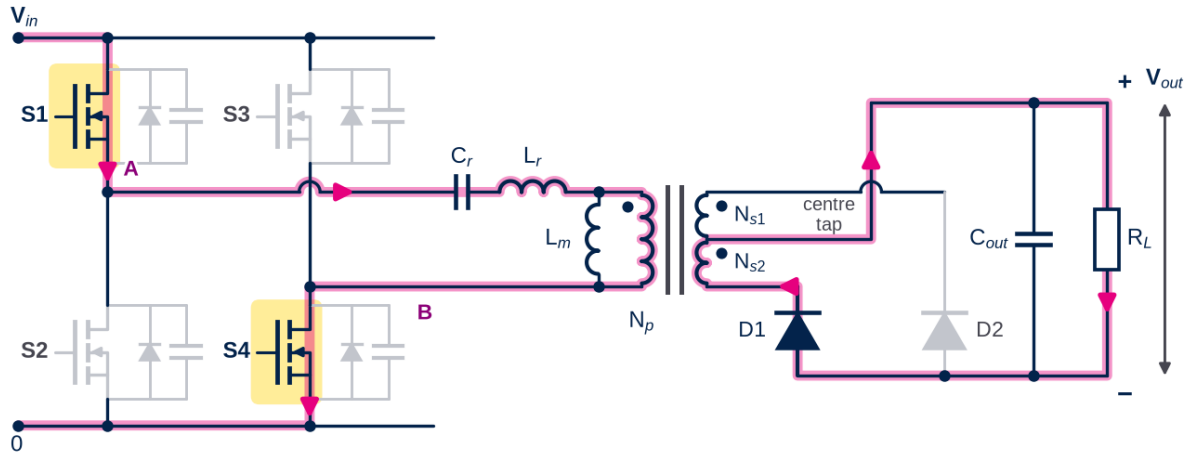
**Figure 5: The two resonances and the band between them in which the tank can boost. The shaded edge is the no-load capacitive boundary; it moves up under load.**

Below resonance each half cycle has two parts, with the same pair of switches on throughout: power delivery, then freewheeling. At resonance the half cycle is power delivery only; above resonance power delivery is cut short.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 1 POWER DELIVERY

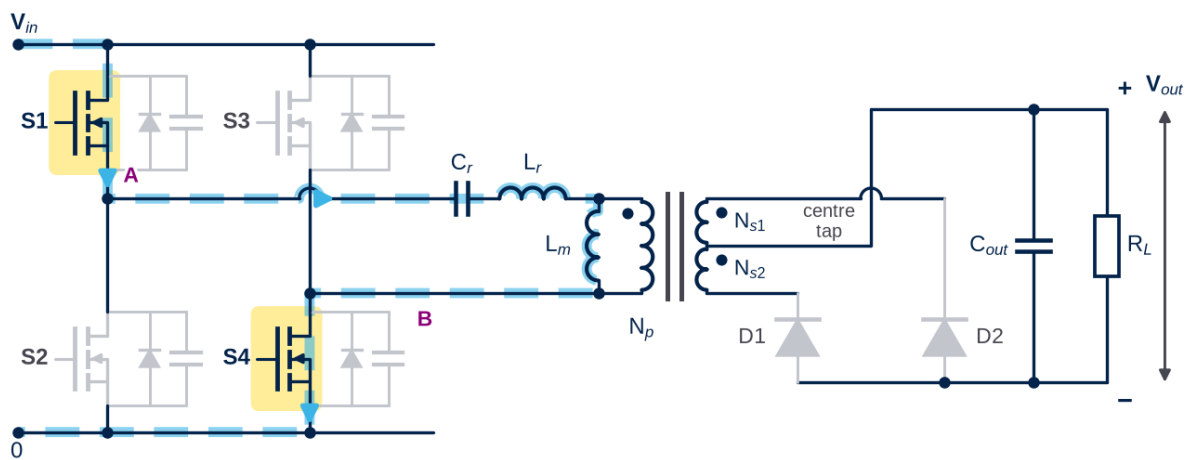
S1, S4 on · D1 conducts · lower half of  $N_s$



$L_m$  is clamped, so  $i_{Lm}$  is a straight ramp and  $i_{Lr} - i_{Lm}$  is the half sine that crosses. What is traced is the load component;  $i_{Lm}$  flows in  $L_m$  too, but it reverses inside this interval.

## 2 FREEWHEELING

S1, S4 STILL on · secondary off



$i_{Lr}$  has fallen to  $i_{Lm}$ . Every rectifier is off,  $L_m$  is free again, and the tank rings at  $f_o$ .

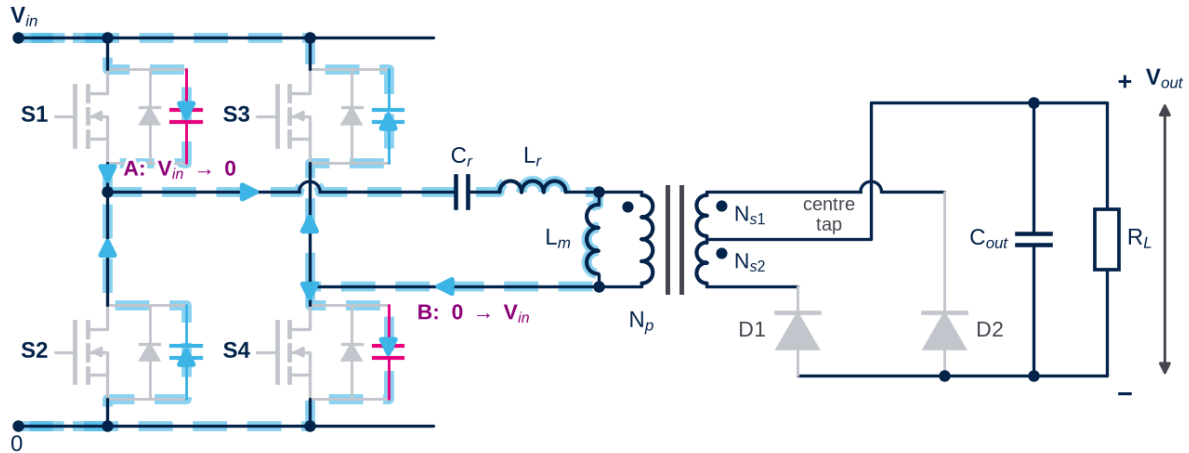
— load current      — magnetising current only        gated on  
  body diode conducting = the ZVS window         $C_{oss}$  charging,  $V_{ds}$  rising         $C_{oss}$  discharging

**Figure 6: First half, steps 1 and 2.** 1 Power delivery:  $S_1, S_4$  on, the resonant current exceeds the magnetising current and the difference reaches  $D_1$ .  $L_m$  is clamped, so this interval resonates at  $f_r$ . 2 Freewheeling: the resonant current has fallen to the magnetising current, the rectifiers are off, and  $L_m$  joins the resonance at  $f_o$ . The same switches are still on. Greyed body diodes and  $C_{oss}$  do nothing in that step.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 3 DEAD TIME (a)

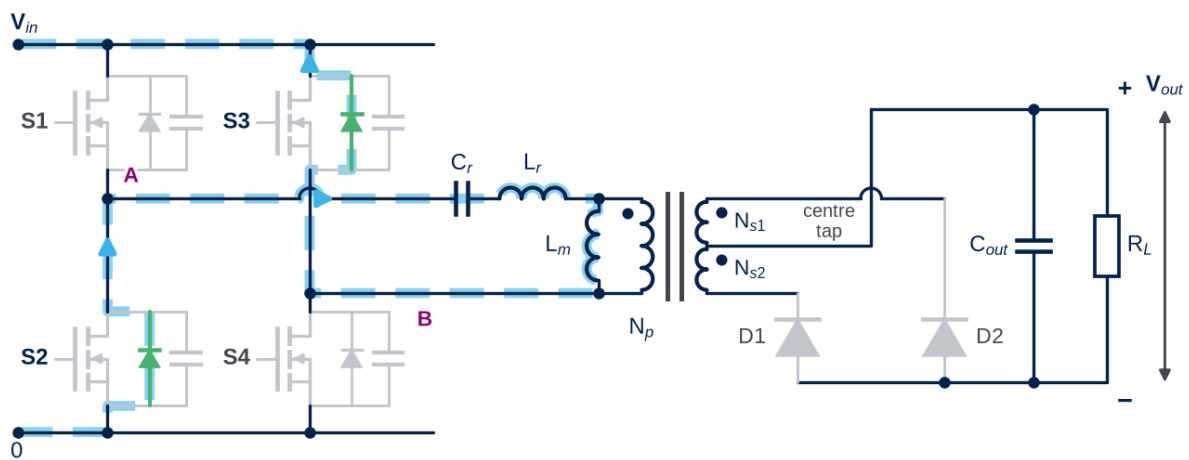
all four off ·  $C_{oss}$  swaps the midpoints over



All four channels are off, so the ONE tank current can reach the rails only THROUGH the four  $C_{oss}$ . It arrives at A from both, so A is pulled down; it leaves B into both, so B is pushed up. That swap IS the transition.

## 4 DEAD TIME (b) — ZVS

body diodes of S2 and S3 clamp



$V_{ds} = 0$  on S2 and S3 now, because their own body diodes are clamping them. Gate them on HERE.

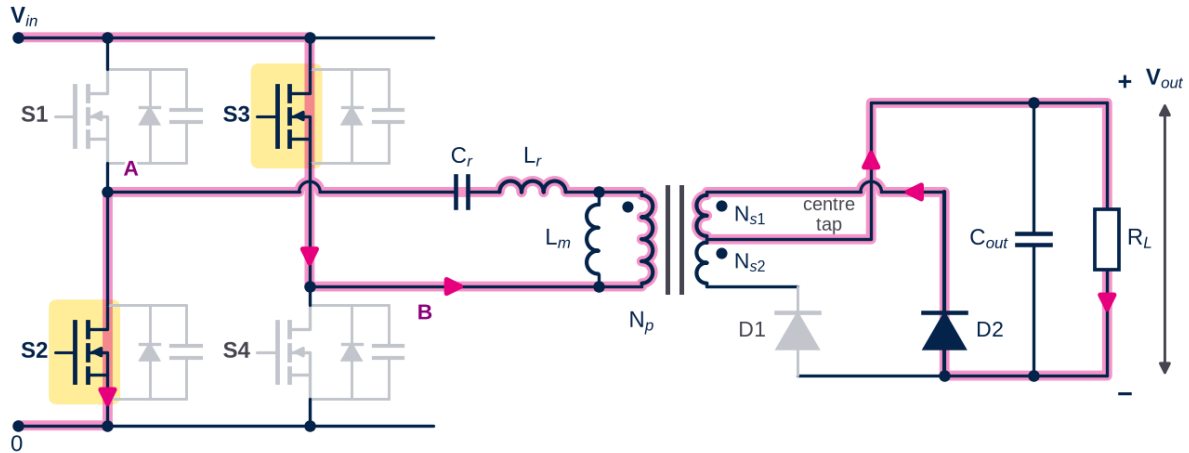
— load current    — magnetising current only     gated on  
 body diode conducting = the ZVS window      $C_{oss}$  charging,  $V_{ds}$  rising      $C_{oss}$  discharging

**Figure 7: Steps 3 and 4, the dead time. 3 All switches off; the magnetising current can only flow through the four  $C_{oss}$ , pulling A down and pushing B up. 4 The swing is complete and the body diodes of  $S_2, S_3$  clamp  $V_{ds}$  at zero. The next gate must arrive inside this window.**

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 5 POWER DELIVERY

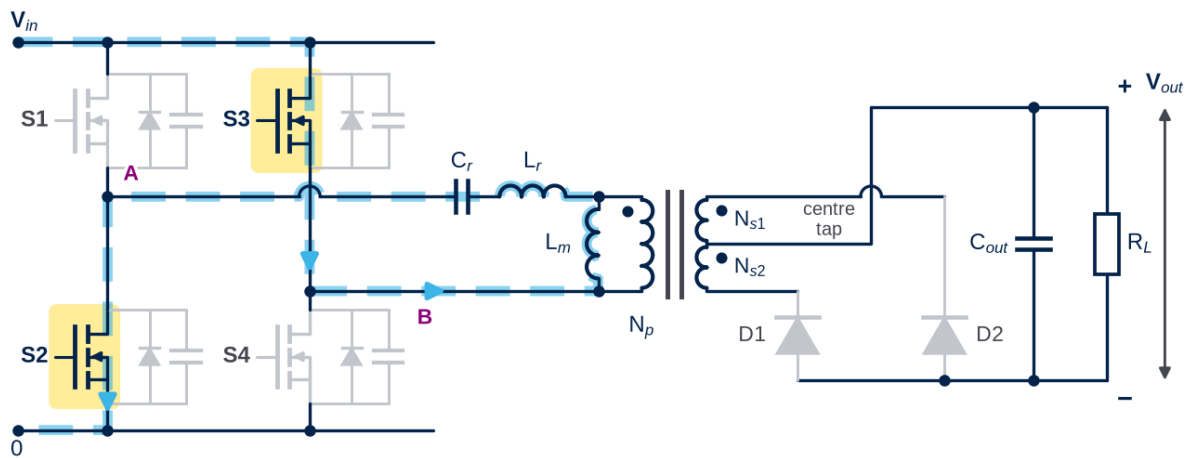
S2, S3 on · D2 conducts · upper half of  $N_s$



The mirror of 1. Just after turn-on the old current still runs back through the two channels. Again only the load component is traced -  $i_{Lm}$  reverses inside this interval as well.

## 6 FREEWHEELING

S2, S3 STILL on · secondary off



The mirror of 2, and the easy one to miss: it ends at the right-hand edge of a waveform plot.

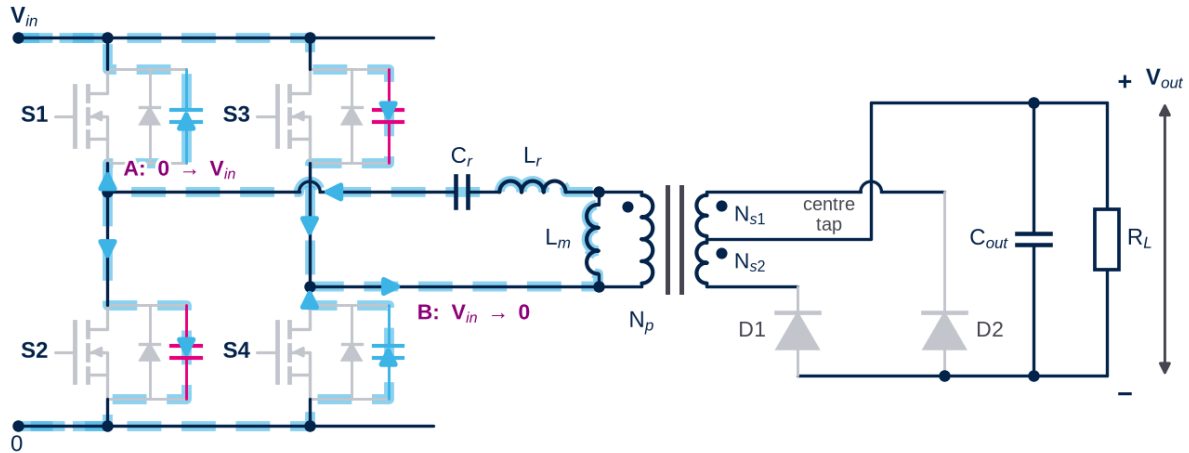
— load current      — magnetising current only       gated on  
 body diode conducting = the ZVS window        $C_{oss}$  charging,  $V_{ds}$  rising        $C_{oss}$  discharging

Figure 8: Second half, steps 5 and 6: the mirror image of 1 and 2 with  $S_2, S_3$  and  $D_2$ .

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 7 DEAD TIME (a)

all four off ·  $C_{oss}$  swaps the midpoints back

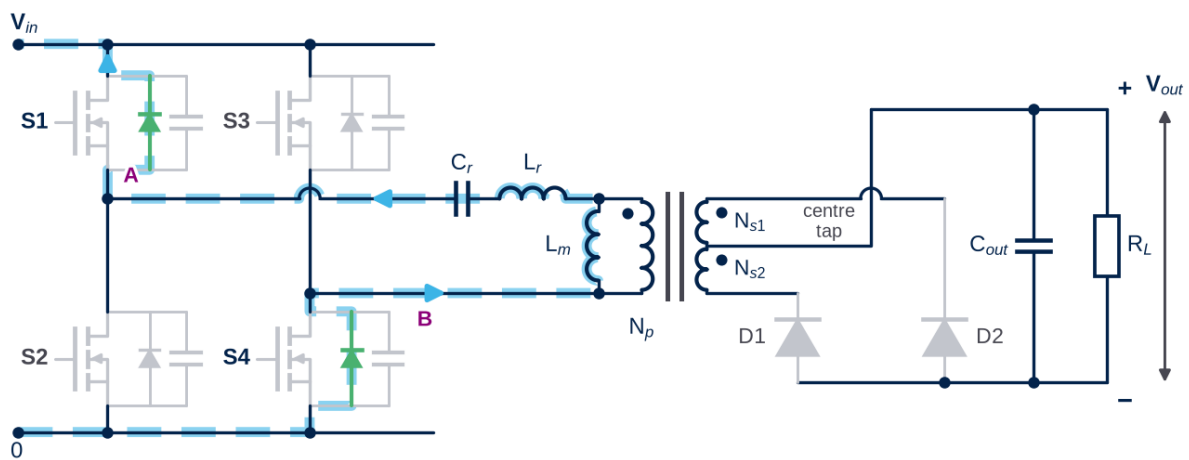


The mirror of 3: the current now arrives at B and leaves A, so B falls and A rises.

Through the capacitances again, never a channel. Magenta:  $C_{oss}$  charging,  $V_{ds}$  rising; cyan: discharging.

## 8 DEAD TIME (b) — ZVS

body diodes of S1 and S4 clamp



The same for S1 and S4, and the period closes. ZVS is in 4 and 8 - and in none of the other six.

— load current      — magnetising current only       gated on  
 body diode conducting = the ZVS window      —  $C_{oss}$  charging,  $V_{ds}$  rising      —  $C_{oss}$  discharging

Figure 9: Steps 7 and 8, the second dead time. The mid-points swing back (7), the body diodes of  $S_1, S_4$  clamp (8), and step 1 begins at zero volts. ZVS happens in steps 4 and 8 only.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

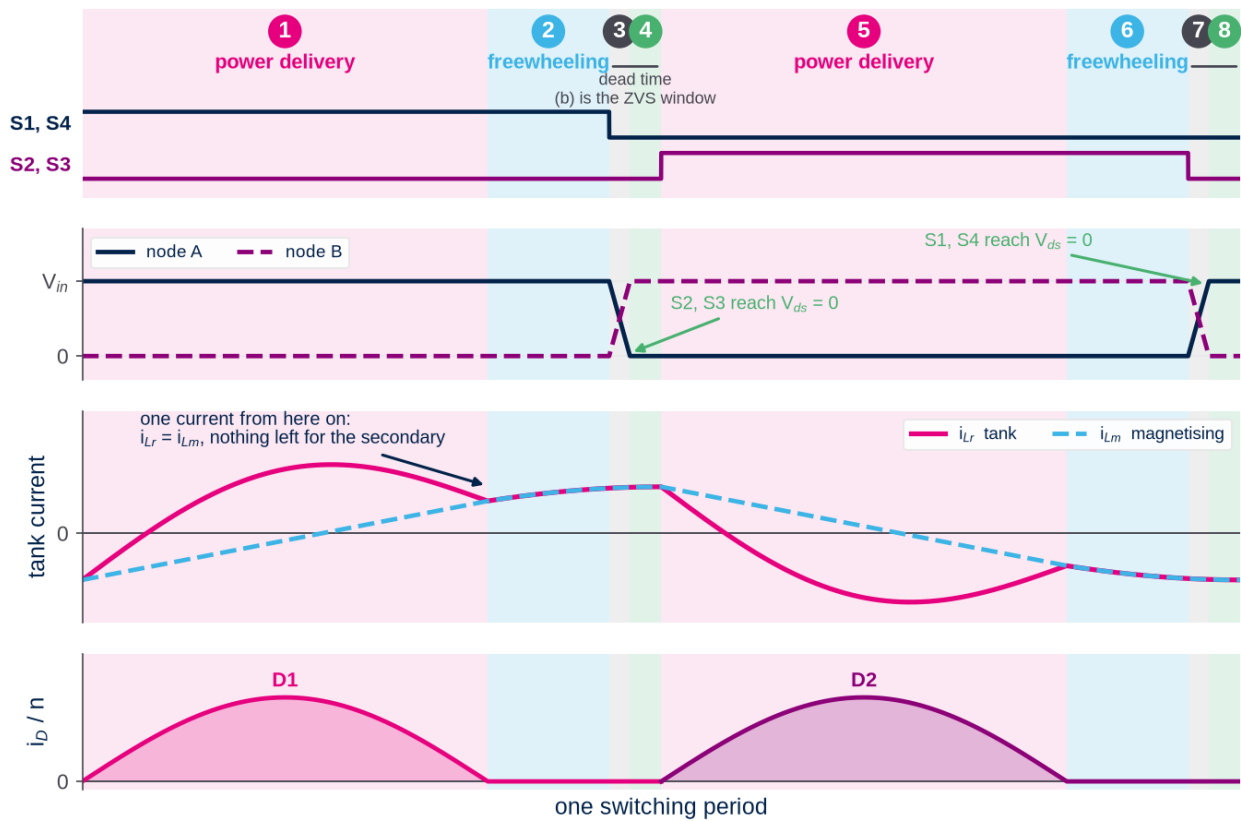
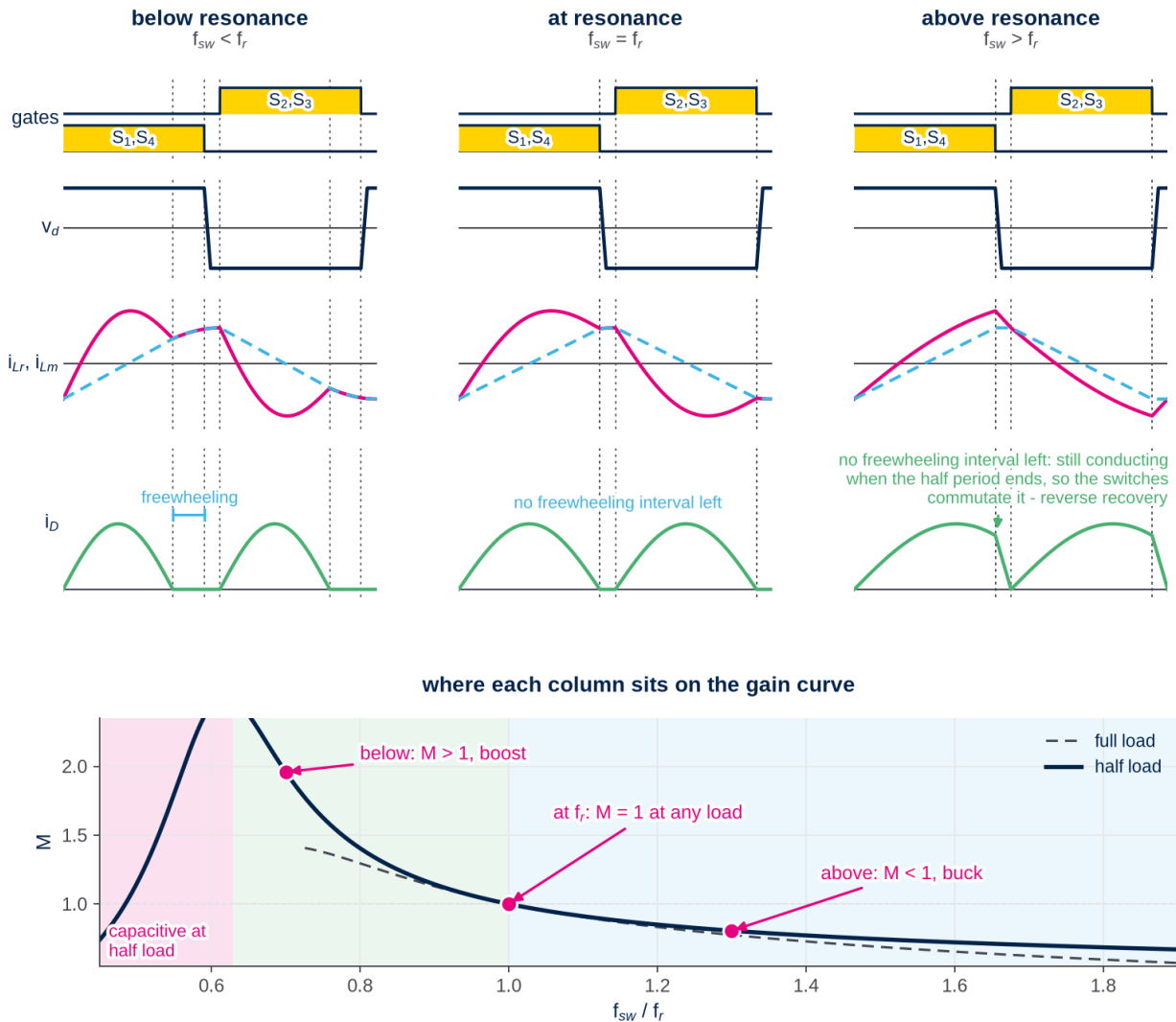


Figure 10: Where each step sits on the waveforms. The numbered bands are the eight panels above in time order. Drawn below resonance at  $f_{sw}/f_r = 0.70$  with the dead time widened so that steps 3, 4, 7 and 8 are visible; the current amplitudes are this design's  $I_{Lr,pk}$  and  $I_{Lm,pk}$  at the lowest voltage the tank sees. The rectifier current is drawn referred to the primary,  $i_D/n = i_{Lr} - i_{Lm}$ .

**“Freewheeling” means two different intervals in the literature.** Here it is steps 2 and 6: rectifiers off,  $L_m$  in the resonance, same switches on. Toshiba’s *Resonant Circuits and Soft Switching* (2019) uses it for the dead time, when the body diodes conduct. The dead time exists at every frequency; steps 2 and 6 exist only below resonance.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design



**Figure 11: Below, at and above resonance. Top: gates, bridge voltage, resonant current with the magnetising current dashed, and rectifier current. Bottom: the same three switching frequencies as points on the half-load gain curve. At full load  $f_{sw}/f_r = 0.70$  is already capacitive, so the full-load curve is drawn only from its ZVS edge up.**

The bottom panel is the gain  $M$  of Section 2.6. Which side of  $f_r$  the converter runs on decides whether the tank boosts or bucks:

- **Below  $f_r$ :  $M > 1$ , boost.** The resonant half sine ends early and  $i_{Lr}$  lands on  $i_{Lm}$ . From then on no power crosses to the secondary: freewheeling.
- **At  $f_r$ :  $M = 1$  at any load.**  $i_{Lr}$  meets  $i_{Lm}$  as the bridge switches, and the rectifier current reaches zero at the same instant. This is the most efficient point.
- **Above  $f_r$ :  $M < 1$ , buck.** The switching half period ends first and the resonant half sine is **cut off**. The switches turn off more current and the rectifier is interrupted while conducting.

**The freewheeling interval rings at  $f_o$ .** Nothing clamps  $L_m$ , so  $L_r + L_m$  rings with  $C_r$ . It looks nearly flat because it is short against the period of  $f_o$  and sits near the crest of that ring. The lower  $f_{sw}$ , the larger its share of the half period. Everything useful happens between the two frequencies.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

**Symbols are not standard.** At least one widely used guide calls the *series* resonance  $f_o$ , the opposite of the meaning here. Check before comparing.

A conventional LLC runs close to  $f_r$  at nominal input, where the circulating current is smallest, and goes below it only in hold-up. This converter runs on both sides, depending on the input voltage and the line phase (Section 4.7).

## 2.6 The gain function and the three regions

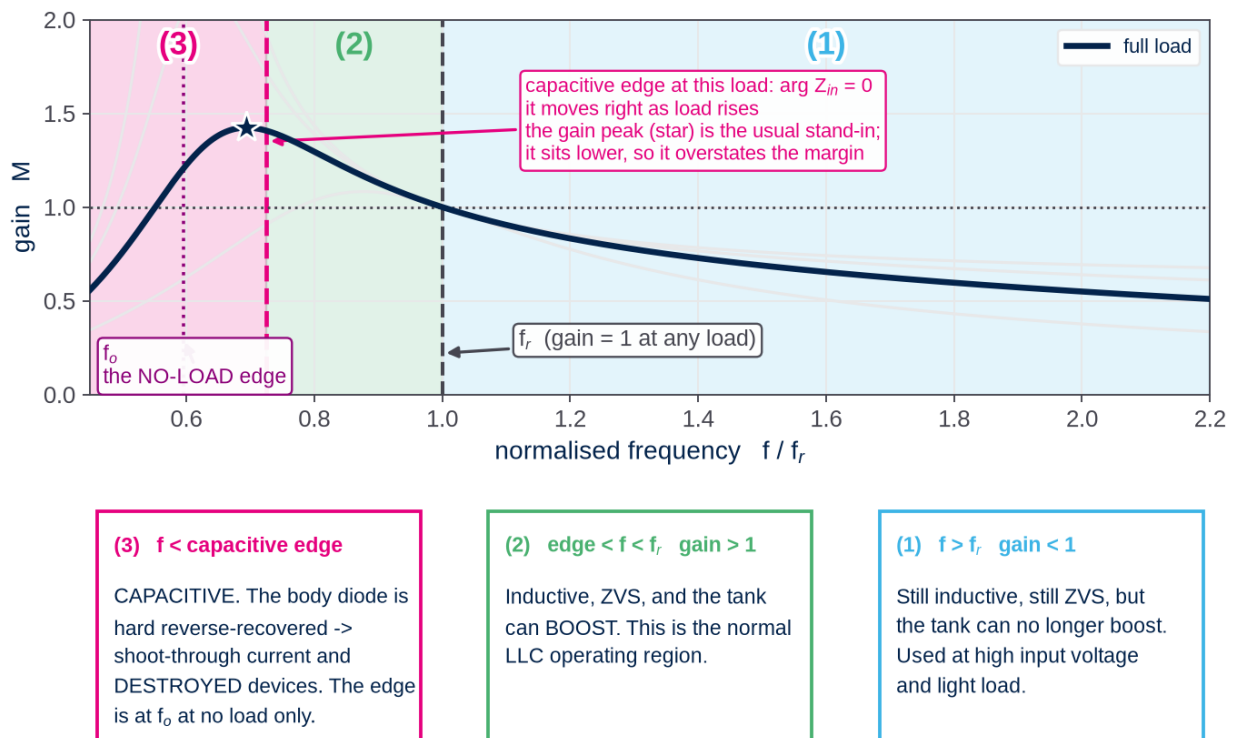
With the first-harmonic approximation the tank gain is

**Equation 4**

$$M(f_n, Q, \lambda) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\left(1 + \lambda - \frac{\lambda}{f_n^2}\right)^2 + Q^2\left(f_n - \frac{1}{f_n}\right)^2}}$$

Two checks by eye: at  $f_n = 1$  the  $Q$  term vanishes and  **$M = 1$  at any  $Q$** , so every curve passes through that point. At no load ( $Q = 0$ ) raising  $f_n$  only brings  $M$  down to  $1/(1+\lambda)$ ; that floor matters in Section 4.10.

The curve has three regions. Below the capacitive/inductive boundary the bridge hard-switches: not allowed. Between the boundary and  $f_r$  the tank is inductive and boosts; above  $f_r$  it is inductive and bucks. The boundary is drawn for the full-load curve; at no load it sits at  $f_o$  and it moves up with load.



**Figure 12: The three regions, shaded for the full-load curve. Only the inductive ones are usable. Framing after ROHM TechWeb.**

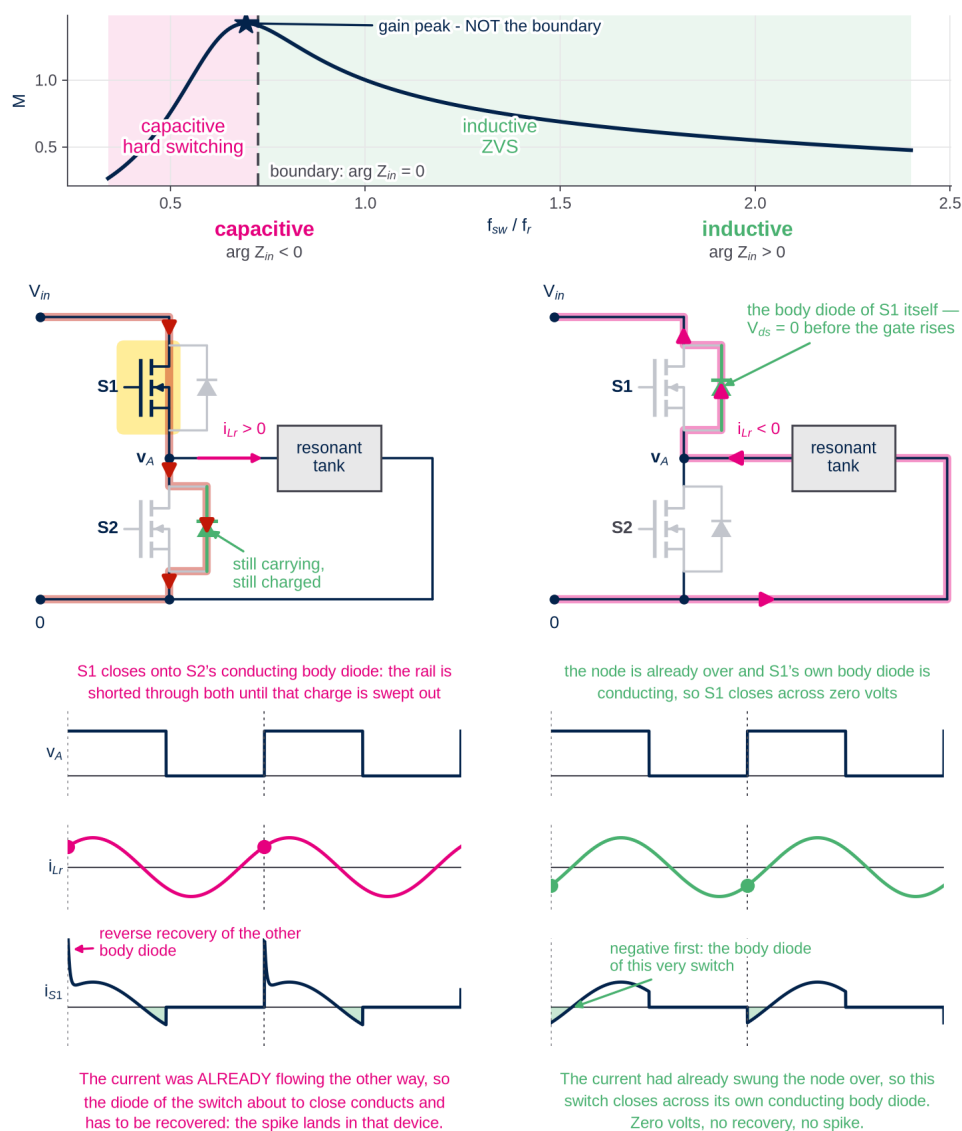
# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

**The side can be read from the chart without a waveform.** Draw the required gain as a horizontal line and find where it crosses the curve for the present load. Above 1 the crossing is left of  $f_n = 1$  (below resonance, the left column of Figure 11); at 1 it is  $f_r$  at any load; below 1 it is to the right (above resonance).

So the input voltage decides the side, not the load: the required gain is the reflected output voltage over the input the tank sees, and the load only picks the curve. A higher input lowers the line and moves the crossing right. The load decides whether the crossing is still to the right of the capacitive boundary (Section 2.9).

## 2.7 Capacitive and inductive, and why those words

The names describe **what the bridge sees**: the phase of the tank current against the square wave that drives it. At low frequency  $C_r$  dominates and the current *leads*; at high frequency the inductances dominate and it *lags*. That phase decides whether the switching is soft or hard.



**Figure 13: Either side of the boundary. Top: the boundary sits a little above the gain peak. Middle: the leg as  $S_1$  is gated on. Left, the tank current is already positive, flowing in  $S_2$ 's body diode, so  $S_1$  closes onto a conducting diode. Right, it is negative, has carried the mid-point up during the dead time, and  $S_1$  finds its own body diode conducting at zero volts. Bottom: the mid-point voltage  $V_A$  (to 0), the tank current and the drain current  $i_{S1}$  of the closing switch, to one scale.**

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

- **Inductive: the current lags.** At turn-off it still pushes the bridge node towards the other rail; the dead time lets it, and the next device turns on at zero volts. **ZVS.**
- **Capacitive: the current leads.** It has already reversed, so it pushes the node back. The next device turns on into the full rail, and the other body diode is forced off with reverse recovery through a low impedance. **Hard switching, and the failure that destroys parts.** The design stays out of this region; the controller has a protection in case it does not.

## 2.8 Why a diode has to recover on one side and not on the other

Take one leg: a high-side switch, a low-side switch and the tank on the mid-point. When either device turns off, **the tank current does not stop**. What carries it during the dead time decides everything. The middle row of Figure 13 shows the two cases, after onsemi AN-4151.

- **Inductive.** The current carries the mid-point to the *other* rail through the two  $C_{oss}$ , the incoming body diode picks it up, and that device is gated on at zero volts. Its own body diode then hands over to the channel with no reverse voltage: **nothing to recover**.
- **Capacitive.** The current has already reversed. It holds the mid-point on the rail it came from through the body diode of the device that just turned off. The incoming device is gated on across the full rail, onto a conducting diode.

That diode cannot block until its stored charge is swept out, so for that time both devices conduct and the rail is shorted through them. The current is a spike limited only by loop inductance, dissipated in the incoming device at full rail voltage; when the diode snaps off, the  $di/dt$  in the loop inductance appears as overshoot across it.

**This is why a fast-recovery body diode is required on the primary** (Section 7.15): any excursion into the capacitive region turns a device on onto the conducting body diode of the other. It is also why  $f_{Min}$  is kept above  $f_o$ , and why the anti-capacitive protection exists.

## 2.9 The two boundaries are not the same boundary

Both pairs of words describe positions on the same frequency axis, but they are different lines on it.

|                       | capacitive / inductive                       | below / above resonance                                |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| the boundary          | where $\arg Z_{in} = 0$                      | $f_r$ , the series resonance                           |
| does it move?         | <b>yes — with load</b>                       | no, it is fixed by $L_r$ and $C_r$                     |
| what it decides       | ZVS or hard switching, on the <b>primary</b> | boost or buck, and ZCS or not, on the <b>secondary</b> |
| which side is allowed | inductive only, always                       | both sides are legitimate                              |

**Table 1: Two classifications, two boundaries, two consequences.**

The capacitive boundary **rises with load**, from  $f_o$  at no load towards  $f_r$  as the load grows, so a frequency that is inductive at light load can be capacitive at overload.

**The boundary is not the gain peak.** It is where  $\arg Z_{in} = 0$ , a little *above* the peak. Using the peak is optimistic in the dangerous direction. Section 7.5 gives both frequencies for this design; the verdict comes from the ZVS check of Section 6.5.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

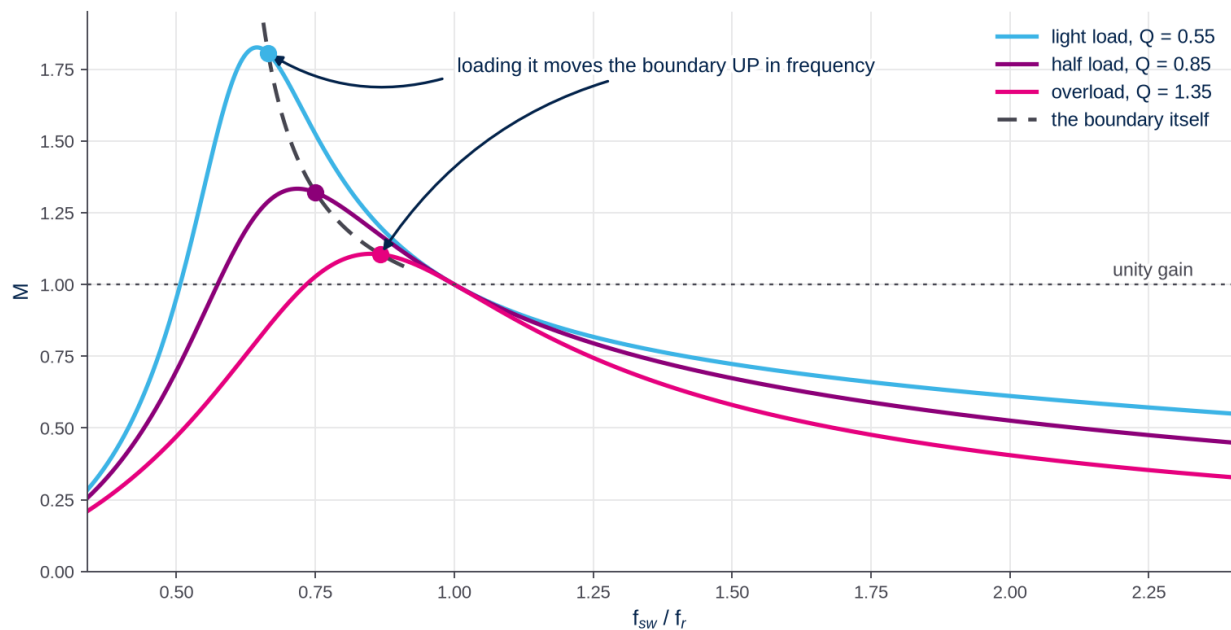


Figure 14: The boundary moves up with load. The dashed curve is the boundary itself, traced as  $Q$  varies.

- Below  $f_r$  and inductive is the normal boosting region.
- Below  $f_r$  and capacitive is the fault. Going below  $f_r$  is not the danger; going below the boundary is.
- Above  $f_r$  is inductive at every load.

**Design rule.** Keep  $f_{\text{Min}}$  above  $f_o$ . That is only the no-load boundary, so it is necessary but not sufficient; the real check is the ZVS sweep of Section 6.5, run under load at every line phase.

## 2.10 ZVS and ZCS are not the same thing

Both switch a device while its voltage or its current is zero. They apply to different devices, and only one is guaranteed.

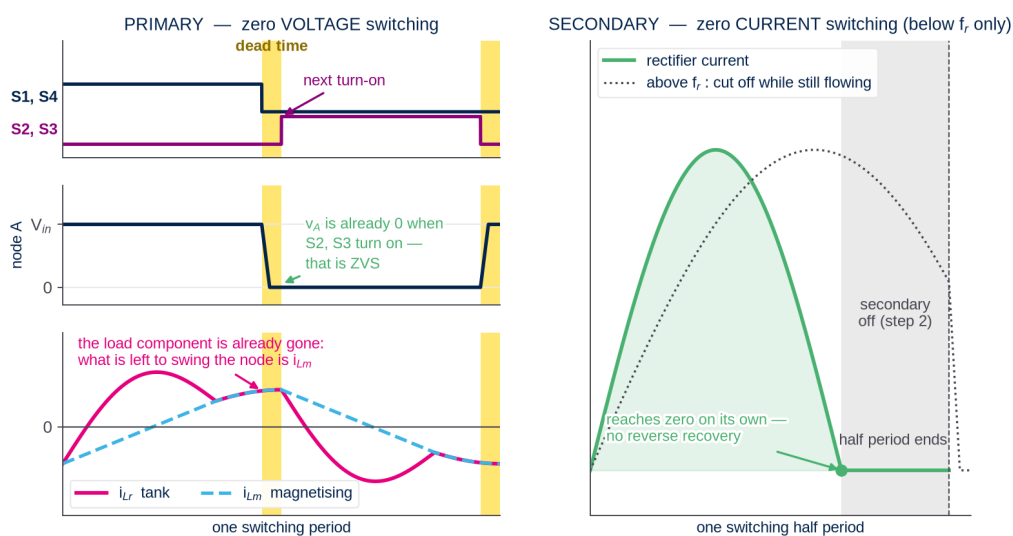


Figure 15: ZVS on the primary, ZCS on the secondary: different devices, different mechanisms, different conditions.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

- **ZVS on the primary switches** needs inductive operation, which is possible on both sides of  $f_r$ . It is required everywhere; Section 6.5 gives the margin.
- **ZCS on the secondary rectifiers** happens when the resonant current reaches zero by itself, which is only **below**  $f_r$ . Above  $f_r$  the rectifier is cut off while conducting and reverse recovery returns.

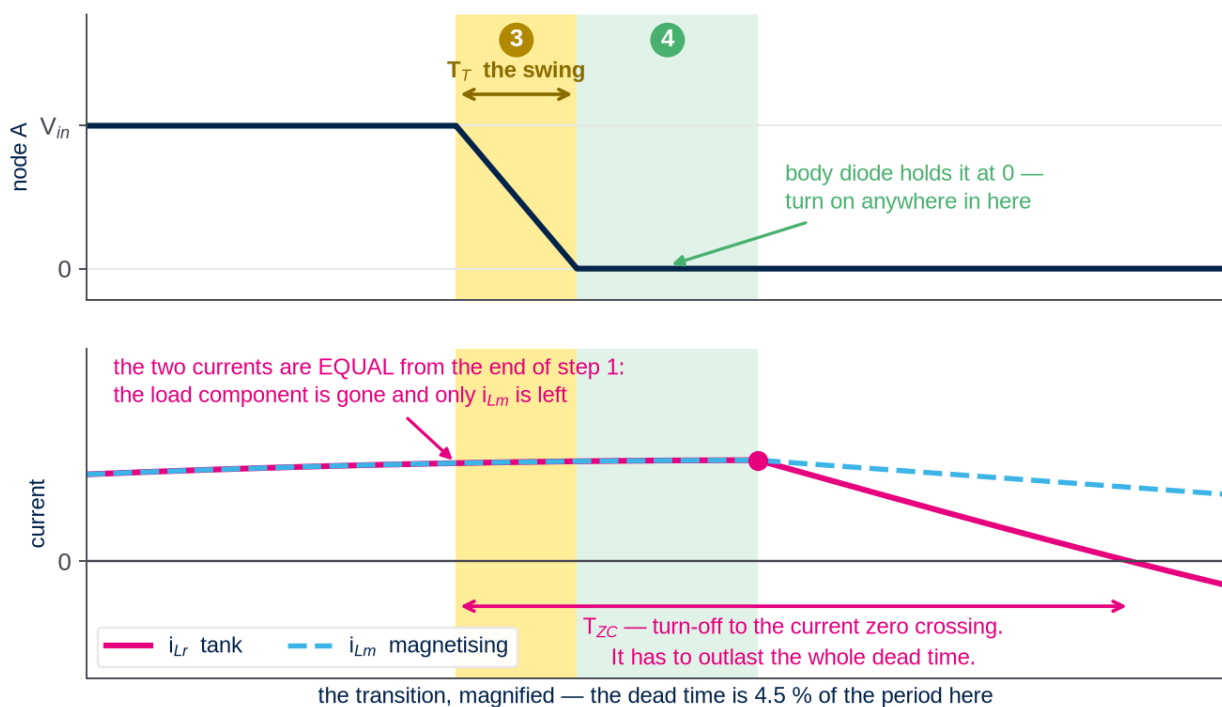
A converter whose input crosses  $f_r$  must be checked on both sides: its rectifier body diode and synchronous-rectifier dead time matter whenever it runs above  $f_r$ .

## 2.11 Sizing the dead time so that ZVS actually happens

ZVS is a charge problem. During the dead time the magnetising current must move enough charge to swing the bridge node across the rail. The design quantity is  $T_{ZC}$ , the time the tank current takes to reach zero after the gates turn off, and it must exceed the dead time:

Equation 5

$$T_{ZC} > t_D$$



**Figure 16: The magnetising current discharges the bridge node during the dead time. Two conditions: the current must not reach zero before the dead time ends ( $T_{ZC} > t_D$ ), and the swing  $T_T$  must finish inside the dead time.**

Use  $C_{o(tr)}$  (equivalently  $Q_{oss}$ ), not the headline  $C_{oss}$ : the datasheet values differ by three to five times, and ZVS is a charge question.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 2.12 Not a flyback, and why that changes the core

Two flyback habits are wrong here and cost money: sizing the core from the current, and asking for saturation at the peak winding current. Both come from when the two windings conduct.

**In a flyback they never conduct together**, so at every instant the whole winding current is magnetising current. Every joule delivered was first stored in the core, the flux follows the *current*, and  $A_e$  is sized from the peak current.

**In an LLC they conduct together**. Their ampere-turns oppose, and only the difference magnetises the core:

Equation 6

$$N_p i_p - N_s i_s = N_p i_\mu$$

The load current passes through by transformer action and never enters the core. What the core holds is the magnetising energy  $\frac{1}{2}L_\mu i_\mu^2$ , with  $L_\mu$  the magnetising inductance of the physical transformer (it is not quite the tank's  $L_m$ ; Section 6.9). That energy is not a by-product:  $i_\mu$  is what swings the bridge node in the dead time. The gap exists to set  $L_\mu$ , and through it  $L_m$ , not to store load energy.

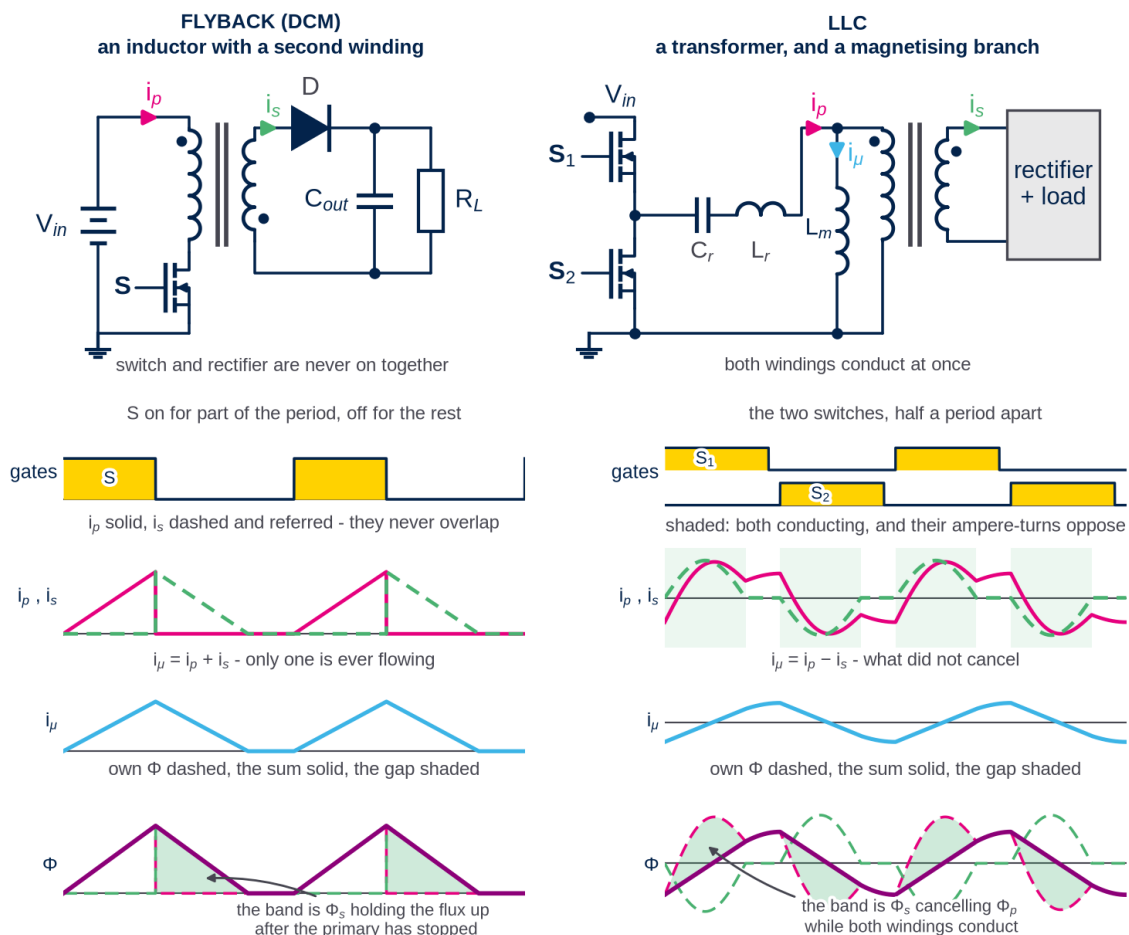
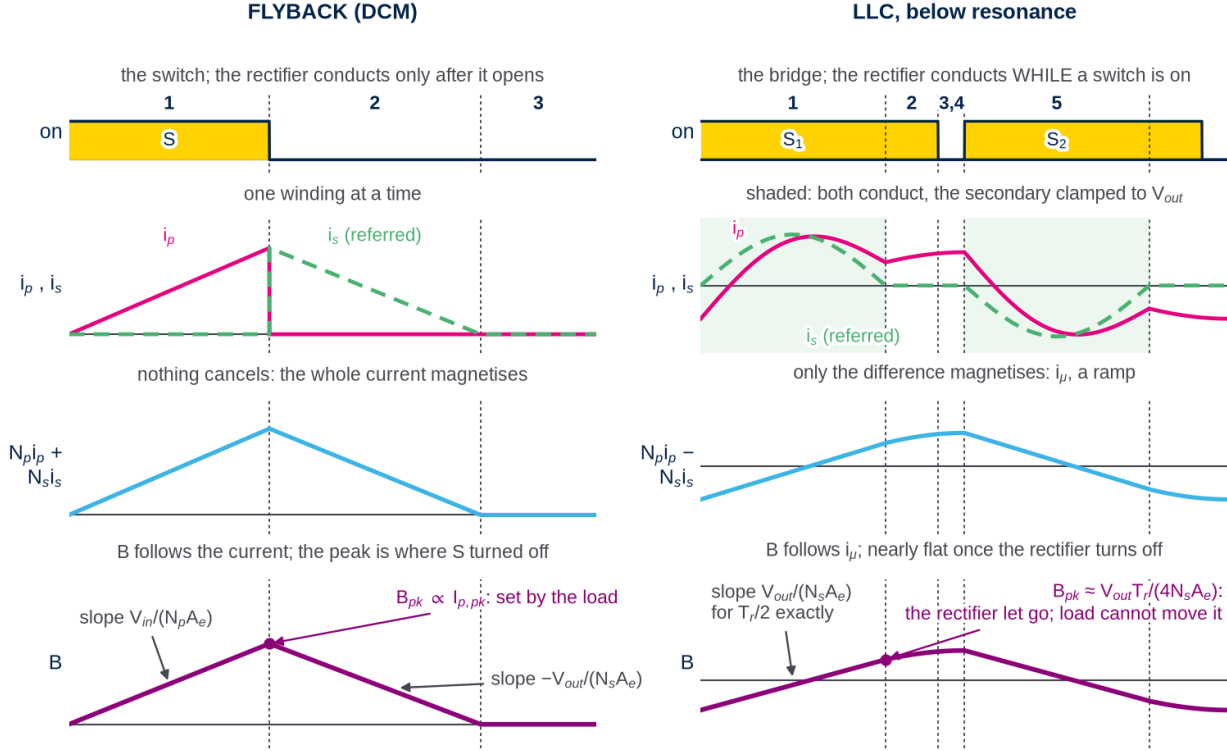


Figure 17: Left: a flyback in discontinuous conduction, as in Figure 18. The switch and the rectifier are never on together, so the conducting winding carries all the magnetising current and the flux ramps with it. Right: both conduct at once and only  $i_\mu = i_p - i_s$  magnetises the core. The secondary current is drawn referred to the primary.

The arrows are the reference directions:  $i_s$  is taken into the dot in the flyback and out of it in the LLC, so the flyback's ampere-turns add. Bottom row: dashed, what each winding would drive alone; solid, their sum; shaded, what the secondary removed.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

Figure 18 follows one period of each converter interval by interval: which winding conducts, what voltage it holds, and so which way the flux moves and what stops it.



**Figure 18: The flux built step by step. Left, a flyback in discontinuous conduction; right, an LLC below resonance, drawn from the eight-interval model with this design's currents and numbered with its steps (Figure 10). Compare the bottom row, the flux.**

- **Flyback, 1.** The switch closes.  $V_{in}$  sits on the primary,  $i_p$  ramps at  $V_{in}/L_p$ , and because no other winding conducts every ampere-turn magnetises:  $B$  rises at  $V_{in}/(N_p A_e)$ . The energy goes into the gap.
- **Flyback, 2.** The switch opens. The flux cannot jump, so the ampere-turns pass to the secondary at once,  $N_s i_s = N_p i_{p,pk}$ . The rectifier conducts,  $V_{out}$  sits on the secondary, and  $B$  falls at  $V_{out}/(N_s A_e)$  while the gap energy leaves for the output.
- **Flyback, 3.** The secondary current reaches zero; both windings are off and the flux rests near zero until the next cycle. The peak flux was fixed at the turn-off instant by  $i_{p,pk}$ , which is whatever the load and the input asked for.
- **LLC, 1.** A bridge switch closes. As soon as the secondary voltage reaches  $V_{out}$  the rectifier conducts, so the secondary is clamped to  $V_{out}$  and the magnetising branch sees  $nV_{out}$ . The load current flows in both windings at once, their ampere-turns cancel, and only  $i_\mu$  ramps:  $B$  rises at  $V_{out}/(N_s A_e)$ .
- **LLC, 2.** The resonant half period ends:  $i_s$  reaches zero, the rectifier turns off and the clamp is gone.  $L_m$  joins the resonance with  $C_r$ ,  $i_\mu$  is nearly flat, and  $B$  holds at its peak. That peak was set by  $V_{out}$  and  $T_r/2$  and by nothing else.
- **LLC, 3 and 4.** Dead time.  $i_\mu$  swings the bridge node to the other rail; the flux hardly moves.
- **LLC, 5.** The other switch closes and the other rectifier clamps the secondary to  $-V_{out}$ ;  $B$  ramps back down at the same slope to  $-B_{pk}$ .

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

|                                  | Flyback                                                      | LLC                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Which winding sets the flux      | whichever one conducts; B follows its current                | the clamped secondary; B follows its volt-seconds                                    |
| What the peak flux depends on    | $I_{p,pk}$ : load, input voltage and conduction mode         | $V_{out}$ , $T_r$ and $N_s$ only                                                     |
| Flux against load                | rises with load                                              | does not move                                                                        |
| Flux against switching frequency | falls as the frequency rises (shorter on-time)               | constant below resonance, falls above it                                             |
| What the gap does                | stores the load energy; gap and $A_e$ together set the power | sets $L_m$ , i.e. the magnetising current and ZVS; holds only the magnetising energy |
| What threatens the core          | overload, over-current                                       | over-voltage on the output                                                           |
| Which protection guards the core | the current limit                                            | the output OVP; the current limit only where there is no OVP (Section 6.19)          |
| Saturation test current          | the peak winding current, with margin                        | $i_{\mu,pk}$ scaled to the OVP ceiling; below the winding peak                       |
| What sizes $A_e$                 | peak current and $L_p$ : energy                              | output volt-seconds at $f_r$ : Faraday                                               |

**Table 2: The same two cores, compared.**

“An LLC transformer stores no energy” is a slogan. It stores the magnetising energy twice per period; it does not store the load energy.

$A_e$  still matters because Faraday’s law does not ask whether energy is stored:

## Equation 7

$$B(t) = \frac{1}{NA_e} \int v dt$$

with  $v$  the winding voltage,  $N$  its turns and  $A_e$  the core area. **Only the input to the calculation differs.** In a flyback the volt-seconds are the input voltage times the on-time. In an LLC the conducting secondary clamps the winding to the output for a resonant half period, so the flux is set by the **output voltage alone** (Section 6.11).

Three consequences:

- **The flux does not rise with load.** More load raises  $i_s$  and the reflected part of  $i_p$  together; their difference  $i_\mu$  does not move. Overload threatens the copper and the semiconductors, not the core.
- **The flux rises with output voltage**, so the saturation specification is set at the over-voltage threshold, not the nominal output (Section 6.19).
- **The flux does not fall with switching frequency** below resonance: the rectifier clamps the winding for  $T_r/2$  whatever  $f_{sw}$  is, which is why  $f_r$  appears in the flux equation.

**What to keep in mind when designing.**

- **Size  $A_e$  from volt-seconds, not from current.** The input is  $V_{out}$ ,  $N_s$  and  $f_r$  (Section 6.11); the winding current does not enter.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

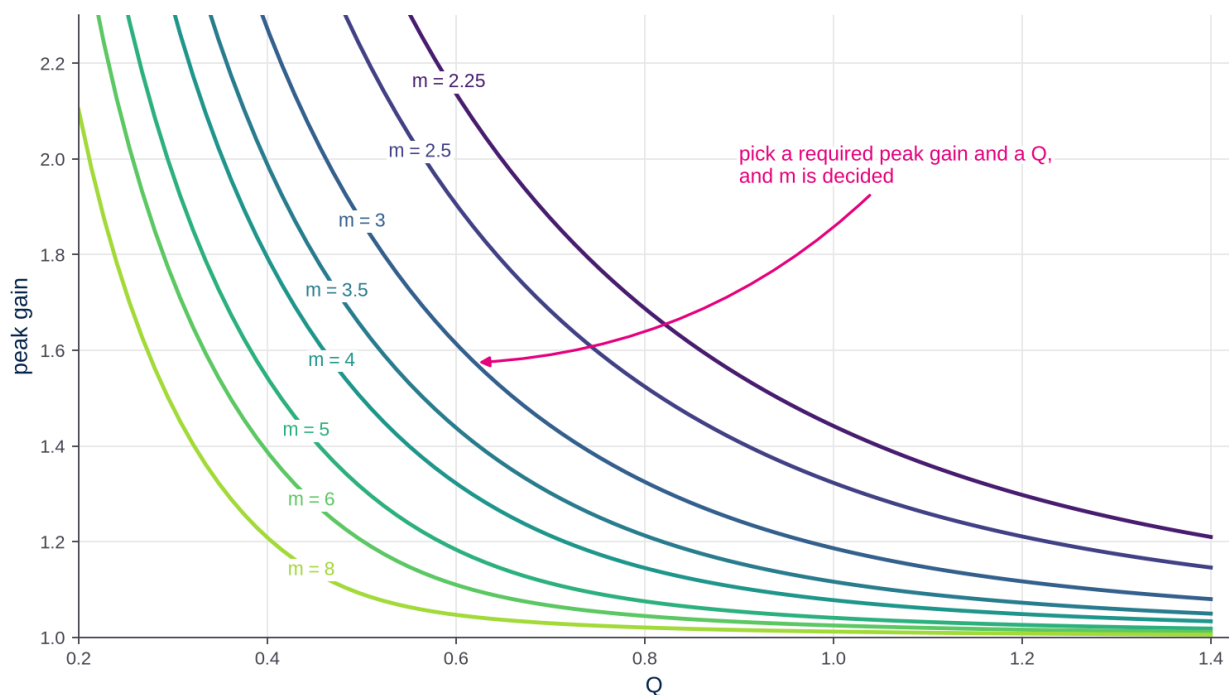
- **Do not add gap for margin.** In a flyback more gap means more stored energy. Here more gap means a smaller  $L_m$ : more magnetising current, more circulating loss, a different  $\lambda$ , and no change in the flux at all. The gap is set by  $L_m$  and checked by  $L_{open}$ ; the flux margin is set by the OVP ceiling and checked by the DC-overlap test.
- **The test current follows  $L_\mu$ ; the flux does not.** A smaller gap raises  $L_\mu$  and lowers  $i_{\mu,pk}$  at the same flux. Recompute  $I_{eq}$  from the actual  $L_\mu$  whenever the gap changes; never carry it over.
- **$B_{pk}$  is fixed, so core loss follows frequency.** The flux is the same at every point of the line cycle below resonance, and the loss per cycle at that flux rises with  $f_{sw}$ . Above resonance the flux falls as  $1/f_{sw}$  and the loss falls with it, so the worst core loss is near  $f_r$ .
- **The flyback habit that costs the most** is asking the supplier for saturation at the tank peak current. That asks for a larger core than the converter needs, for a flux the converter can never produce.

A DC-overlap test is made with every other winding open, which removes the cancellation: all of the test current is magnetising current. Section 6.19 takes that to a number.

## 2.13 How an LLC is normally designed

The standard sequence. Section 6 follows it and departs from it in two places.

- **1 Turns ratio** so that the converter runs near  $M = 1$  at nominal input, where circulating current is lowest.
- **2 Gain range**  $M_{min} \dots M_{max}$  from the input range and output tolerance.
- **3 Load resistance referred to the primary,  $R_{ac}$ .**
- **4  $m = (L_r + L_m)/L_r$  (or  $\lambda$ ) and  $Q$  together** from the peak-gain chart. For each  $m$  there is a curve of attainable peak gain against  $Q$ , and the design must sit under it with margin. Larger  $m$ : less circulating current, less peak gain.
- **5 Component values.**  $Q$  and  $R_{ac}$  give  $Z_0$ ;  $Z_0$  and  $f_r$  give  $C_r$  and  $L_r$ ;  $m$  gives  $L_m$ .
- **6 Verify** gain margin at the worst corner, ZVS at the worst point, and currents and flux against real parts.



**Figure 19: Step 4: the peak gain depends on both  $m$  and  $Q$ , so a required gain and a  $Q$  leave only a band of usable  $m$ .**

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 2.14 What power factor correction is

A bridge rectifier feeding a capacitor holds the bus near the mains peak, so the diodes conduct only in the short window when the mains is above the capacitor voltage. All the charge for the whole cycle arrives in that window.

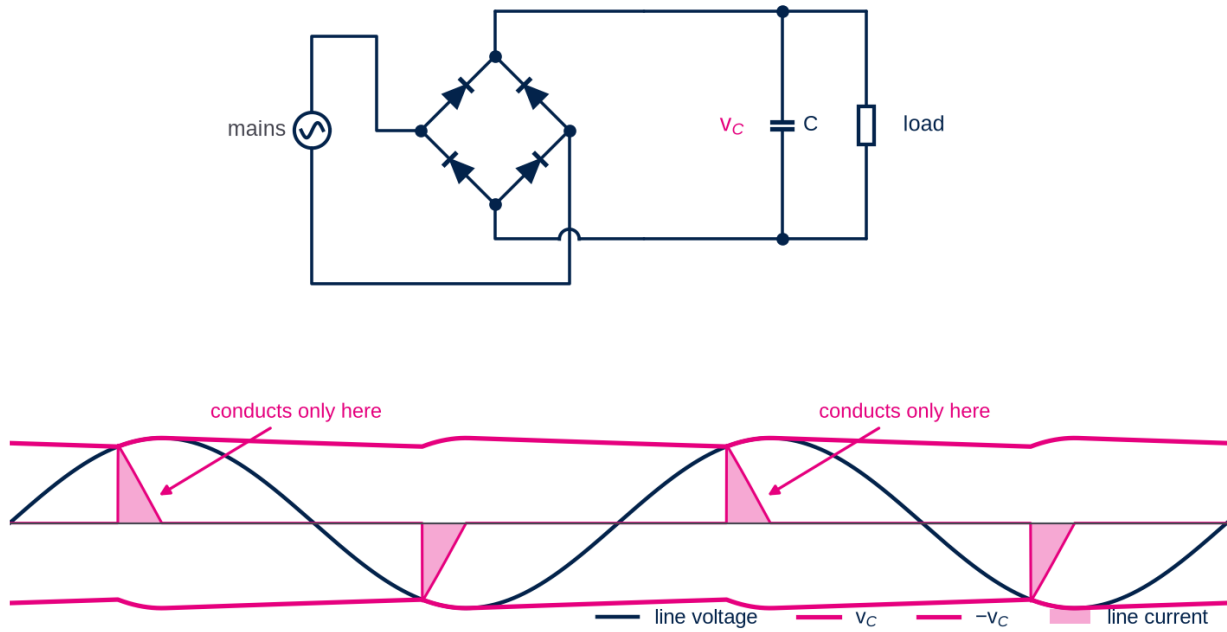


Figure 20: A capacitor-input rectifier:  $v_C$  stays near the crest, the diodes conduct in narrow windows, and the current inside them is tall.

The peak current is several times what a resistor of the same power would draw, and a pulse train that narrow is mostly harmonics.

## 2.15 Power factor, and why it is not the same as distortion

**Power factor** is the ratio of real power to apparent power, with  $V_{ac}$  and  $I_{ac}$  the rms input voltage and current:

Equation 8

$$PF = \frac{P}{V_{ac} I_{ac}} = \cos \varphi_1 \times \frac{I_{1,rms}}{I_{ac}}$$

with  $P$  the average power,  $I_{1,rms}$  the rms of the fundamental alone, and  $\varphi_1$  its phase against the voltage. **Displacement** (the phase) is what a motor gets wrong; **distortion** (the harmonic share of the rms) is what a rectifier gets wrong. The current above is roughly in phase and still scores about 0.6.

Total harmonic distortion, THD, is the harmonic content as a fraction of the fundamental:

Equation 9

$$THD = \frac{\sqrt{I_{ac}^2 - I_{1,rms}^2}}{I_{1,rms}}, \quad \frac{I_{1,rms}}{I_{ac}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + THD^2}}$$

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

A converter can hold PF above 0.99 and still fail IEC 61000-3-2, which limits *individual* harmonics in amperes. Class D covers only the product types the standard lists, up to 600 W; above that the absolute Class A limits apply. Settle the class first.

## 2.16 How a corrector fixes it

Force the input current to follow the input voltage and the converter looks like a resistor to the mains. The standard implementation is a **boost converter after the bridge**, switching fast enough that the mains is constant within one switching cycle.

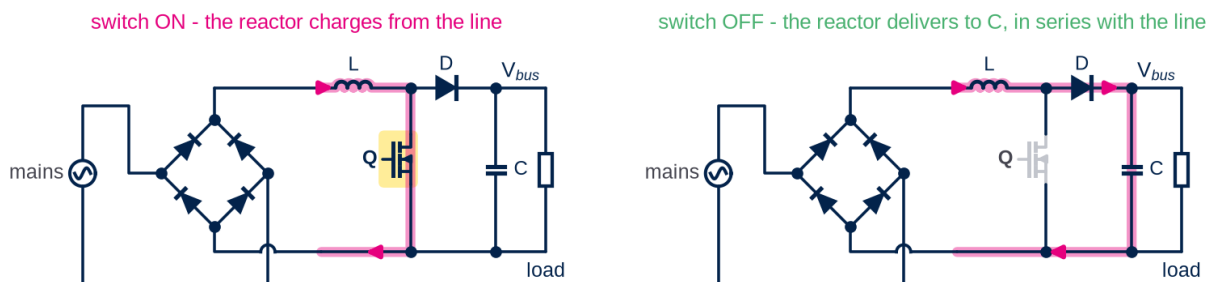


Figure 21: A boost corrector: the inductor charges from the line while the switch is on and delivers to the bus in series with the line while it is off.

- **Why a boost.** Near the zero crossing the stage must step up by an unlimited ratio. A boost can, and its input current is continuous, which makes shaping possible.
- **The inner loop** regulates the inductor current, fast.
- **The outer loop** regulates the bus voltage and is made **slower than  $2f_l$** . A fast voltage loop would fight the bus ripple and flatten the current shape the corrector exists to make.
- **The multiplier** joins them: shape from the mains, level from the output.

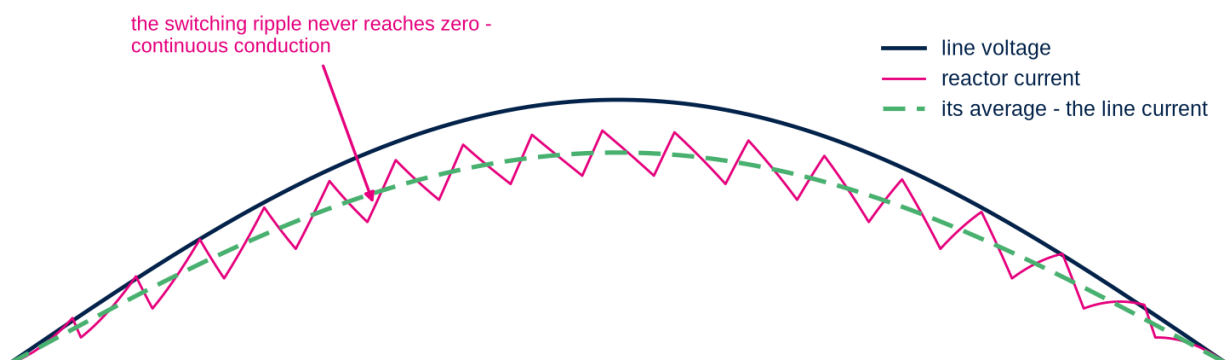
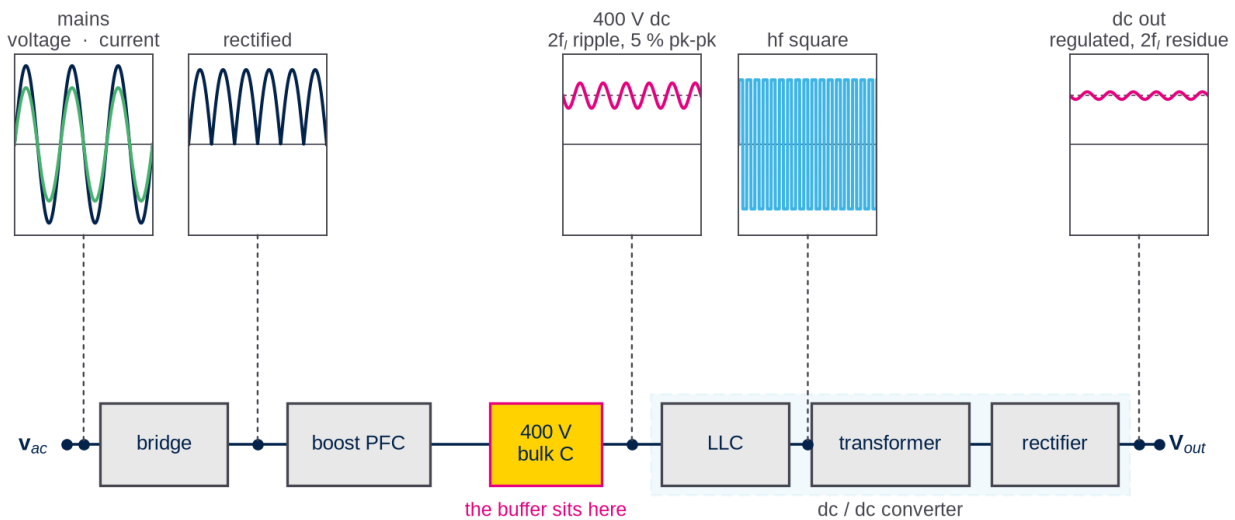


Figure 22: The result in continuous conduction: switching ripple rides on the inductor current, and its average follows the input voltage.

A current that follows the voltage means an input power that follows  $\sin^2\theta$ : zero twice per cycle, twice the average at the crests. The load wants constant power, so **something must store the difference**.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 2.17 Why they are normally two stages



**Figure 23: The two-stage arrangement with the waveform at every node. The buffer that absorbs the twice-line-frequency pulsation sits between the stages at 400 V. Ripple on the dc nodes is exaggerated;  $v_{ac}$  is the instantaneous mains voltage.**

The bus capacitor does two jobs:

- it **buffers** the difference between the pulsating input power and the constant output power;
- it **isolates** the LLC from the mains waveform, so the tank sees a nearly constant input and has to cover only a narrow gain range.

Removing the boost stage removes both. The buffering must be done elsewhere, and the tank must work from a rectified sine that goes to zero 100 or 120 times a second.

## 3 Why single stage, and what it costs

Two steps of the standard LLC sequence (Section 2.13) do not survive here. There is no nominal point, because the input sweeps a half sine; and no single tank covers the gain range, so the bridge itself changes (Sections 4.1 and 5).

### 3.1 The energy a unity power factor cannot deliver

Unity power factor makes the instantaneous input power follow  $\sin^2\theta$ , swinging between zero and twice the average at twice the line frequency:

**Equation 10**

$$p_{in}(t) = V_{ac}I_{ac} [ 1 - \cos(2\omega_l t) ]$$

with  $V_{ac}$  and  $I_{ac}$  the rms mains voltage and current and  $\omega_l = 2\pi f_l$ . The load wants constant power, so the difference must be stored and returned a few milliseconds later, whatever the topology.

Panel 2 of Figure 24 draws it: the surplus above the flat load equals the deficit below it, and a capacitor somewhere must absorb the one and return it as the other.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 3.2 Moving the buffer from 400 V to the output

In the two-stage converter the buffer is the 400 V bus capacitor. Here there is no bus, so it moves to the output. **The joules do not change; the voltage they sit at does**, and a capacitor returns only the energy between its starting voltage and the lowest the load accepts:

Equation 11

$$E = \frac{1}{2} C (V^2 - V_{min}^2)$$

Hold-up shows the price. Both architectures must store the same energy for the same  $T_{hold}$ . On a 400 V bus that may fall to 320 V the window is  $400^2 - 320^2$ ; on an output of a few tens of volts it is  $V_{out}^2 - V_{o,min}^2$ , smaller by a factor in the hundreds, so the capacitance grows by that factor. Settle this first: if the enclosure cannot house the bank, the output voltage must change. Section 7.13 sizes the bank for this design, where ripple, not hold-up, decides.

**The trade.** Out: a switch, an inductor, a diode, a 400 V electrolytic and their losses. In: a very large low-voltage capacitor bank, 2f<sub>l</sub> ripple on the output, and a tank that must cover a much wider range. Whether it is a good trade depends on how much output ripple the load accepts.

## 3.3 What the load must tolerate

The output carries the 2f<sub>l</sub> ripple directly. It is set by the bank and the load, not by the loop, and it cannot be regulated away: trying puts the distortion on the input current instead (Section 6.28). **The allowed ripple is a property of the load** and must come from the specification. This design allows a few per cent peak-to-peak.

# 4 Operating principle

## 4.1 Gain is a boundary condition, not a control variable

In a two-stage LLC the controller commands gain. Here it cannot, because **both ports are voltage sources**: the output is a millifarad-class capacitor bank and the input is the rectified mains. The instantaneous gain is forced:

Equation 12

$$M(\theta) = \frac{n V_{o,eff}}{V_{drive}(\theta)} = \frac{2 n V_{o,eff}}{\sqrt{2} V_{ac,eq} \sin \theta}$$

with  $\theta$  the line phase and  $V_{drive}$  the amplitude the bridge applies to the tank: the rectified mains in full bridge, half of it in half bridge.  $V_{ac,eq}$  is the mains voltage a half bridge would need for the same drive, so twice the mains in full bridge and the mains itself in half bridge;  $V_{o,eff}$  is the output plus the rectifier drop (Equation 19). Both voltages are pinned from outside, so their ratio is fixed moment by moment.

Moving the frequency therefore moves **Q**, that is, power. **Frequency is a power command, not a voltage command.**

## 4.2 Two divergences that cancel

Near the zero crossing the required gain rises as  $1/\sin\theta$  without limit. The converter survives because the load disappears at the same time:

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

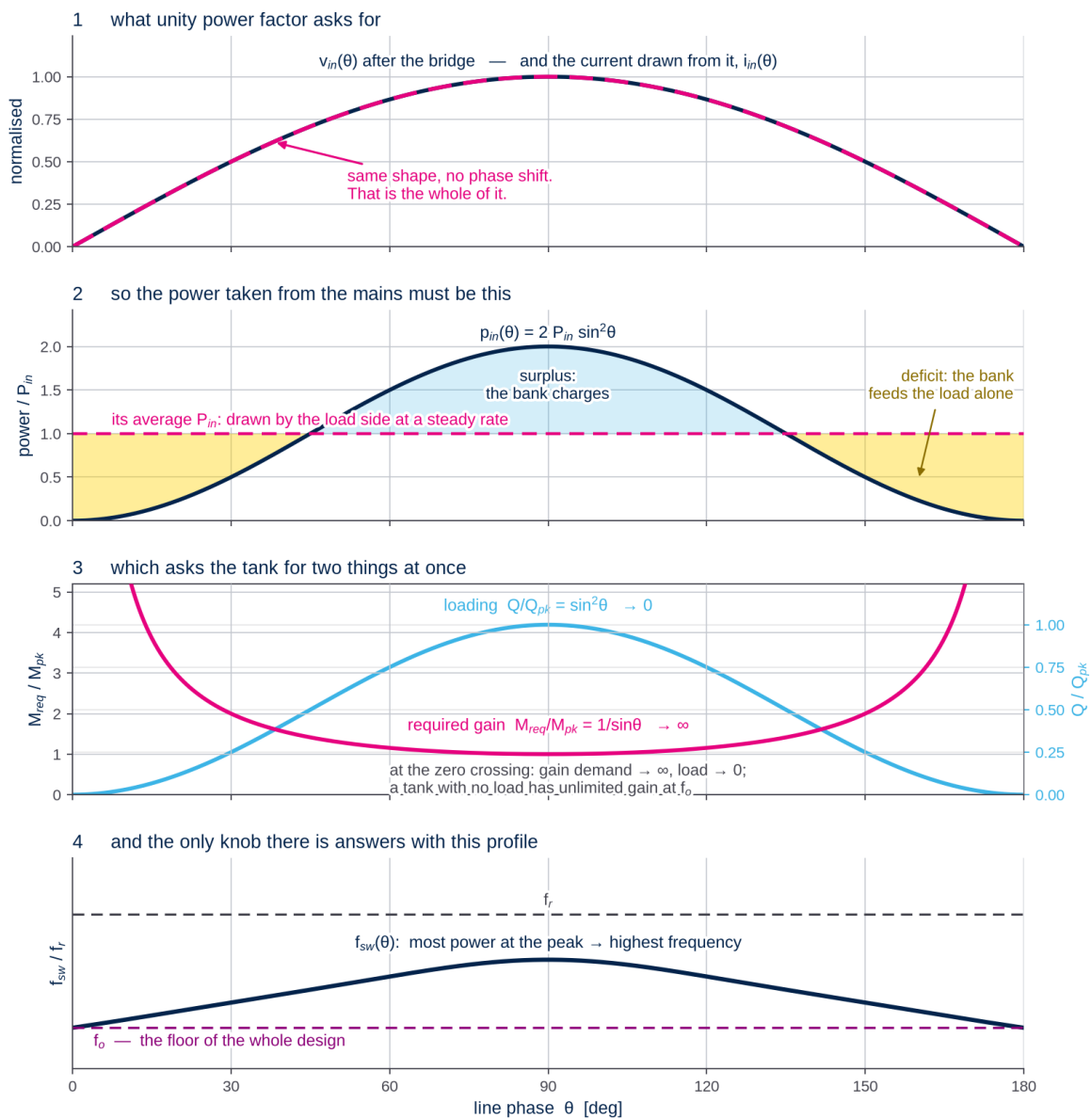
## Equation 13

$$Q(\theta) = Q_{pk} \sin^2 \theta$$

with  $Q_{pk}$  its value at the line peak, and an unloaded LLC has unlimited gain at  $f_o$ . The two infinities cancel, and the operating point walks down towards  $f_o$  as the mains approaches zero (Section 7.7).  $f_o$  is the **frequency floor of the whole design**; an oscillator clamp below it destroys hardware.

## 4.3 Frequency modulation is the power factor correction

Figure 24 follows the control law round one line half cycle. The first three steps are forced by the two voltage sources; only the fourth is something the controller does.



**Figure 24: How the power factor is corrected, over one line half cycle. 1 Unity power factor: the current has the shape of the rectified mains. 2 The power drawn is  $\sin^2$ , while the load takes a steady  $P_{out}$ ; the shaded areas are what the bank buffers. 3 The tank is handed a gain and a load, and both run away at the zero crossing. 4 The switching frequency is the only free variable; this profile satisfies 1 to 3. Normalised; with numbers in Section 7.7.**

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Unity power factor fixes the instantaneous power at  $2 P_{in} \sin^2\theta$ , which fixes both the gain (Equation 12) and the loading (Equation 13) at every instant. The controller answers with the one variable it has. There is no current loop and no multiplier against a rectified reference: **the frequency profile  $f_{sw}(\theta)$  is the power factor correction.**

| At the line phase              | $\sin\theta$ | instantaneous power<br>$p/P_{in}$ | required gain $M_{req}/M_{pk}$ | loading $Q/Q_{pk}$ |
|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|
| $\theta = 90^\circ$ , the peak | 1.000        | 2.000                             | 1.000                          | 1.000              |
| $\theta = 60^\circ$            | 0.866        | 1.500                             | 1.155                          | 0.750              |
| $\theta = 45^\circ$            | 0.707        | 1.000                             | 1.414                          | 0.500              |
| $\theta = 30^\circ$            | 0.500        | 0.500                             | 2.000                          | 0.250              |
| $\theta = 10^\circ$            | 0.174        | 0.060                             | 5.759                          | 0.030              |
| $\theta \rightarrow 0$         | 0            | 0                                 | $\infty$                       | 0                  |

**Table 3: The half cycle at six instants, normalised as in Figure 24. Trigonometry only; no part value enters.**

In the last two rows the gain demand runs away, but so does the ability to meet it: an unloaded tank has unlimited gain at  $f_o$ . The frequency walks down towards  $f_o$  and the current goes to zero with the voltage.

The controller has two signals on two time scales:

- **FB says how much.** It carries the error amplifier output through the optocoupler and commands an input *power* (Section 4.6). The loop behind it crosses well below the line frequency, so within one half cycle it is a constant: the *height* of the profile in panel 4.
- **HVSU says where in the cycle.** The start-up pin is also the input-voltage sense, so the controller knows the instantaneous rectified mains without a divider. That is the fast signal, the *shape* of the profile.
- **The internal PFC and THD block combines them** into  $I_{EA}$ , the one current that moves the oscillator (Equation 60).

**The draft datasheet does not publish the law inside that block.** This note therefore computes, from the tank, the profile that *must* come out if the current is to follow the voltage. Measuring  $f_{sw}(\theta)$  on the first board is how the block gets characterised.

**Zero-crossing dead zone.** Very near  $\theta = 0$  the profile asks for a frequency below  $f_{Min}$ , and the converter stops drawing current until the mains comes back. This is inherent and appears as third-harmonic distortion. The other THD mechanism is the voltage loop (Section 6.28).

## 4.4 Solving for the profile without a root search

The profile does not need a numerical root search. With  $M_{req} = M_{pk}/\sin\theta$ ,  $Q = Q_{pk}\sin^2\theta$  and  $x = 1/f_n^2$  the gain equation is a cubic in  $x$ :

**Equation 14**

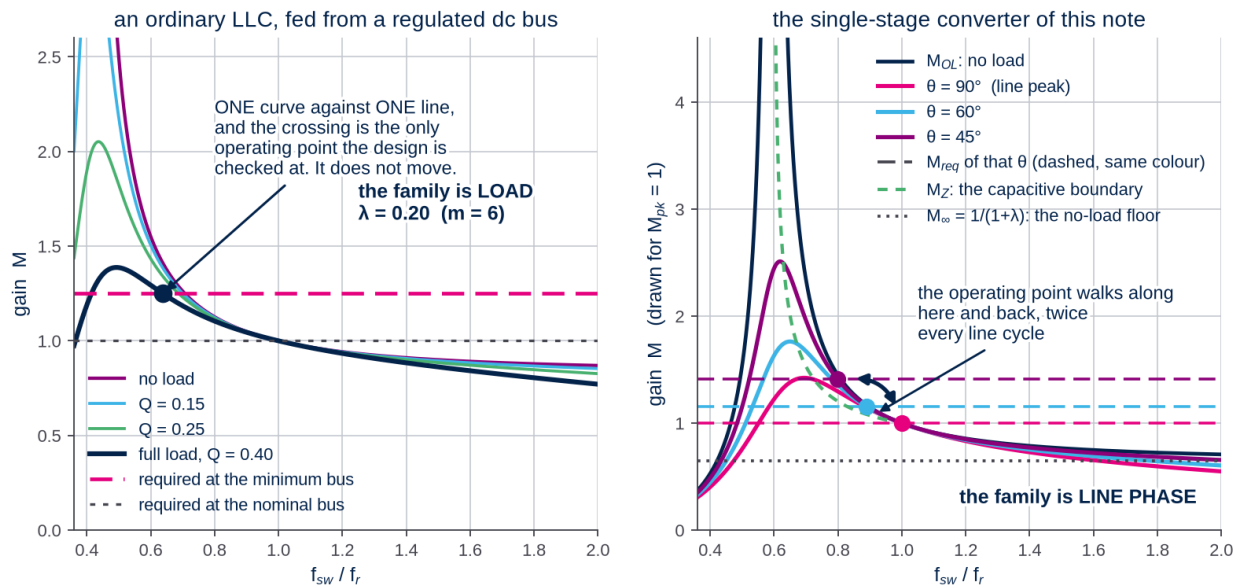
$$\lambda^2 x^3 + (q - 2\lambda(1 + \lambda))x^2 + ((1 + \lambda)^2 - 2q - \frac{u}{M_{pk}^2})x + q = 0, \quad u = \sin^2 \theta, \quad q = Q_{pk}^2 u^2$$

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One root is negative (the cubic is  $+q$  at  $x = 0$  and tends to  $-\infty$  as  $x \rightarrow -\infty$ ). The other two are the capacitive and the inductive crossing of the same curve, and the inductive one is the **middle** root, because  $x$  falls as frequency rises. In the trigonometric form of Cardano it is always the  $k = 1$  branch. No positive root means the no-solution case of Section 4.10, not a numerical failure. A grid search would also need an upper bound on  $f_n$ , and a bound taken from the ac maximum instead of the morphing corner misses the real operating point.

## 4.5 Reading the gain chart of a single-stage converter

The chart in Figure 5 is the standard picture: a family of curves, one required-gain line, one crossing. A single-stage converter is drawn the same way and **read differently**. Figure 25 puts the two side by side.



**Figure 25: The ordinary chart and the single-stage one: same axes, same equation, read differently. Left, the family is load and the converter sits at one crossing. Right, the family is line phase, each curve has its own required-gain line in its own colour, and the converter travels the family twice per line cycle. The right panel is drawn for the input at which the line peak needs  $M = 1$  ( $M_{pk} = 1$ ); a lower input raises every dashed line by the same factor.**

Six differences:

- **The family parameter is line phase, not load.** The load is fixed at full and the curves are  $\theta = 90^\circ, 60^\circ, 45^\circ, \dots$ , because  $Q = Q_{pk} \sin^2 \theta$  falls as the mains falls.
- **The operating point moves, 100 or 120 times a second.** There is no single point to check; the design is checked along a path.
- **There is a ladder of required gains,**  $M_{req}(\theta) = M_{pk}/\sin \theta$ , one line per phase, climbing without limit towards the zero crossing. **Each curve is compared with its own line only.**
- **The curves get taller as the lines get higher.** Halve  $\sin \theta$  and the requirement doubles, but  $Q$  falls by four and the curve grows far more than twice as tall. The margin grows towards the zero crossing.
- **$M_Z$ , the capacitive boundary, is drawn.** It is where  $\arg Z_{in} = 0$  (Section 2.9), a little to the right of each curve's peak, and every crossing must lie to its **right**. It has to be cleared at every phase, so it is a curve of its own.
- **$M_\infty = 1/(1+\lambda)$  is on the chart.** An ordinary LLC never needs a gain that small; a single-stage converter at high input voltage does. Below this line there is **no solution at no load, at any frequency**, and burst mode takes over (Section 4.10).

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

**The mistake this chart invites:** checking the tallest curve against the lowest line. There is no such operating point.  $\theta$  sets the curve *and* the line together, so only the same-coloured pairs mean anything.

At the lowest equivalent input the chart answers “can the tank make the gain and stay inductive?” At the highest it answers “how high does the frequency go, and is there a solution at light load?” Section 7.6 draws it at all six input voltages for that reason.

## 4.6 The feedback pin is a power command

Combining the burst-mode expression with the multiplier in the block diagram gives the meaning of the feedback voltage  $V_{FB}$ :

**Equation 15**

$$V_{FB} = V_{os} + \frac{2K_{HV}}{K_M K_{FF}} R_{CS} P_{in, LLC} = 0.5 \text{ V} + 0.167 \frac{\text{V}}{\Omega \cdot \text{W}} R_{CS} P_{in, LLC}$$

$P_{in, LLC}$  is the power drawn by the bridge:  $R_{CS}$  sits in the bridge return, so that is the power the controller senses.  $V_{os}$  is the 0.5 V the pin sits at with no power commanded;  $K_{HV}$ ,  $K_M$  and  $K_{FF}$  are the input-voltage sense, multiplier and feed-forward gains of the block diagram. The 2.8 V feedback span gives  $2.8/0.167 = 16.8 \text{ } \Omega \cdot \text{W}$ , the maximum-power rule of the datasheet. **Maximum power, burst entry and overload detection all sit on one scale,  $R_{CS}$ .** The optocoupler loop commands an input power; the internal loop distributes it over the line cycle as  $\sin^2\theta$ .

This is why the current-sense pin tolerates no filter and no series resistor: the power law and the over-current threshold read the same pin.

## 4.7 Which side of resonance this converter runs on

A single-stage converter does not pick one side. The equivalent input follows a half sine and the required gain follows it, so the operating point can cross  $f_r$  and come back within one line cycle. Whether it crosses, and for how long, depends on the mains voltage; at a low input it can stay below  $f_r$  all the way. Section 7.7 shows the profile at the six input voltages.

**Both sides must be designed for.** The boosting side sets the gain requirement and the ZVS margin. The bucking side sets the top frequency and takes the secondary out of ZCS, so the rectifier body diode and the SR dead time matter here.

## 4.8 Why $\lambda$ must be about 0.5

A classic LLC uses  $m = (L_r + L_m)/L_r$  of 5 to 10, that is  $\lambda$  of 0.11 to 0.25. A single-stage converter needs very high gain near the zero crossing, and peak gain falls as  $\lambda$  falls. ST's evaluation board runs  $\lambda = 0.500$  and this design comes out close to it (Section 7.4): the value comes from the topology.

The price is circulating current: a small  $L_m$  means a large magnetising current with conduction loss at every load. **A single-stage PFC LLC is less efficient than a two-stage LLC, inherently.**

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 4.9 $f_{sw,max}$ does not check the tank — it computes it

Two of the four candidates for  $\lambda$  carry the specified maximum switching frequency in a denominator:

Equation 16

$$\lambda_2 = \frac{\lambda_1}{1 - \left(\frac{f_r}{f_{sw,max}}\right)^2} \quad \lambda_{TD} = \frac{\lambda_1}{1 - \frac{\pi^2}{8} \left(\frac{f_r}{f_{sw,max}}\right)^2}$$

$\lambda_1$  is the plain minimum-gain condition;  $\lambda_2$  and  $\lambda_{TD}$  fold in the frequency ceiling: the tank must reach the lowest required gain *before* it runs out of frequency. With the usual  $f_{sw,max} = 1.5 f_r$  the squared ratio is 0.44 and **the value typed as  $f_{sw,max}$  roughly doubles the  $\lambda$  asked for**. Set it near  $f_r$  and the required  $\lambda$  goes to infinity. The fourth candidate,  $\lambda_3$ , comes from the specified minimum switching frequency; it is small in this converter and does not bind.

The common  $1.5 \times f_r$  is a **choice**, not a limit, and it sits upstream of the tank: a round number typed into it changes  $L_m$ .

$f_{Max}$ , the oscillator ceiling, is different. It *is* a limit, fixed by  $R_T$ ,  $C_T$ ,  $I_{EA,max}$  and the idle time, and it is checked after the fact by  $k_{ceil}$  (Section 7.3). One decides the tank; the other reports whether the oscillator can serve it.

## 4.10 The other bound on $\lambda$ , and where it has no solution

The ceiling on  $\lambda$  comes from the lowest required gain, at the highest equivalent input and no load. The no-load gain does not fall without limit; raising the frequency only brings it down to an asymptote:

Equation 17

$$M_\infty = \lim_{f \rightarrow \infty} M_{OL} = \frac{1}{1 + \lambda}$$

with  $M_{OL}$  the gain curve at no load ( $Q = 0$ , output open).

**If the required minimum gain is below  $M_\infty$ , no frequency satisfies it.** A spreadsheet solving for that frequency returns an error, and the error looks like a broken formula. It is not: the question has no answer. Whether a tank sits above or below the asymptote is a matter of a per cent, and no full-load check shows it; Section 7.4 reports it for this design.

Losing the solution is not a failure: no load at high input voltage belongs to **burst mode**. But it decides which candidate turns ratios can still regulate by frequency alone at no load.

## 5 Topology morphing

A resonant tank has a usable gain range of roughly 1.5:1 at full load. A universal mains asks for 2.93:1. No single tank covers that and keeps ZVS, so the L6790A changes the bridge instead.

Below a mains peak of 235 V the part runs a **full bridge**, which drives the tank with twice the rail. Above 245 V<sub>pk</sub> it runs a **half bridge**. The tank therefore sees 173.2 to 332.3 Vac equivalent, a range of 1.92:1, and one tank can cover it.

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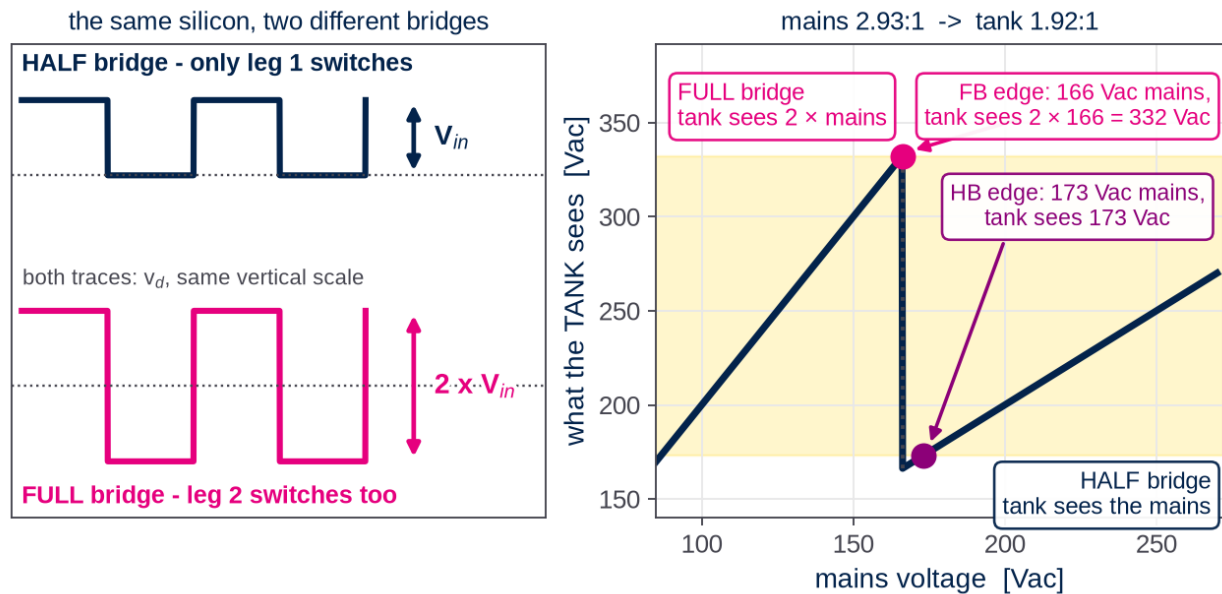


Figure 26: Morphing collapses a 2.93:1 mains range into a 1.92:1 range at the tank. The worst corners are the morphing edges, not the ends of the mains range. Drawn for a falling mains; Figure 30 shows the band in which the mode depends on the direction.

## 5.1 Full bridge

Diagonal pairs conduct together, so the drive is a square wave of amplitude  $V_{in}$  with fundamental  $(4/\pi)V_{in}$ . All four devices switch.

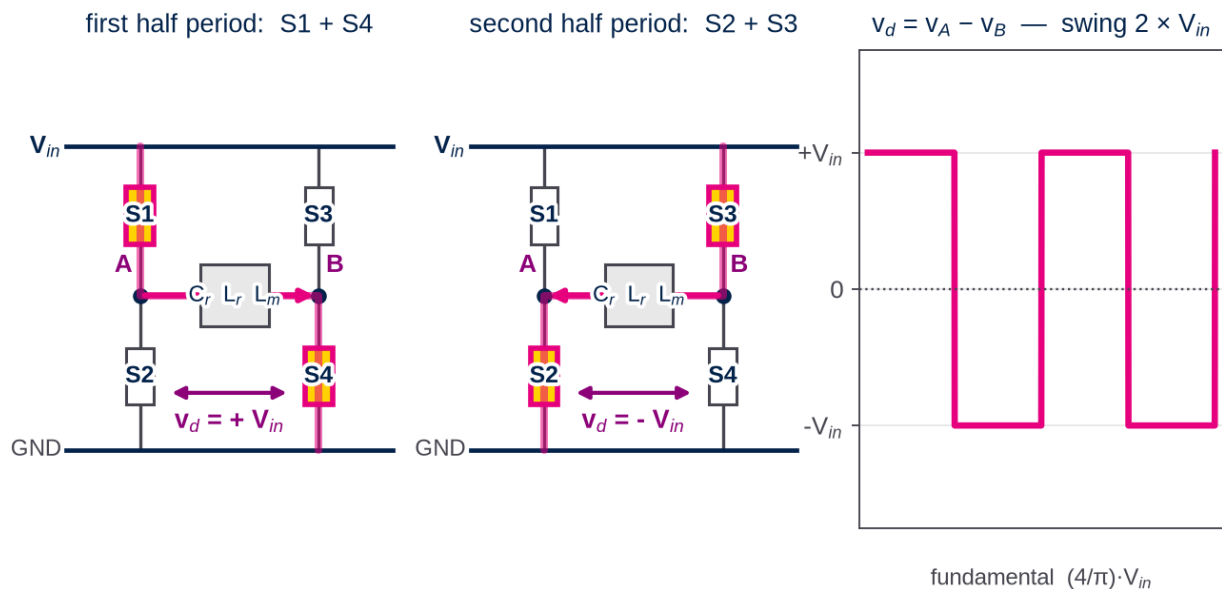


Figure 27: Full bridge: conduction path in each half period, and the resulting tank drive.

## 5.2 Half bridge

LOUT2 is held high: S3 never turns on and S4 never turns off, so the bridge output swings between 0 and  $V_{in}$ .  $C_r$  blocks the  $V_{in}/2$  of dc, and the tank sees  $\pm V_{in}/2$ , a fundamental of  $(2/\pi)V_{in}$ . No extra hardware.

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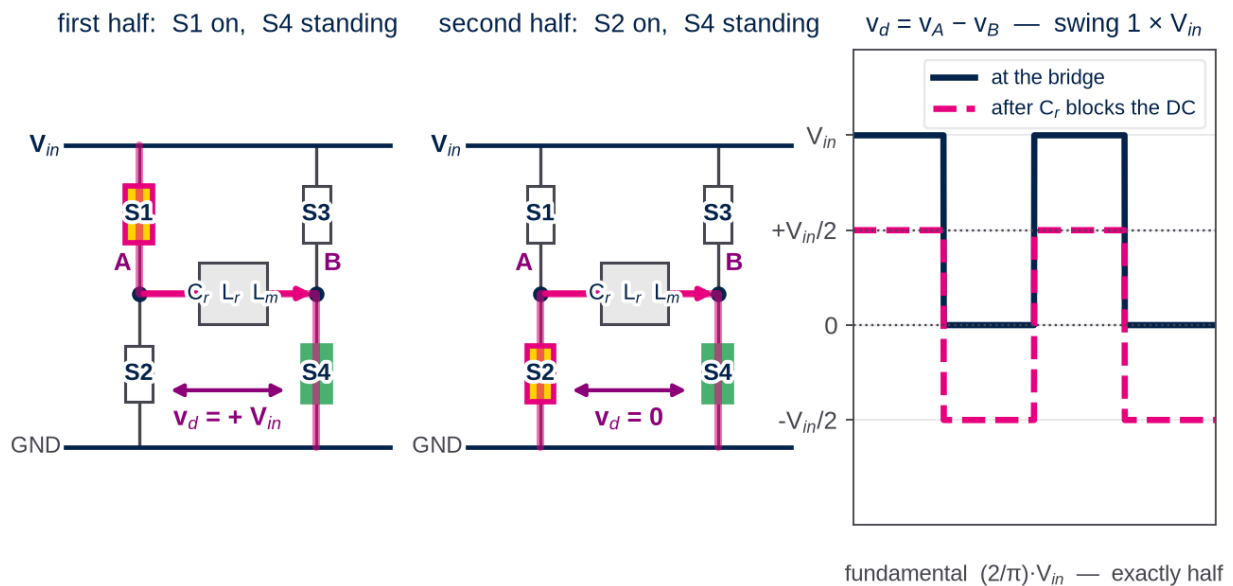


Figure 28: Half bridge: leg 2 stops switching, and  $C_r$  removes the dc that the asymmetric drive creates.

**The standing device is the hottest one.** S4 never switches but conducts the full tank current continuously, and in this design it is the hottest single device (Section 7.14).

## 5.3 How the controller does it

Only leg 2 changes between the modes: HOUT2 stops and stays low, LOUT2 stops and stays high. The thresholds are **fixed inside the IC**;  $R_{CFG}$  only enables morphing and sets the brown-out threshold.

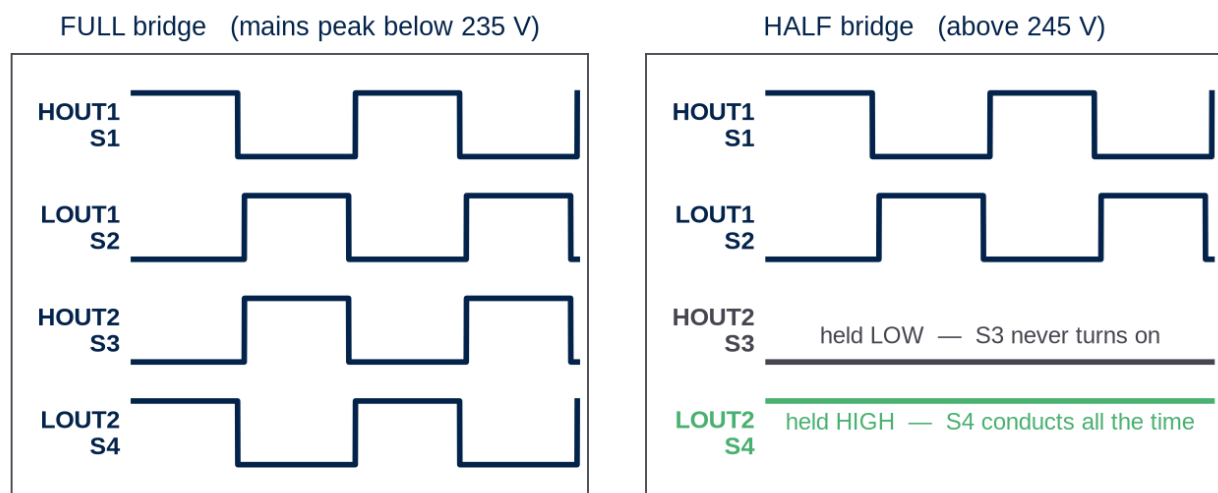


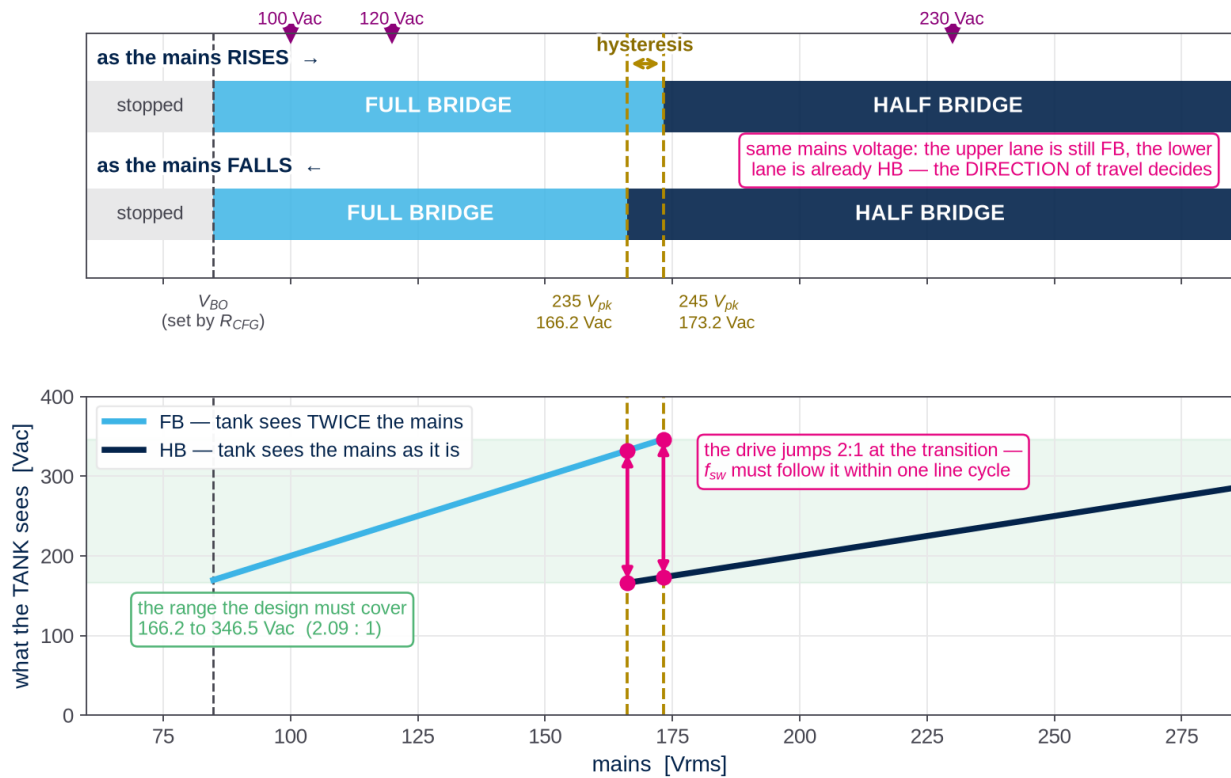
Figure 29: The four bridge drive signals in each mode. Holding LOUT2 high and HOUT2 low is the entire mechanism.

## 5.4 The hysteresis band, and the range it really implies

The part drops to half bridge at  $245 V_{pk}$  going up and returns to full bridge at  $235 V_{pk}$  coming down. The hysteresis stops toggling, but **between the two the mode depends on the direction of travel**, not on the voltage.

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Taking each threshold where its mode is guaranteed gives 173.2 to 332.3 Vac (1.92:1). Including the band gives **166.2 to 346.5 Vac (2.09:1)**. This design passes at the wider range too; do not use the narrower figure when tightening a specification.

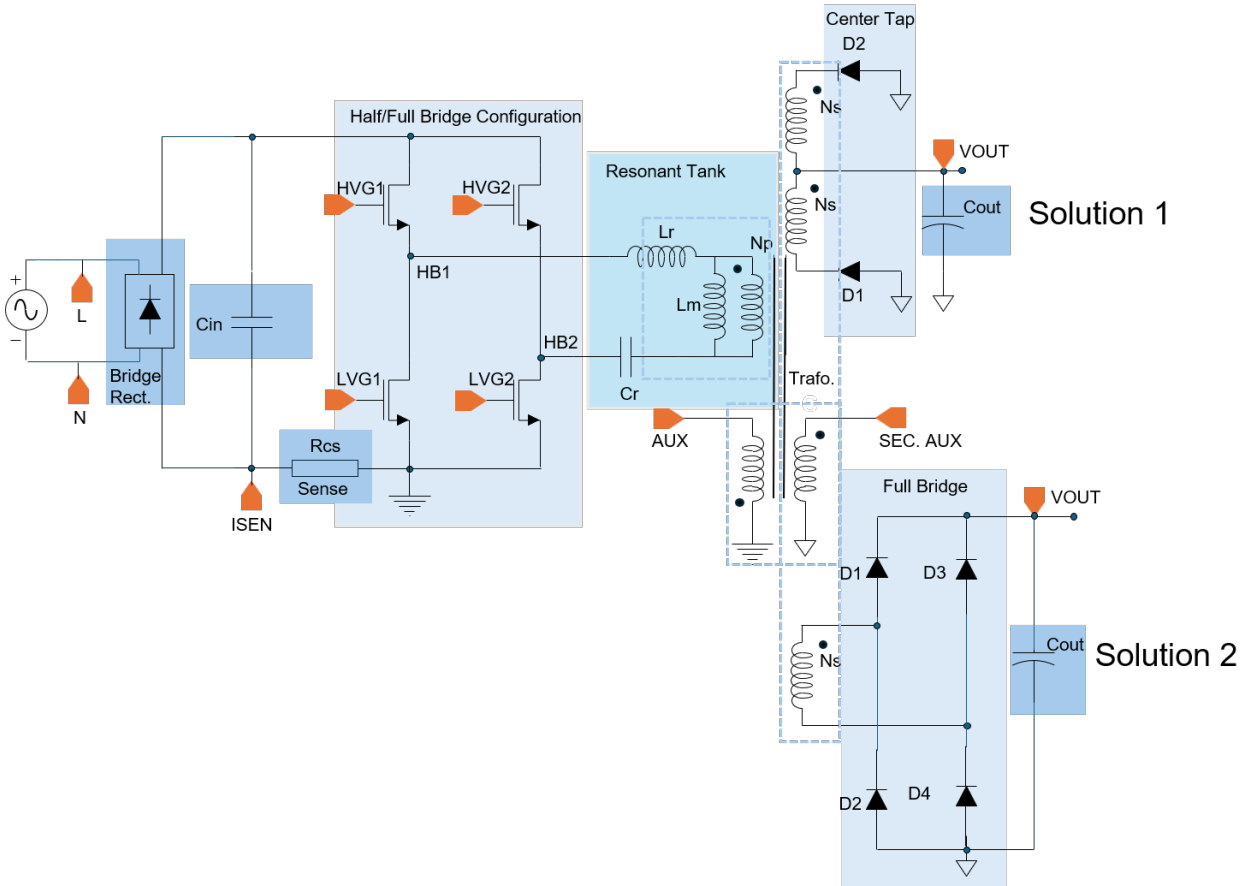


**Figure 30: Where each mode applies. Inside the band the mode depends on which direction the mains arrived from.  $V_{BO}$  is the brown-out threshold, set by  $R_{CFG}$  (Section 7.21).**

No nominal mains voltage lies in 166 to 173 Vrms; the band is met in sags, on a programmable ac source and in dip and surge tests. Test it with a **step** across the threshold, not a ramp.

**Transition transient.** Crossing a threshold changes the drive 2:1 within one line cycle, against a loop that crosses in the tens of hertz, so the output dips (going up) or overshoots (coming down) until the loop recovers. The dip is less severe than hold-up, which is already met, so it is no reason to enlarge  $C_{out}$ ; neither has been checked in the time domain.

## 6 Design procedure



**Figure 31: The power stage. The bridge rectifier feeds the leg pair directly: no bulk capacitor, no boost stage. The secondary is drawn as centre tap (Solution 1) and full bridge (Solution 2). Drawing from the ST L6790A design spreadsheet.**

Pick the secondary first: it sets  $N_{rect}$ , and  $N_{rect}$  sets the reflected voltage. A centre tap has one device in the conduction path, a full bridge two, so at a low output voltage the centre tap halves the rectifier conduction loss at the price of twice the reverse voltage per device. This design uses the centre tap. The steps below are in dependency order.

### 6.1 The specification

The full specification is in Section 7.1. Two qualifiers apply to every step: **the worst line frequency is the lowest**, and **hold-up is specified at the ripple trough**.

### 6.2 The equivalent input range

With morphing the tank does not see 90 to 264 Vac. It sees an **equivalent** input given by the bridge mode:

**Equation 18**

$$V_{ac,eq} = 2 V_{ac} \quad (\text{full bridge}) \quad V_{ac,eq} = V_{ac} \quad (\text{half bridge})$$

At the half-bridge edge ( $245 V_{pk}$ ) the tank sees 173.2 Vac; at the full-bridge edge ( $235 V_{pk}$ ) it sees 332.3 Vac. **These edges are the design corners**: the low one for gain and ZVS, the high one for switching frequency. The

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mains voltages a supply actually meets map onto the same axis: 90 and 110 Vac in full bridge become 180 and 220 Vac equivalent, 230 and 264 Vac in half bridge stay 230 and 264. All four lie inside the two edges, and this note reports at all six conditions.

## 6.3 Turns ratio and reflected voltage

The turns ratio appears only multiplied by the effective output voltage, so what matters is the **reflected voltage**  $V_{refl}$ :

**Equation 19**

$$V_{refl} = n V_{o, eff} = n(V_{out} + N_{rect} V_f)$$

$V_f$  is the forward drop of one rectifier and  $N_{rect}$  the number in the conduction path.  $n$  is the model ratio in the gain equation;  $n_T$  is the wound ratio with the leakage folded into  $L_r$ . At  $\lambda \approx 0.5$  they differ by more than 20 % (Section 6.9), so the drawing must carry open- and short-circuit inductance as well as turns.

## 6.4 The resonant tank

The equivalent ac load resistance for a centre-tapped secondary, evaluated at the line peak, is

**Equation 20**

$$R_{ac} = \frac{4}{\pi^2} \frac{n^2 V_{o, eff}^2}{P_{in, LLC}}$$

with  $P_{in, LLC}$  the power into the resonant stage. The usual LLC form writes  $8/\pi^2$  with the one output power a two-stage converter has. Here the drawn power is  $2P \sin^2 \theta$ , so  $R_{ac}$  is pinned to the line peak, where  $p = 2P$ : the 8 becomes a 4, and  $Q$  means the quality factor at the peak, with  $Q(\theta) = Q_{pk} \sin^2 \theta$  elsewhere. Using the two-stage value understates the loading by two.

The gain requirement at the low corner and the ZVS requirement cap the quality factor at  $Q_{ZVS}$ .  $R_{ac} Q_{ZVS}$  is the impedance the tank is sized from: it fixes  $C_r$  through Equations 1 and 2, and  $C_r$  with  $f_r$  fixes  $L_r$ . Three rules matter more than the arithmetic:

- The three calculated figures are not one tank.  $L_r$  is whatever pairs with the **selected**  $C_r$ , and the  $L_m$  figure is  $L_r$  over the  $\lambda$  that *no load at the high corner* asks for, a condition a design may knowingly not meet (Section 4.10). It is not a value to round towards.
- **A larger  $L_m$  costs ZVS margin.** It lowers  $\lambda$  and the magnetising current that swings the node.  $C_r$  above and  $L_m$  below their calculated values do the opposite.
- **Stay below the  $Q_{ZVS}$  cap.** That gap is most of the ZVS margin. Choose  $L_m$  with  $n$  so that  $n_T = n\sqrt{(1+\lambda_{act})}$  is a ratio that can be wound.

## 6.5 ZVS verification

The closed-form ZVS estimate in most guides is a fitted approximation at the design  $Q_{ZVS}$ , not at the  $Q$  the converter runs at. Against a full sweep it is off by tens of per cent, and nothing in it guarantees which way; optimistic is the dangerous direction.

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The shortcut is written with a bare  $\lambda$  and means the *design*  $\lambda$ . Read it with  $\lambda_{act}$  and the phase can come out **negative** for a tank well inside the inductive region. The sweep has no such ambiguity.

Sweep  $\theta$ , input voltage and load with the **selected** tank and take the minimum. Section 7.5 does it for this design; the worst point is not where one would expect.

## 6.6 Which side of resonance the converter runs on

Below  $f_r$  the secondary current is a full resonant half sine followed by the freewheeling interval, and the conduction ratio  $d = f_{sw}/f_r$  is less than one; above  $f_r$  the half sine is cut short and  $d$  clamps at one. The rms figures behind ratings and losses contain  $d$ .

**The turns ratio decides the side.**  $M_{req} = 2nV_{o,eff}/(\sqrt{2} V_{ac,eq})$ , so a larger  $n$  asks for more gain and sits further below resonance. Two candidate transformers on the same tank can end up on opposite sides of  $f_r$  at the same mains voltage.

Settle this before the transformer is ordered: below resonance the rectifiers turn off at zero current, above it they do not.

## 6.7 Currents over the line cycle

Ratings come from the worst switching cycle; losses from the line-cycle rms. Two further rules:

- The primary devices and the sense resistor see the **composite** tank current: reflected load current plus magnetising current. Its peak is neither the sum nor the larger of the two peaks, because they occur at different instants.
- Below resonance the secondary conducts for  $d$  of each half period. The rms is the pulse peak times  $\sqrt{d}$ ; omitting  $d$  over-estimates it, and the loss by its square. Section 7.8 draws the composite current of this design.

## 6.8 The transformer

The tank fixed  $L_r$ ,  $L_m$  and a ratio; the transformer has turns, an open-circuit inductance and a leakage. **Two turns ratios and two inductances carry almost the same names**, and that is where most errors are made. This section turns Section 2.12 into numbers a supplier can measure.

Every number on the drawing is read off the primary current, the current in each secondary winding, the secondary winding voltage, or one bench test. Figure 43 marks where on this design's waveforms; Table 4 says what each mark sets.

| Mark | Item                 | Read from — and over what                                                                                                                                      | What it sets                                                                    |
|------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Primary peak current | Top of $i_p$ : the half sine of load current riding on the magnetising ramp. Worst switching cycle: line peak, minimum equivalent input, full load.            | Primary switch and OCP1 headroom. <b>Not</b> the saturation test.               |
| 2    | Primary rms current  | $i_p^2$ averaged over the whole switching period, then over the line half cycle. With $N_x$ units each carries all of it: the primaries are in series.         | Primary copper: $A_{cu} = I_{rms}/J$ per unit                                   |
| 3    | Magnetising peak     | The dashed $i_{Lm}$ at the switching instant. Below resonance it depends on neither $f_{sw}$ nor load, only on $V_{o,eff}$ , so it is the same on every cycle. | The peak flux; and, scaled to $V_{OVP2}$ , the DC-overlap test current (mark 7) |

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| Mark | Item                                | Read from — and over what                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | What it sets                                                      |
|------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4    | Secondary peak current              | Top of the pulse in either secondary winding, same worst cycle. With $N_x$ units each carries $1/N_x$ of the rectifier-leg value: the secondaries are in parallel.                                                                                                                                           | Rectifier peak rating; the foil termination                       |
| 5    | Secondary rms current, each winding | One pulse per period in each winding, so the rms is taken over the whole period with the idle half counted, then over the line half cycle.                                                                                                                                                                   | Secondary copper: $A_{cu} = I_{rms}/J$ , per winding and per unit |
| 6    | Winding volt-seconds                | The secondary winding voltage is $V_{o,eff}$ for the resonant half period $T_r/2$ while the rectifier conducts. That area is the flux swing $2N_s A_e B_{pk}$ ; $f_r$ is the worst case because the interval never gets longer than $T_r/2$ .                                                                | Core area and $N_s$ : $A_e \geq V_{o,eff}/(4 f_r N_s B_{max})$    |
| 7    | DC-overlap (saturation) test        | Not a waveform. LCR meter across the primary NP1, every other winding open (secondaries NS2 and NS3, auxiliary NAUX); a dc current overlapped on the primary and the primary inductance read against it. The test current is mark 3 scaled to the highest output the controller allows, $V_{OVP2}/V_{out}$ . | Core saturation margin; the number the supplier tests to          |
| —    | $L_{open}$ , $L_{short}$            | LCR meter across NP1 at 100 kHz, 1 V. $L_{open}$ : every other winding open. $L_{short}$ : NS2 and NS3 both shorted, NAUX open. Terminal quantities, so a supplier can test them.                                                                                                                            | $L_m + L_r$ and $L_r$ : the tank itself                           |

**Table 4: What each mark in the figure sets. Currents are per unit: for one transformer that is the whole part; split into  $N_x$  units (Section 6.21), the primaries are in series and the secondaries in parallel.**

## 6.9 Two ratios, two inductances

With all leakage referred to the primary the tank sees an ideal transformer of ratio  $n$ , a series  $L_r$  and a shunt  $L_m$ . That  $n$  is **not** the wound ratio. With  $k$  the coupling coefficient,

### Equation 21

$$n = k n_T, \quad k = \sqrt{\frac{L_m}{L_m + L_r}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + \lambda}}$$

so  $n_T = n\sqrt{1+\lambda}$ : more than 20 % apart at  $\lambda \approx 0.5$ , far more than any gain margin.

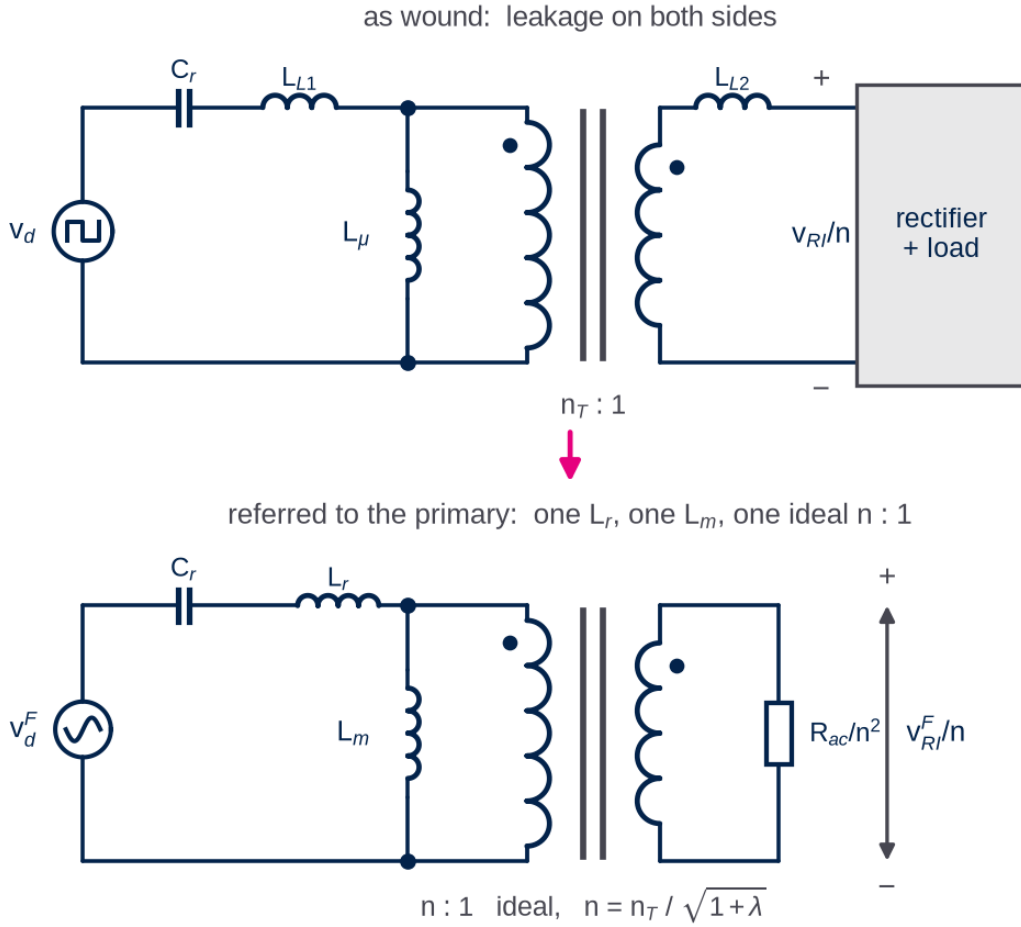
The inductances split the same way. The tank model uses  $L_r$  and  $L_m$ ; the physical transformer has a magnetising inductance  $L_\mu$  with leakage on both sides:

### Equation 22

$$L_\mu = \sqrt{L_m(L_m + L_r)}, \quad L_{L1} = L_m + L_r - L_\mu, \quad L_{L2} = \frac{L_{L1}}{n_T^2}$$

with  $L_{L1}$  the primary leakage and  $L_{L2}$  the secondary leakage, each on its own side of the ratio.

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**Figure 32:** The same transformer drawn both ways. Above, as wound: leakage on both sides, the physical  $L_\mu$  in shunt, ratio  $n_T : 1$ , driven by  $v_d$ . Below, referred to the primary and driven by the fundamental of  $v_d$ : one  $L_r$ , one  $L_m$ , ratio  $n : 1$ . Neither the shunt elements nor the ratios are the same numbers.

The as-wound form ( $L_{L1}$ ,  $L_\mu$ ,  $L_{L2}$ ) assumes the leakage splits evenly. The real split does not matter: the tank sees only the two quantities a meter can read.

### 6.10 What the transformer specification must say

Only two inductances are measurable at the terminals, and they are the two the tank needs:

#### Equation 23

$$L_{open} = L_\mu + L_{L1} = L_m + L_r, \quad L_{short} = L_{L1} + \frac{L_\mu n_T^2 L_{L2}}{L_\mu + n_T^2 L_{L2}} = L_r$$

Both are read across the primary.  $L_{open}$ : every other winding open.  $L_{short}$ : every secondary shorted (on a centre-tapped part both halves), the auxiliary open. **Specify those two and the turns, never  $L_\mu$** : no terminal pair exposes it. State the turns as numbers, because with one or two secondary turns the lead-out loop dominates that winding's inductance, and the root of the open-circuit inductances read at the primary and at one secondary,

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$\sqrt{L_1/L_2}$ , does not give the ratio.

## 6.11 Peak flux is set by the secondary, not the primary

Mark **6** of Figure 43: the secondary winding voltage is a rectangle of height  $V_{o,eff}$  and width  $T_r/2$ , and the flux swings  $\pm B_{pk}$  across it. Above resonance the secondary conducts for a shorter switching half period, so  $f_r$  is the worst case everywhere on the line cycle:

Equation 24

$$B_{pk} = \frac{V_{o,eff}}{4f_r N_s A_e} \implies A_e \geq \frac{V_{o,eff}}{4f_r N_s B_{max}}$$

**$N_p$  does not appear.** Only secondary turns reduce the flux. For a low-voltage, high-current output, where the secondary wants to be one turn, halving  $N_s$  doubles the core area.

From an inductance the same flux is  $B_{pk} = L_{\mu} i_{\mu,pk} / (N_p A_e)$  with the **physical**  $L_{\mu}$ . Using the tank  $L_m$  understates it by  $\sqrt{(1+\lambda)}$ .

## 6.12 Choosing the core: two areas, and the one that usually decides

A core must satisfy two independent conditions: enough cross-section  $A_e$  for the flux at the chosen turns, and enough window  $A_N$  for the copper. Their product is the **area product**, and either can bind.

**Check the flux against  $A_{min}$ , not  $A_e$ .** The narrowest section saturates first: the real peak is  $B_{pk} A_e / A_{min}$ .

In a single-stage PFC LLC **a third condition normally decides**: the leakage must come out at  $L_r$ . As a fraction of what a meter reads,

Equation 25

$$\frac{L_{short}}{L_{open}} = \frac{L_r}{L_m + L_r} = \frac{\lambda}{1 + \lambda}$$

At  $\lambda \approx 0.5$  that is **about a third**. A conventional transformer leaks a few per cent; this one must leak ten times more, on purpose. Leakage that large is a winding **geometry**, and geometry costs window. A core that passes on  $A_e$  and copper can still fail here.

## 6.13 The winding arrangement is the leakage

Leakage is set by how the windings are arranged and how far apart they sit:

- **Interleaved** (primary, secondary, primary): one or two per cent. What a forward or flyback transformer wants; the opposite of what is needed here.
- **Concentric, not interleaved**: a few per cent. Still short.
- **Side by side**, primary on one half of the width and secondary on the other: tens of per cent, adjustable by the gap between them. **This is what a single-stage tank asks for**, and why the window must be generous.
- **A magnetic shunt** in the window: leakage without winding width, at the cost of a part and a harder tolerance.

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The usual transformer advice is to interleave. Here  $L_r$  is a design value, and a supplier who “improves” the coupling breaks the converter. Say so on the drawing, next to  $L_{\text{short}}$ .

## 6.14 The gap, and why the drawing must not name it

$L_m$  is far below what an ungapped core gives, so the core is gapped:

Equation 26

$$A_L = \frac{L_{\text{open}}/N_x}{N_p^2} \quad g \approx \frac{\mu_0 A_e}{A_L}$$

with  $N_x$  the number of units in the assembly (1 for a single transformer; Section 6.21),  $g$  the total centre-leg gap and  $\mu_0$  the permeability of free space. The gap expression ignores fringing, which makes the gap actually needed larger. **Specify  $A_L$ , or better  $L_{\text{open}}$ , and leave the gap to the supplier:** that is what they grind to and what a meter can check.

## 6.15 The window: wire, current density and what actually fits

Marks **2** and **5** of Figure 43. Copper is sized on the **line-cycle** rms: the rms of each switching period, averaged in  $I^2$  over the line half cycle. The secondary value is per winding and per unit, with the idle half inside the average.

Each winding needs a copper area set by its rms current and the current density the design can cool:

Equation 27

$$A_{cu} = \frac{I_{rms}}{J} \quad \sum_w N_w A_{cu,w} \leq k_u A_N$$

with  $N_w$  the turns of winding  $w$  and  $A_{cu,w}$  its copper area.  $J$  is an assumption: 4 to 5 A/mm<sup>2</sup> in free air, less enclosed.  $k_u$ , the window utilisation, is **0.3 or less** with Litz wire once insulation, bobbin wall, margins and tape are counted. Sizing on bare copper overstates what fits by three times.

Split into  $N_x$  units (Section 6.21), every unit carries the whole primary current, because the primaries are in series; only the secondaries share. That is why splitting helps a low-voltage, high-current output.

## 6.16 Skin depth, and why the wire is not a wire

At the switching frequency current crowds into a surface layer of depth

Equation 28

$$\delta = \sqrt{\frac{\rho}{\pi f \mu_0}}$$

with  $\rho$  the resistivity of copper at the winding temperature and  $f$  the frequency it carries, here  $f_r$ . Copper deeper than  $\delta$  below the surface carries little current, so a conductor thicker than  $2\delta$  gains little. The field from the other turns also drives circulating current in each conductor (the proximity effect), and in a side-by-side winding that term can dominate.

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So a winding is not one wire. This note uses both ways out:

- **Litz wire** on the primary: a bundle of many fine wires, twisted so that each takes a turn at every position, and each insulated by its own enamel. One fine wire is a **strand**;  $d_s$  is its diameter and  $a_s$  its copper cross-section. The rule is  $d_s \leq 2\delta$  **per strand**.
- **Copper foil** on a low-voltage, high-current secondary: thickness  $t_f$  near  $\delta$ , width does the carrying. It also terminates well into a centre tap.
- The ac resistance heats the winding; the dc resistance is a floor, not an answer.

**Litz.** Pick a standard strand at or below  $2\delta$ ; the strand count is the copper needed over what one strand gives:

**Equation 29**

$$a_s = \frac{\pi d_s^2}{4}, \quad n_s = \left\lceil \frac{A_{cu}}{a_s} \right\rceil$$

with  $A_{cu}$  from Equation 27. The bundle is wider than its copper: gaps between round strands, enamel and serving are collected into a fill factor  $k_{litz}$  of about 0.5 to 0.6, and the outside diameter is

**Equation 30**

$$d_{litz} = \sqrt{\frac{4A_{cu}}{\pi k_{litz}}}$$

**Foil.** Choose the thickness from the skin depth and what the supplier stocks; the width follows. If it exceeds the bobbin width, use several narrower strips in parallel, stacked radially:

**Equation 31**

$$w_f = \frac{A_{cu}}{t_f}, \quad n_f = \left\lceil \frac{w_f}{w_{f,max}} \right\rceil$$

## 6.17 Isolation, margins and what they cost in window

The transformer is the isolation barrier. **Margin tape** leaves a creepage margin at each end of the bobbin, typically 3 mm a side for reinforced isolation from universal mains, so 6 mm of winding width is lost. **Triple-insulated wire** needs no margin but is thicker for the same copper and costs more.

On a side-by-side winding the width is spent twice: on the isolation margin and on the gap that sets the leakage. Budget both.

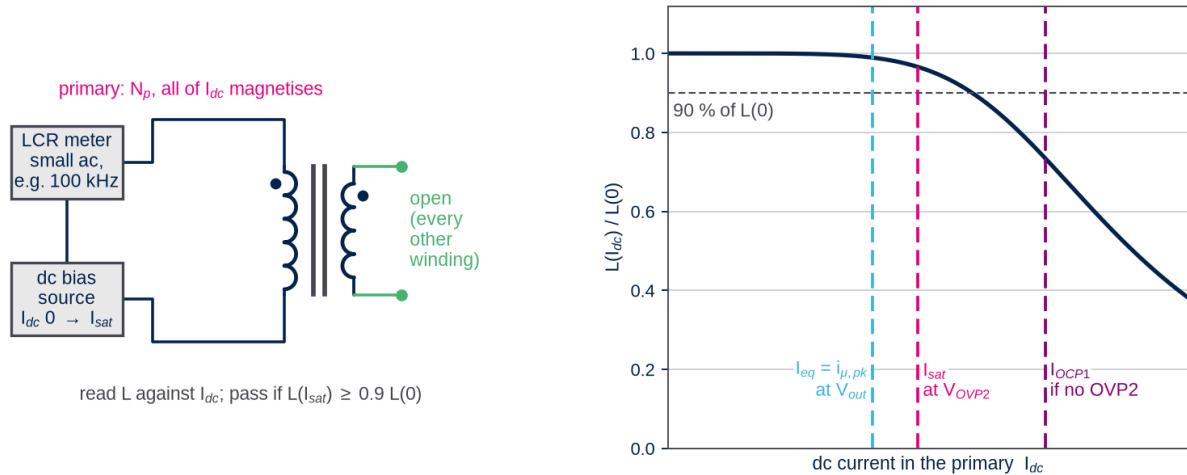
## 6.18 Loss, and the temperature the drawing has to survive

- **Core loss** comes off the material curve at the operating flux and frequency, not off the headline figure. The flux is fixed below resonance, so the worst loss is near  $f_r$ , the top of the sweep below resonance; above it the flux falls as  $1/f_{sw}$ .
- **Copper loss** is  $I^2 R_{ac}$  for both windings, and in a side-by-side arrangement the proximity term is not small.
- **Temperature rise** is what limits the design, and it depends on surface area and airflow. The computed loss is an input to a thermal measurement, not an answer.

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## 6.19 The saturation test is not the peak winding current

**What the line on the specification says.** A transformer specification usually carries a line of the form “DC overlap: inductance more than 90 % of initial, test current  $I_{sat}$ , normal temperature”. The name is the measurement. An LCR meter reads the primary inductance with a small ac signal (100 kHz, 1 V is a common setting, the same one the leakage test uses) while a bias source overlaps a dc current on the same winding; every other winding is open. The dc current is stepped up and the inductance is read at each step. The same test is called dc bias or dc superposition.



**Figure 33: The DC-overlap test. Left: the bench. Right: inductance against the dc current, an illustrative shape, with this design's three currents marked: the operating magnetising peak, the test current the specification asks for, and the current that would have to be used if the controller had no voltage ceiling.**

**What it reveals.** With the other windings open the dc current alone sets the flux, so the inductance stays flat while the core is linear and falls as the core approaches saturation; the 90 % point marks the knee. It is the only test at the terminals that reads the flux margin. Turns and  $A_L$  do not: the same  $A_L$  comes from a different gap, a different  $A_{min}$  or a different material, and  $L_{open}$  confirms the inductance, not the margin. A part with the right  $L_{open}$  and the wrong core is caught here and nowhere else.

**Which current to write on the line.** Mark 3 and the bench panel of Figure 43. The current to ask for is the peak of the magnetising trace, scaled to the over-voltage ceiling, not the peak winding current at mark 1.

In the test nothing cancels the primary ampere-turns, so the same current makes far more flux than in operation. Ask for the current that reproduces the operating flux in that test:

### Equation 32

$$I_{eq} = \frac{B_{pk} N_p A_e}{L_{\mu}}$$

**The denominator is  $L_{\mu}$ , not  $L_{open}$ :** the primary leakage links no core. Dividing by  $L_{open}$  understates the current by a factor  $\sqrt{(1+\lambda)}$ . A free check: the answer **must** equal  $i_{\mu, pk}$ .

Testing at the peak tank current would ask for a flux the converter never produces. No arbitrary margin is wanted on  $I_{eq}$  either: the flux ceiling is already defined by the highest output the controller allows before it shuts down.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

**Why the ceiling is OVP2.** Write the same peak flux twice: from the volt-seconds the clamped secondary applies (Equation 24), and from the current that magnetises the core (Equation 32).  $A_e$  cancels:

**Equation 33**

$$B_{pk} = \frac{V_{o,eff}}{4f_r N_s A_e} = \frac{L_\mu i_{\mu,pk}}{N_p A_e} \implies i_{\mu,pk} = \frac{n_T V_{o,eff}}{4f_r L_\mu}$$

with  $n_T = N_p/N_s$ . Nothing that the load or the input sets is left in it. Below resonance the secondary is clamped for  $T_r/2$  whatever  $f_{sw}$  is; above resonance for less, so the flux is lower. **The magnetising peak, and the flux with it, is proportional to the output voltage and to nothing else in operation.** The worst case is therefore the highest output voltage at which the bridge is still switching.

The L6790A has two levels on the ZCD pin. At OVP1 (2.3 V on the pin) it keeps switching at reduced power, so the output can sit between OVP1 and OVP2 with the transformer still driven. At OVP2 (2.5 V) it stops switching for 100 ms and restarts with a soft start. While the core is driven, the output therefore stays at or below  $V_{OVP2}$ , and Equation 33 gives the largest magnetising peak the core ever carries.

On the bench every other winding is open, so the dc current is the only ampere-turns on the core and makes  $B = L_\mu I_{dc}/(N_p A_e)$ , the same relation as in operation. The test current that reproduces the flux at OVP2 is the magnetising peak scaled by the voltage ratio, and the ratio of the two voltages is the whole margin. No arbitrary factor goes on top of it:

**Equation 34**

$$I_{sat} = I_{eq} \frac{V_{OVP2}}{V_{out}}$$

With  $V_f = 0$  this is the exact flux ratio. With a rectifier drop the flux ratio is  $(V_{OVP2} + N_{rect} V_f)/(V_{out} + N_{rect} V_f)$ , a little smaller, so Equation 34 errs on the safe side.

Overload, start-up, burst mode and the switching frequency do not raise the flux (Section 2.12); an output over-voltage does, and temperature lowers the ceiling.  $B_s$  of a MnZn power ferrite falls by about a fifth between 25 and 100 °C, so a test made at normal temperature is read against the material's hot  $B_s$ , and the design flux at OVP2 has to sit under it with margin. The 90 % criterion is that margin.

**If the controller has no OVP2-like ceiling.** Then something else has to bound the output voltage, and the specification follows whichever bound exists.

- **A protection that stops the drive**, on either side of the barrier: a secondary crowbar or latch, an SR-controller OVP, a primary OVP that latches. Use its threshold in place of  $V_{OVP2}$ .
- **A protection that only reduces power**, like OVP1, is not a ceiling: the output can rest at it while the core is driven. Do not use it.
- **No voltage ceiling at all.** The output is then bounded only by what the tank can deliver at the oscillator floor into the lightest load, and with the floor near  $f_o$  that bound is not useful. What remains is the current limit: with nothing clamping the secondary the primary current is the magnetising current, so the core must not saturate at the largest current the controller ever lets through the primary,  $I_{sat} = I_{OCP1}$ . Safe, and expensive; Section 7.12 gives the ratio for this design.
- **The rule of thumb**, 1.2 to 1.5 times  $i_{\mu,pk}$  or the winding peak at normal temperature, is what a specification carries when nobody asked the question. It names no event, so it is neither safe nor economical. Replace it with one of the three above.

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## 6.20 The specification, and what it is not allowed to leave out

**Check the open-circuit inductance tolerance against the frequency floor.**  $f_o$  goes as  $1/\sqrt{L_{open}}$ , so a low part raises  $f_o$  towards the oscillator floor  $f_{Min}$ ; unless the floor margin covers the fall, a part that meets  $\pm 10\%$  can hard switch. Section 6.25 gives the check.

Core, bobbin, wire and winding order are the supplier's choice; insulation and creepage follow the safety standard. Everything above is measurable at the terminals.

## 6.21 If one transformer is not practical

At low voltage and high current the secondary is one heavy turn and the core comes out large. The transformer can then be built as  $N_x$  identical units with **primaries in series and secondaries in parallel**; series primaries carry the same current, so the secondaries share without balancing resistors.

- Open-circuit and leakage inductance divide by  $N_x$ , and so do the secondary currents. **The primary current does not.**
- The DC-overlap test current does not change.
- The wound ratio becomes  $N_x N_p / N_s$ , so **achievable ratios are quantised in steps of  $N_x / N_s$** . Respect that when the tank is chosen.

## 6.22 The input capacitor

$C_{in}$  is a film capacitor that absorbs switching ripple only. It has a floor, the ST rule of thumb that the evaluation board also follows:

### Equation 35

$$C_{in} = 3 \frac{nF}{W} \times P_{in}$$

That is a **lower** bound; round up to the next standard value and rate it for the full input voltage. Do not go far above it: a large value holds charge across the zero crossing and distorts the line current, so it is a THD term.

## 6.23 The output capacitor bank

Two conditions apply, and the larger wins. The ripple condition is

### Equation 36

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{P_{out}}{2\pi f_{l,min} \Delta v V_{out}^2}$$

and the hold-up condition is

### Equation 37

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{2P_{out}T_{hold}}{\left(V_{out} - \frac{1}{2}\Delta v_{pp}\right)^2 - V_{o,min}^2}$$

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**Hold-up starts at the worst line phase.** If the mains fails at the ripple trough the bank is already half a ripple down, hence the  $-\frac{1}{2}\Delta v_{pp}$  term; it shortens the ride-out.  $\Delta v_{pp}$  is the ripple the bank produces, not the allowance, so this is checked once the bank is chosen.

Both conditions scale as  $1/V_{out}^2$ , so which wins depends only on the specification. With  $k = V_{o,min}/V_{out}$ , ripple dominates when

## Equation 38

$$\left(1 - \frac{\Delta v}{2}\right)^2 - k^2 > 4\pi f_l \Delta v T_{hold}$$

using the *allowed*  $\Delta v$ , since it is asked before the bank exists. Section 7.13 evaluates it.

- Include the  **$2f_l$  component** in the ripple current; it is comparable to the switching part and adds in quadrature.
- With a centre-tapped secondary, judge capacitor ripple current at the **output node**, not per winding.
- Use the ESR at the frequency of each current component: the **switching-frequency** ESR for the switching part, the **120 Hz** figure from  $\tan\delta$  for the  $2f_l$  part. Here the two parts are of similar size.

The controller start-up window is finite and this bank is a far heavier start-up load than a conventional design. Cold start into the full bank should be measured early.

## 6.24 Semiconductor requirements

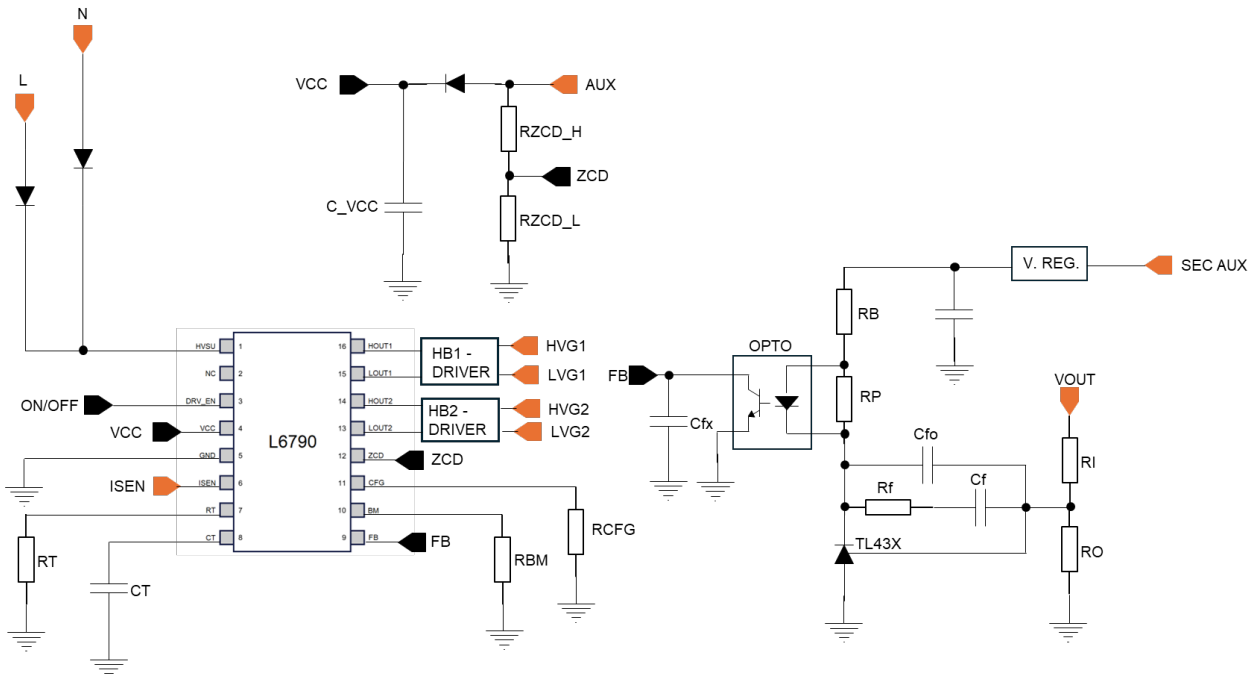
State requirements rather than pick parts. Four rules:

- Rate the primary switches on the **composite tank peak**; the load component alone under-rates them.
- Divide by the number of devices in parallel. Tabulated currents are **per switch position** on the primary and **per leg** on the secondary; a centre-tapped leg carries the whole secondary current.
- Compute loss from  $R_{DS(on)}$  at  $T_{j,max}$ . The datasheet maximum is 25 °C process spread; temperature is a separate multiplier, about two for a superjunction device.
- A curve against  $T_a$  may be read as  $T_j$  **only if it is a pulse test**.

The standing device in half-bridge morphing (Section 5.2) never switches and carries the whole tank current; Section 7.14 shows what that cost here.

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## 6.25 Controller network



**Figure 34: The controller and its passive network.** HVSU is fed from the AC side of the bridge; the auxiliary winding drives ZCD through a divider;  $R_T$  and  $C_T$  set the oscillator limits;  $R_{CFG}$  and  $R_{BM}$  are read at power-up. The drawing also feeds  $V_{CC}$  from the auxiliary winding through a diode; the worked design does not, and takes  $V_{CC}$  from an external rail (Section 7.23). Drawing from the ST L6790A design spreadsheet.

Decide first what the auxiliary winding is for. If it supplies  $V_{CC}$ , its voltage at OVP2 must stay under the  $V_{CC}$  rating, which caps its ratio. Here  $V_{CC}$  comes from elsewhere, so the winding only senses and the only constraint is whole turns (Section 7.22).

Section 7.17 sizes the parts in order.  $R_T$  deserves the most attention: it sets the oscillator floor, and that floor must stay above  $f_o$ .

**That floor is usually the thinnest margin.** It also depends on the oscillator idle time, which the draft datasheet states inconsistently, so it must be confirmed by measuring  $f_{sw}(\theta)$  on hardware.

The transformer tolerance must fit inside the same margin. A **low**  $L_{open}$  raises  $f_o$ ; the fall that can be tolerated is

### Equation 39

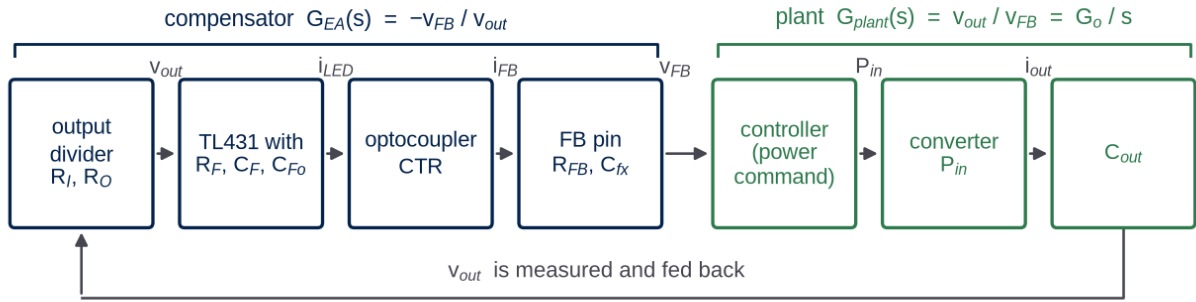
$$\frac{\Delta L}{L} = 1 - \frac{1}{k_{floor}^2}$$

with  $k_{floor} = f_{Min}/f_o$  the floor margin. A floor margin of only a few per cent allows a fall of only a few per cent, and then the usual  $\pm 10\%$  does **not** fit: at the bottom of the tolerance  $f_o$  rises above  $f_{Min}$  and the bridge can hard switch near the zero crossing. Either tighten the low-side tolerance or lower  $R_T$  to lift  $f_{Min}$ ; a higher floor widens the zero-crossing dead zone (Section 4.3). **Check before the transformer is ordered.**

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## 6.26 Voltage loop and compensation

The loop is the chain of Figure 35: a divider measures the output, a TL431 compares it with its reference and drives an optocoupler LED, the optocoupler transistor pulls the FB pin, the FB voltage commands power (Section 4.6), and that power goes into the output capacitor.



**Figure 35: The voltage loop as blocks. Everything left of the FB pin is the compensator  $G_{EA}(s)$ ; everything right of it is the plant  $G_{plant}(s)$ . The loop gain is  $T(s) = G_{plant}(s) G_{EA}(s)$ .**

**The plant.** The FB voltage sets the power, the power over the output voltage is the current into  $C_{out}$ , and a current into a capacitor integrates. In small signal, with  $v_{out}$  and  $v_{FB}$  the changes of  $V_{out}$  and  $V_{FB}$ :

**Equation 40**

$$G_{plant}(s) = \frac{v_{out}(s)}{v_{FB}(s)} = \frac{G_o}{s}, \quad G_o = \frac{P_{out}}{V_{out} V_{FB} C_{out}} \quad [\text{rad/s}]$$

$V_{FB}$  is the feedback voltage above its 0.5 V offset at rated power (Equation 15). An integrator falls at 20 dB per decade with  $-90^\circ$  everywhere and would cross 0 dB at  $f_{cto} = G_o / 2\pi$ . There is no second pole and no right-half-plane zero, so the loop is easy to stabilise. What makes it hard to place is the output ripple (Section 6.28).

The integrator assumes a load that draws constant power as the output moves, which a downstream converter does. A resistive load  $R_L$  draws less as the output falls, and in small signal the integrator becomes a pole at  $1/(\pi R_L C_{out})$ . Above that pole the plant is the same; below it the loop gain is lower, and at the crossover the phase is up to  $90^\circ$  less negative, so the integrator is the worst case for phase margin.

## 6.27 What the loop must achieve, and what goes wrong when it does not

Three numbers are read from the Bode plot of  $T(s)$ : the **crossover**  $f_c$  where  $|T| = 1$ , the **phase margin**  $180^\circ + \arg T$  at  $f_c$ , and the **gain margin**, how far  $|T|$  is below 0 dB at  $f_{180}$  where  $\arg T = -180^\circ$ . Table 5 gives the aims.

| Quantity        | Aim                                                                                                                                           | If it is too low                                                                                         | If it is too high                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Crossover $f_c$ | 15 to 20 Hz in this converter (Section 6.28). The general rules are below $f_{sw}/5$ and below the ripple frequency the loop must not follow. | The loop is slow. The output dips further and recovers later after a load step or a morphing transition. | The loop follows the $2f_l$ output ripple. The power command, and so the input current, is modulated at $2f_l$ ; third harmonic on the input current, and chatter across the burst threshold. |

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| Quantity              | Aim                                                                                                                                        | If it is too low                                                                                                                                                                                     | If it is too high                                                                                           |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Phase margin $\Phi_M$ | 45° is the floor; 50 to 60° is the target. At 76° the step response has no overshoot; at 45° it rings ( $Q \approx 1.2$ ) [onsemi TND381]. | Ringings after every disturbance. At 0° the loop oscillates at $f_c$ .                                                                                                                               | The response is over-damped and slow. Not a fault, but no longer free: the crossover has to drop to get it. |
| Gain margin GM        | 6 dB is the floor; 10 dB is comfortable.                                                                                                   | Part spread moves  T  up. The optocoupler CTR alone spreads by 2:1 over bins, current and temperature; a loop with a small gain margin oscillates at $f_{180}$ on a warm board with a high-CTR part. | —                                                                                                           |
| $G_{EA}$ at $2f_l$    | At or below the value that keeps the third harmonic inside its budget (Equation 43).                                                       | Nothing wrong with the loop; the crossover is lower than it needs to be.                                                                                                                             | Third harmonic above budget, burst chatter.                                                                 |

**Table 5: What the loop must achieve.**

## 6.28 Why the crossover must be low: the $2f_l$ ripple

The output ripple at  $2f_l$  (Section 3.1) has the peak-to-peak value

**Equation 41**

$$\Delta V_{loop} = \frac{P_{out}}{V_{out}} \frac{1}{2\pi f_l C_{out}}$$

The compensator passes a fraction  $G_{EA}(2f_l)$  of it to the FB pin, which is a power command, so the input current is modulated at  $2f_l$ . A sine modulated at twice its own frequency gains a third harmonic; a modulation of the command by  $m$  puts  $m/2$  into it, and the ripple amplitude is half the peak-to-peak, so

**Equation 42**

$$D_3 = \frac{G_{EA}(2f_l) \Delta V_{loop}}{4 V_{FB}}$$

Turned around, the third-harmonic budget fixes the largest compensator gain at  $2f_l$ :

**Equation 43**

$$G_{EA}(2f_l) \leq \frac{4 V_{FB} D_3}{\Delta V_{loop}}$$

A small gain at  $2f_l$  means a crossover well below it; with 5 % third harmonic allowed, 15 to 20 Hz. A faster loop would give less output ripple and a quicker load-step response, and more input distortion. The distortion limit wins. onsemi TND381 calls the failure “tail chasing”.

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 6.29 The compensator: TL431, optocoupler and the FB pin

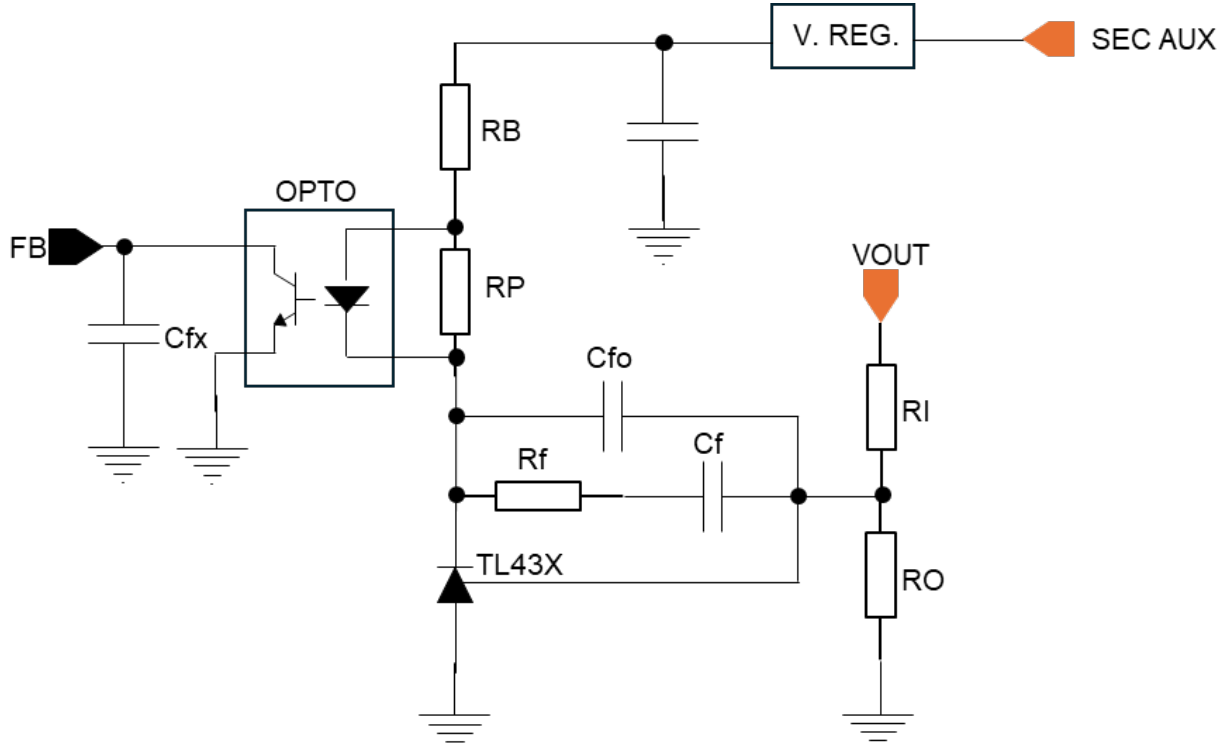


Figure 36: The compensator on the secondary side.  $R_I$  and  $R_O$  set the regulated output; the TL431 is the error amplifier;  $R_F$ ,  $C_F$  and  $C_{F0}$  ( $R_f$ ,  $C_f$ ,  $C_{fo}$  on the drawing) shape its gain;  $R_B$  feeds the optocoupler LED from the regulated  $V_Z$  rail;  $R_P$  keeps the TL431 above its minimum current;  $C_{fx}$  sits on the FB pin. Drawing from the ST L6790A design spreadsheet.

The divider  $R_I$ ,  $R_O$  brings the output down to the TL431 reference  $V_R = 2.495$  V:

### Equation 44

$$V_{out} = V_R \left( 1 + \frac{R_I}{R_O} \right)$$

When the output rises the TL431 sinks more cathode current through the LED, which  $R_B$  feeds from a regulated rail  $V_Z$ ; the optocoupler transistor pulls FB down against the internal pull-up  $R_{FB}$  and the power command falls.  $R_P$  across the LED carries the minimum cathode current the TL431 needs, so it has an upper limit:

### Equation 45

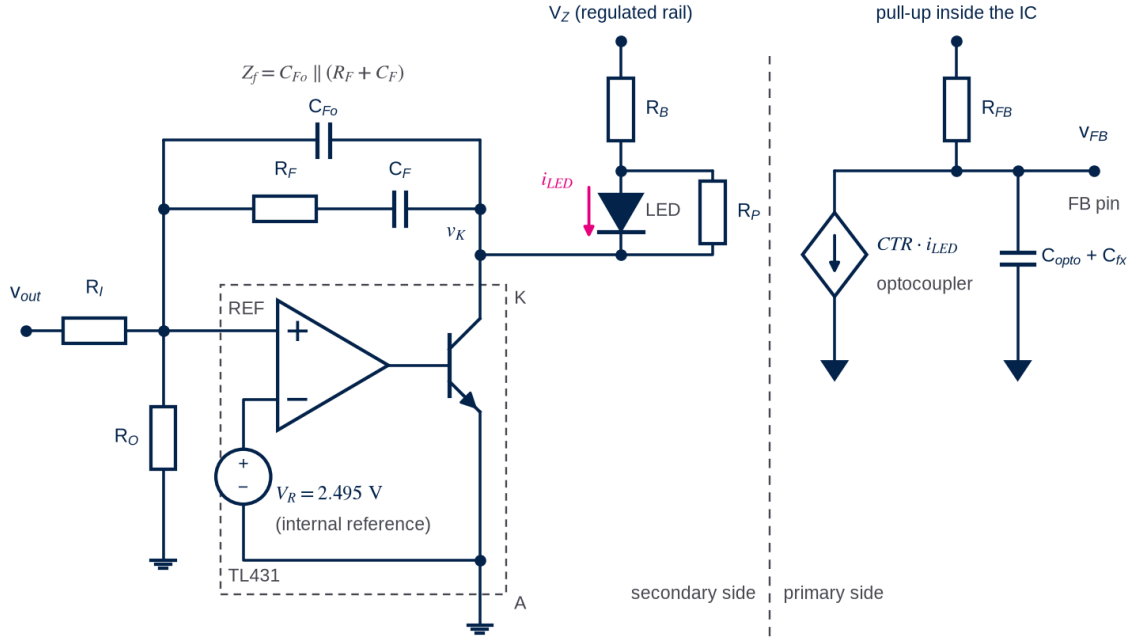
$$R_P \leq \frac{V_{Fo}}{I_{min}}$$

with  $V_{Fo}$  the LED forward voltage and  $I_{min}$  the least cathode current the TL431 needs. Because the LED is fed from  $V_Z$ , the output ripple reaches it only through the TL431: there is no second path (TND381's "fast lane").

**The same network as an op-amp.** Figure 37 redraws it. Inside the TL431 an amplifier compares REF with the internal  $V_R$  and drives an NPN whose collector is the cathode; the transistor inverts, so from REF to cathode the part is a high-gain inverting amplifier that holds REF at  $V_R$ .  $R_I$  is its input resistor and  $C_{F0}$  in parallel with  $R_F + C_F$  its feedback impedance  $Z_f$ , so the cathode moves by  $-Z_f/R_I$  times the output change;  $R_O$  sets only the dc point. The

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cathode current is the LED current, and the optocoupler transistor is a current-controlled current source sinking  $CTR i_{LED}$  from the FB node into  $R_{FB}$  with the pole of  $C_{opto} + C_{fx}$ . The three blocks multiply to a negative gain, which is the negative feedback.  $G_{EA}$  is written without that sign:  $G_{EA} = -v_{FB}/v_{out}$ .



$$\frac{v_K}{v_{out}} = -\frac{Z_f}{R_I}, \quad i_{LED} = -\frac{v_K}{R_B}, \quad v_{FB} = -CTR i_{LED} \left( R_{FB} \parallel \frac{1}{s(C_{opto} + C_{fx})} \right)$$

$R_O$  carries no signal: the REF input is held at  $V_R$

$$G_{EA}(s) = -\frac{v_{FB}}{v_{out}} = \frac{Z_f}{R_I} \cdot \frac{CTR R_{FB}}{R_B} \cdot \frac{1}{1 + s R_{FB}(C_{opto} + C_{fx})}$$

**Figure 37: The TL431 compensator as an op-amp circuit:**  $R_I$  and  $Z_f$  make an inverting amplifier;  $R_B$ ,  $R_P$  and the LED turn the cathode voltage into  $i_{LED}$ ; the optocoupler is a current source  $CTR i_{LED}$  into  $R_{FB}$  and  $C_{opto} + C_{fx}$ . The two sides return to different grounds across the isolation barrier.

Its transfer function from output to FB pin is a Type II network with one more pole:

**Equation 46**

$$G_{EA}(s) = \frac{EA_o}{s} \cdot \frac{1 + s/\omega_z}{(1 + s/\omega_p)(1 + s/\omega_{px})}$$

**Equation 47**

$$EA_o = \frac{CTR R_{FB}}{(C_F + C_{Fo}) R_I R_B} \quad [\text{rad/s}], \quad f_z = \frac{1}{2\pi R_F C_F}$$

$$f_p = \frac{1}{2\pi R_F C_{ser}}, \quad C_{ser} = \frac{C_F C_{Fo}}{C_F + C_{Fo}}, \quad f_{px} = \frac{1}{2\pi R_{FB} (C_{opto} + C_{fx})}$$

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$\omega = 2\pi f$  throughout, and  $C_{ser}$  is  $C_F$  and  $C_{F0}$  in series.  $C_F + C_{F0}$  make the pole at the origin (zero static error);  $R_F C_F$  the zero  $f_z$  that returns the phase;  $R_F$  with  $C_{F0}$  the pole  $f_p$  that brings the gain down again by  $2f_i$ ;  $C_{opto} + C_{fx}$  with  $R_{FB}$  a third pole  $f_{px}$  at about a kilohertz that removes switching noise. CTR multiplies the whole gain, which is why its spread matters.

**The bias window.** The LED must drive the FB pin at its steady-state current with the lowest CTR (upper bound), and must not exceed the pin's maximum current with the highest CTR when the TL431 is fully on (lower bound).

$I_{FB,steady}$  and  $I_{FB,max}$  are those two FB-pin currents:

## Equation 48

$$R_{B,max} = \frac{V_Z - (V_R + V_{F0})}{V_{F0}/R_P + I_{FB,steady}/CTR_s}$$

$$R_{B,min} = \frac{V_Z - (V_R + V_{F0})}{V_{F0}/R_P + I_{FB,max}/CTR_m}$$

$EA_o$  uses the CTR at the steady-state LED current,  $CTR_s$ ; the lower bound of  $R_B$  uses the CTR at maximum LED current,  $CTR_m$ . Take both from the bin that will be fitted, and re-check the loop at the top of the bin: the crossover rises almost in proportion to CTR, because the loop falls at close to 20 dB per decade there, and the phase margin falls.

## 6.30 Placing the zero and the pole: the K-factor method

The Venable K-factor method sets  $EA_o$ , the zero and the pole from two targets: the phase margin  $\Phi_M$  and the gain allowed at  $2f_i$ . A spread factor  $K_v$  comes from the phase margin, with  $\alpha_v$  a weighting constant (1.2 in the ST tool):

## Equation 49

$$K_v = \frac{1}{2\alpha_v} \left[ (1 + \alpha_v^2) \tan \Phi_M + \sqrt{(1 + \alpha_v^2 \tan \Phi_M)^2 + 4\alpha_v^2} \right]$$

The zero goes  $K_v$  below the crossover and the pole  $K_v$  above it. Above the pole the gain is  $EA_o K_v^2 / \omega$ , so the limit at  $2f_i$  fixes  $EA_o$ :

## Equation 50

$$EA_o = \frac{2\pi(2f_i) G_{EA}(2f_i)}{K_v^2}$$

The centre point follows from the plant gain, with  $\Gamma_v = 0.744 V_{eq,max} / V_{eq,min}$  an input-voltage margin factor of the ST tool (Appendix 10.3). The tool takes  $V_{eq,min}$  as the lowest equivalent input and  $V_{eq,max}$  as the mains maximum, not the highest equivalent input:

## Equation 51

$$f_{MB} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_o K_v EA_o}{\Gamma_v}}, \quad f_p = K_v f_{MB}, \quad f_z = \frac{f_{MB}}{K_v}$$

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The parts follow from Equation 47. The high-frequency pole is placed at a chosen  $f_{pHF}$ , and  $C_{fx}$  is what is left after the optocoupler capacitance:

**Equation 52**

$$C_{Fo} = \frac{f_z}{f_p} \cdot \frac{CTR_s R_{FB}}{R_I R_B E A_o}, \quad C_F = C_{Fo} \left( \frac{f_p}{f_z} - 1 \right)$$

$$R_F = \frac{1}{2\pi f_z C_F}, \quad C_{fx} = \frac{1}{2\pi f_{pHF} R_{FB}} - C_{opto}$$

Round each value to a standard part, then compute the zero, pole and gain the standard parts give and check the loop on those.

## 6.31 Checking the loop: crossover, phase margin and gain margin

The loop gain (Equations 40 and 46) is two integrators, one zero and two poles:

**Equation 53**

$$|T(\omega)| = \frac{G_o E A_o}{\omega^2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{1 + (\omega/\omega_z)^2}}{\sqrt{1 + (\omega/\omega_p)^2} \sqrt{1 + (\omega/\omega_{px})^2}}$$

$$\arg T(\omega) = -180^\circ + \arctan \frac{\omega}{\omega_z} - \arctan \frac{\omega}{\omega_p} - \arctan \frac{\omega}{\omega_{px}}$$

The  $-180^\circ$  is the two integrators, so the **phase margin is the compensator phase at the crossover**. With  $A(\omega)$  the fraction in Equation 53, the crossover condition  $\omega_c^2 = G_o E A_o A(\omega_c)$  is solved by repeating

**Equation 54**

$$\omega_c \leftarrow \sqrt{G_o E A_o A(\omega_c)}, \quad \text{starting from } \omega_c = \sqrt{G_o E A_o}$$

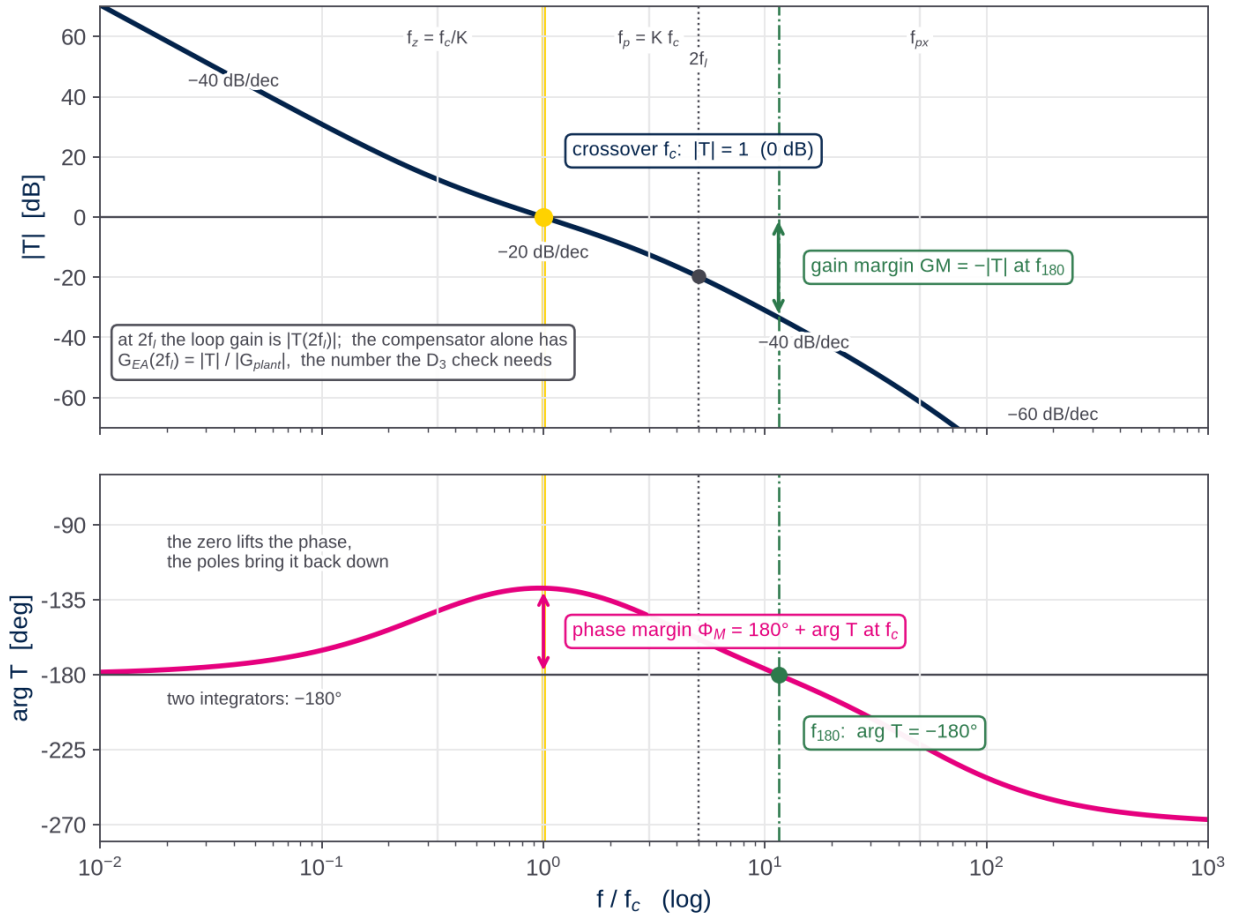
a few times; each pass cuts the error by more than half, because the square root halves the change in A, so no solver is needed. Then

**Equation 55**

$$\Phi_M = \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_z} - \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_p} - \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_{px}}$$

Figure 38 shows where the three numbers are read, in units of the loop's own crossover, so it is the shape of every loop of this kind. Section 7.16 puts this design's numbers on the same plot.

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**Figure 38:** A two-integrator loop with a Type II compensator, in units of its crossover. Phase margin is the distance from  $-180^\circ$  at  $f_c$ ; gain margin is  $|T|$  below 0 dB at  $f_{180}$ . The dot at  $2f_l$  is the gain the third-harmonic check reads.

## 6.32 Gain margin, and why it needs checking

Above  $f_{px}$  one zero faces two poles, so the phase keeps falling and  $-180^\circ$  is crossed at a finite frequency, which also needs no search:

**Equation 56**

$$f_{180} = \sqrt{f_p f_{px} - f_z(f_p + f_{px})}, \quad GM = -20 \log_{10} |T(f_{180})|$$

The root is real whenever the zero sits well below both poles, which the K-factor placement gives; if its argument were negative the phase would sit below  $-180^\circ$  at every frequency, and the phase margin would be negative at any crossover. Judge against 6 dB as a floor and 10 dB as comfortable. With a crossover in the tens of hertz the margin is usually large; that is a reason to compute it, not to assume it.

The same expression at  $2f_l$  gives the third harmonic through Equation 42, which closes the check.

## 6.33 Feedback ripple against the burst threshold

A crossover this low leaves  $2f_l$  ripple on the FB pin, which moves the commanded power every half cycle. If it crosses the burst-entry threshold the converter chatters. At the burst point the ripple is

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## Equation 57

$$\Delta V_{FB} = \frac{P_{in,BM}}{V_{out}} \frac{1}{2\pi f_l C_{out}} G_{EA}(2f_l)$$

with  $P_{in,BM}$  the input power at the burst entry point. Lowering  $R_{BM}$  moves the burst entry below that ripple, at 0.01 V per k $\Omega$ , and the ripple must clear it on both sides:

## Equation 58

$$\Delta R_{BM} = \frac{\Delta V_{FB}}{2 \times 0.01 \text{ V/k}\Omega}$$

Raising the crossover would shrink the ripple but worsen the distortion, so  $R_{BM}$  is the practical answer.

A loop this slow cannot recover from a large load step by itself; the anti-saturation circuit does, and it needs the FB pin to reach its full current range. That is why  $R_B$  must sit inside its window (Equation 48).

## 7 Design example

One design from specification to component values; every computed value shows its arithmetic. **90 to 264 Vac in, 25 V / 26.3 A = 657.5 W out**, centre-tapped synchronous rectification, no bulk capacitor, no boost stage.

### 7.1 The specification, sorted by what kind of number it is

Each number is **given** by the load and the mains, **chosen** by the designer, or **assumed** in place of a measurement not yet made.

| Item                         | Symbol                | Value                            | Kind   | Note                                                                     |
|------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mains input                  | $V_{ac}, f_l$         | 90 to 264 Vac, 47 to 63 Hz       | given  | the worst line frequency is the lowest, so every $f_l$ term uses 47 Hz   |
| Output                       | $V_{out}, I_{out}$    | 25 V, 26.3 A (657.5 W)           | given  | $V_{o,eff} = V_{out} + N_{rect} V_f = 25.0 \text{ V}$ with $V_f = 0$     |
| Output ripple, 2 $f_l$ pk-pk | $\Delta v$            | $\leq 5\%$ of $V_{out}$ (1.25 V) | given  | a property of the load, not of the converter                             |
| Hold-up                      | $T_{hold}, V_{o,min}$ | 12 ms down to 19 V, at 100 Vac   | given  | starts at the ripple trough, the worst line phase                        |
| Secondary rectifier          | $N_{rect}$            | 1 (centre tap, SR)               | chosen | halves the rectifier conduction loss; doubles the device reverse voltage |
| Target series resonance      | $f_r$                 | 150 kHz                          | chosen | sets the magnetics size                                                  |
| Specified maximum $f_{sw}$   | $f_{sw,max}$          | 225 kHz (1.5 $f_r$ )             | chosen | an input to $\lambda$ , Section 4.9                                      |
| Bridge dead time             | $t_D$                 | 220 ns                           | chosen | what the ZVS sweep has to beat                                           |
| $V_{CC}$ source              | —                     | external 12 V rail               | chosen | no turns-ratio ceiling on the auxiliary winding                          |

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| Item                            | Symbol      | Value                   | Kind    | Note                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LLC stage efficiency            | $\eta_{HB}$ | 98 %                    | assumed | a 95 % outcome moves $R_{ac}$ and $R_{CS}$ by about 3 %; nothing downstream is sensitive                          |
| Oscillator idle time            | $T_{idle}$  | 250 ns                  | assumed | the draft datasheet also implies 350 and 700 ns; 700 ns would close the floor margin — the first thing to measure |
| $R_{DS(on)}$ temperature factor | $k_T$       | 1.8 / 1.9               | assumed | primary / secondary, read off the datasheet curves at $T_{j,max}$                                                 |
| Burst entry point               | $r_{BM}$    | 11 % of $P_{in}$ (75 W) | assumed | sets $R_{BM}$ , then checked against the feedback ripple                                                          |

**Table 6: The specification. Everything else in this chapter is computed from these.**

**Harmonic class.** IEC 61000-3-2 Class D reaches only 600 W. This design draws 685 W at the input, so the absolute Class A limits apply.

## 7.2 What the design came out as

| Block       | Values                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tank        | $C_r$ 100 nF, $L_r$ 11 $\mu$ H, $L_m$ 20 $\mu$ H, $\lambda$ 0.55, $f_r$ 151.7 kHz, $f_o$ 90.4 kHz                                          |
| Transformer | $N_p:N_s$ 15:2, $n$ 6.02, $n_T$ 7.50, $L_{open}$ 31.0 $\mu$ H, $L_{short}$ 11.0 $\mu$ H, $A_e \geq 103$ mm <sup>2</sup> at $B_{pk}$ 0.20 T |
| Frequency   | $f_{sw}$ at the line peak, full load: 127.1 kHz at the low corner, 249.0 kHz at the high corner                                            |
| Output      | 470 $\mu$ F $\times$ 160 = 75.2 mF, ripple 1.18 V (4.74 %), hold-up 13.42 ms                                                               |
| Controller  | $R_T$ 11 k $\Omega$ , $C_T$ 470 pF, $R_{CS}$ 24.0 m $\Omega$ , $R_{CFG}$ 30 k $\Omega$ , $R_{BM}$ 30 k $\Omega$                            |
| Loop        | $f_c$ 17.57 Hz, $\Phi_M$ 49.64°, third harmonic 4.23 %                                                                                     |

**Table 7: Principal values. The rest of the chapter shows where each one comes from.**

## 7.3 What a verification margin is

Every check is what the design has divided by what it needs:

### Equation 59

$$k = \frac{X_{act}}{X_{req}} \implies \text{pass when } k > 1$$

$k = 1.05$  is five per cent of room; the smallest  $k$  is the thinnest part of the design.

| Check                                       | $k = \text{has} / \text{needs}$ | Substituted           | $k$          |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|
| ZVS at the worst point of the sweep         | $T_{ZC,min} / t_D$              | 401 ns / 220 ns       | 1.824        |
| Oscillator floor clears the lower resonance | $f_{Min} / f_o$                 | 92.25 kHz / 90.39 kHz | <b>1.021</b> |

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| Check                                                     | k = has / needs                                       | Substituted             | k            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------|
| Oscillator ceiling clears the highest operating frequency | $f_{\text{Max}} / f_{\text{sw}}$ (FB edge, line peak) | 319.61 kHz / 249.03 kHz | 1.283        |
| Over-current threshold clears the tank peak               | $I_{\text{OCP1}} / I_{\text{Lr,pk}}$                  | 22.92 A / 18.32 A       | 1.251        |
| Hold-up achieved against hold-up required                 | $t_{\text{hold}} / T_{\text{hold}}$                   | 13.42 ms / 12 ms        | 1.119        |
| Secondary loss per rectifier leg against its budget       | $P_{\text{budget}} / P_{\text{SR,leg}}$               | 3.00 W / 2.83 W         | 1.063        |
| Loss of the standing primary device against its budget    | $P_{\text{budget}} / P_{\text{mos,dc}}$               | 3.00 W / 9.65 W         | <b>0.311</b> |

**Table 8: The verification margins.**

$k_{\text{Ploss}} = 0.311$  is a result, not a failed calculation: the standing primary device spends 9.65 W against a 3 W budget; no single 600 V device meets that budget in the standing position, so the design goes ahead and the heatsink question is settled by measurement (Section 7.27).  $k_{\text{floor}} = 1.021$  is the thinnest of the margins that pass: the transformer tolerance and the idle time both move it, and neither is known to 2 % yet.

## 7.4 Following the numbers through

The design in the order it was computed; each step shows its equation and the numbers in it. Table 9 collects the results.

**Step 1 — the power the tank passes.** The bridge, the EMI filter and the LLC stage each get a loss budget, the last as  $\eta_{\text{HB}}$ :

$$P_{\text{in}} = P_{\text{out}} + P_{\text{LLC}} + P_{\text{EMI}} + P_{\text{BR}} = 657.5 + 13.42 + 8.34 + 5.52 = \mathbf{684.8 \text{ W}}$$

$$P_{\text{in,LLC}} = P_{\text{in}} - P_{\text{BR}} - P_{\text{EMI}} = 684.8 - 5.52 - 8.34 = \mathbf{670.9 \text{ W}}$$

**Step 2 — the two corners of the equivalent input.** They are the morphing thresholds, not the mains limits:

Equation 18, repeated

$$V_{\text{ac,eq}} = 2 V_{\text{ac}} \quad (\text{full bridge}) \quad V_{\text{ac,eq}} = V_{\text{ac}} \quad (\text{half bridge})$$

$$V_{\text{ac,eq,low}} = \frac{245 V_{\text{pk}}}{\sqrt{2}} = \mathbf{173.2 V_{\text{ac}}} \quad V_{\text{ac,eq,high}} = \frac{2 \times 235 V_{\text{pk}}}{\sqrt{2}} = \mathbf{332.3 V_{\text{ac}}}$$

**Step 3 — the turns ratio.** The wound ratio 15:2 is the input, because it is what can be built (the plain calculation gives  $n = 6.046$ ); the model ratio follows from it and the realised  $\lambda$  (step 8):

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Equation 21, repeated

$$n = k n_T, \quad k = \sqrt{\frac{L_m}{L_m + L_r}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + \lambda}}$$
$$n = \frac{n_T}{\sqrt{1 + \lambda_{act}}} = \frac{7.500}{1.2450} = \mathbf{6.024}$$

Equation 19, repeated

$$V_{refl} = n V_{o, eff} = n(V_{out} + N_{rect} V_f)$$
$$V_{refl} = n V_{o, eff} = 6.024 \times 25.0 = \mathbf{150.6 \text{ V}}$$

**Step 4 — the gain the tank is asked for**, at the line peak ( $\theta = 90^\circ$ ) of each corner:  $M_{low}$  at the low corner,  $M_{high}$  at the high one:

Equation 12, repeated

$$M(\theta) = \frac{n V_{o, eff}}{V_{drive}(\theta)} = \frac{2 n V_{o, eff}}{\sqrt{2} V_{ac, eq} \sin \theta}$$
$$M_{low} = \frac{2 \times 6.024 \times 25.0}{\sqrt{2} \times 173.24} = \mathbf{1.2294} \quad M_{high} = \frac{2 \times 6.024 \times 25.0}{\sqrt{2} \times 332.34} = \mathbf{0.6409}$$

**Step 5 — the load the tank sees.** The 4, not the textbook 8, because  $P_{in, LLC}$  is the line-peak power (Section 6.4):

Equation 20, repeated

$$R_{ac} = \frac{4}{\pi^2} \frac{n^2 V_{o, eff}^2}{P_{in, LLC}}$$
$$R_{ac} = \frac{4}{\pi^2} \frac{6.024^2 \times 25.0^2}{670.9} = \mathbf{13.70 \text{ } \Omega}$$

**Step 6 — the Q cap and the design impedance.** At the low corner, the Q at which the tank still reaches  $M_{low}$  and the Q at which ZVS still completes inside  $t_D$ ; the smaller is kept (Equation 1). The design impedance  $Z_{0, design}$  follows from it:

$$Q_{ZVS} = \mathbf{1.7019} \quad Z_{0, design} = R_{ac} Q_{ZVS} = 13.70 \times 1.7019 = \mathbf{23.32 \text{ } \Omega}$$

**Step 7 —  $C_r$  and  $L_r$ .**  $C_r$  is taken up on purpose for Q margin;  $L_r$  pairs with the selected  $C_r$ :

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Equation 2, repeated

$$f_r = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{L_r C_r}}$$

$$C_r = \frac{1}{2\pi f_r Z_{0, design}} = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 150 \text{ kHz} \times 23.32 \text{ } \Omega} = 45.50 \text{ nF} \rightarrow \mathbf{100 \text{ nF}}$$

$$L_r = \frac{1}{(2\pi f_r)^2 C_r} = \frac{1}{(2\pi \times 150 \text{ kHz})^2 \times 100 \text{ nF}} = 11.26 \text{ } \mu\text{H} \rightarrow \mathbf{11 \text{ } \mu\text{H}}$$

**Step 8 —  $\lambda$  and  $L_m$ .** Four candidates for  $\lambda$ , the largest binding:

Equation 16, repeated

$$\lambda_2 = \frac{\lambda_1}{1 - \left(\frac{f_r}{f_{sw, max}}\right)^2} \quad \lambda_{TD} = \frac{\lambda_1}{1 - \frac{\pi^2}{8} \left(\frac{f_r}{f_{sw, max}}\right)^2}$$

$$\lambda_1 = 0.560, \quad \lambda_2 = 1.009, \quad \lambda_3 = 0.125, \quad \lambda_{TD} = \mathbf{1.241} \quad \Rightarrow \quad L_m = \frac{L_r}{\lambda_{TD}} = \frac{11}{1.241} = 8.87 \text{ } \mu\text{H}$$

That 8.9  $\mu\text{H}$  is the no-load condition at the high corner, which this design knowingly does not meet (Section 4.10), so it is not rounded to.  $L_m$  is chosen with  $n$  so that  $n_T$  is windable:

$$L_m = \mathbf{20 \text{ } \mu\text{H}} \quad \lambda_{act} = \frac{L_r}{L_m} = \frac{11}{20} = \mathbf{0.550}$$

**Step 9 — what the selected parts make.** Every later check is measured against these:

Equation 3, repeated

$$f_o = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{(L_r + L_m) C_r}}$$

$$f_r = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{11 \text{ } \mu\text{H} \times 100 \text{ nF}}} = \mathbf{151.7 \text{ kHz}} \quad f_o = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{31 \text{ } \mu\text{H} \times 100 \text{ nF}}} = \mathbf{90.4 \text{ kHz}}$$

$$Z_0 = \sqrt{\frac{11 \text{ } \mu\text{H}}{100 \text{ nF}}} = 10.49 \text{ } \Omega \quad Q_{pk} = \frac{Z_0}{R_{ac}} = \frac{10.49}{13.70} = \mathbf{0.766}$$

$$n_T = n\sqrt{1 + \lambda_{act}} = 6.024 \times 1.2450 = \mathbf{7.500} = 15 : 2$$

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| Step | Quantity                            | Eq.     | Result                                                    |
|------|-------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | $P_{in}, P_{in,LLC}$                | —       | 684.8 W, 670.9 W                                          |
| 2    | $V_{ac,eq}$ , low and high corner   | 18      | 173.2, 332.3 Vac                                          |
| 3    | $n, V_{refl}$                       | 21, 19  | 6.024, 150.6 V                                            |
| 4    | $M_{low}, M_{high}$                 | 12      | 1.2294, 0.6409                                            |
| 5    | $R_{ac}$                            | 20      | 13.70 $\Omega$                                            |
| 6    | $Q_{ZVS}, Z_{0,design}$             | 1       | 1.7019, 23.32 $\Omega$                                    |
| 7    | $C_r, L_r$                          | 2       | 45.5 $\rightarrow$ 100 nF, 11.26 $\rightarrow$ 11 $\mu$ H |
| 8    | $\lambda_{req}, L_m, \lambda_{act}$ | 16      | 1.241, 20 $\mu$ H, 0.550                                  |
| 9    | $f_r, f_o, Q_{pk}, n_T$             | 2, 3, 1 | 151.7 kHz, 90.4 kHz, 0.766, 7.500                         |

**Table 9: The design, step by step: the results of the nine steps. In a  $\rightarrow$  b, a is the calculated value and b the part selected.**

**Steps 7 and 8 are the judgement calls.**  $C_r$  is 100 nF against a calculated 45.5: the larger capacitor lowers  $Q_{pk}$ , which is where the ZVS margin comes from.  $L_m$  is 20  $\mu$ H against 8.9: it lets the wound 15:2 give the  $n$  the tank needs, and gives up the no-load solution (next note).

**No-load solution: none.** The no-load gain of this tank bottoms out at  $M_{\infty} = 0.6452$ , and the high corner asks for 0.6409, below it. No frequency reaches that gain without load, and the margin is under one per cent, so no full-load check would show it. Burst mode owns that region (Section 4.10).

## 7.5 ZVS over the whole operating space

The closed form of Section 6.5 reads 292 ns on this tank against a swept 460 ns (36 % pessimistic), and it also reads low, by tens of per cent, on the other tanks computed for this project. Being low there is no guarantee for another tank. Read with  $\lambda_{act} = 0.550$  instead of the design  $\lambda = 1.241$  it returns  $-471$  ns, a capacitive answer for an inductive tank. This design is judged by the sweep.

The capacitive edge of the full-load curve ( $\arg Z_{in} = 0$ ) is at 110.1 kHz; the gain peak is lower, at 105.4 kHz, with 8.4° of capacitive phase still there (Section 2.9). Neither is used for the verdict.

| Load  | 173 Vac<br>HB edge | 90 Vac<br>FB | 110 Vac<br>FB | 230 Vac<br>HB | 264 Vac<br>HB | 166 Vac<br>FB edge |
|-------|--------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|--------------------|
| 100 % | 460                | 517          | 665           | 675           | 674           | 603                |
| 75 %  | 757                | 776          | 796           | 785           | 720           | 561                |
| 50 %  | 1084               | 1079         | 988           | 953           | 808           | 501                |
| 25 %  | 1470               | 1445         | 1259          | 1202          | 974           | 401                |

**Table 10:  $T_{ZC,min}$  in nanoseconds, the smallest over the line half cycle, at each load and input voltage; FB is full bridge (the tank sees twice the mains), HB half bridge;  $t_D = 220$  ns.**

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The worst point is not the corner the tank was designed at. Full load at the HB edge is where the gain requirement is set, and it gives  $T_{ZC} = 460$  ns, a margin of 2.09. The smallest number in Table 10 is **401 ns at 25 % load, at the FB edge (166 Vac in full bridge, which the tank sees as 332 Vac)**, a margin of 1.82 against  $t_D = 220$  ns. That is the number this design is held to.

**Why light load at high input voltage can be the ZVS corner.** The charge that swings the bridge node is carried by the magnetising current, and above resonance, where this corner runs, its peak goes as  $nV_{o,eff}/(4f_{sw}L_m)$ . Shed load and the controller raises  $f_{sw}$  to cut the gain, so that current falls while the node still has the same capacitance to move. Sweeping only the design corner therefore reports a margin that is not there.

## 7.6 The gain chart of this design

Figure 39 is the chart of Section 4.5 on this tank ( $\lambda_{act} = 0.550$ ,  $Q_{pk} = 0.766$ ), one panel per input voltage: the two morphing edges and the four mains voltages a supply meets. Each panel names the mains voltage and the bridge; in full bridge the tank sees twice the mains, so each panel also says what the tank sees. The curves are the same in every panel; only the required-gain lines move. The marked crossings are the operating points the sweep is built from.

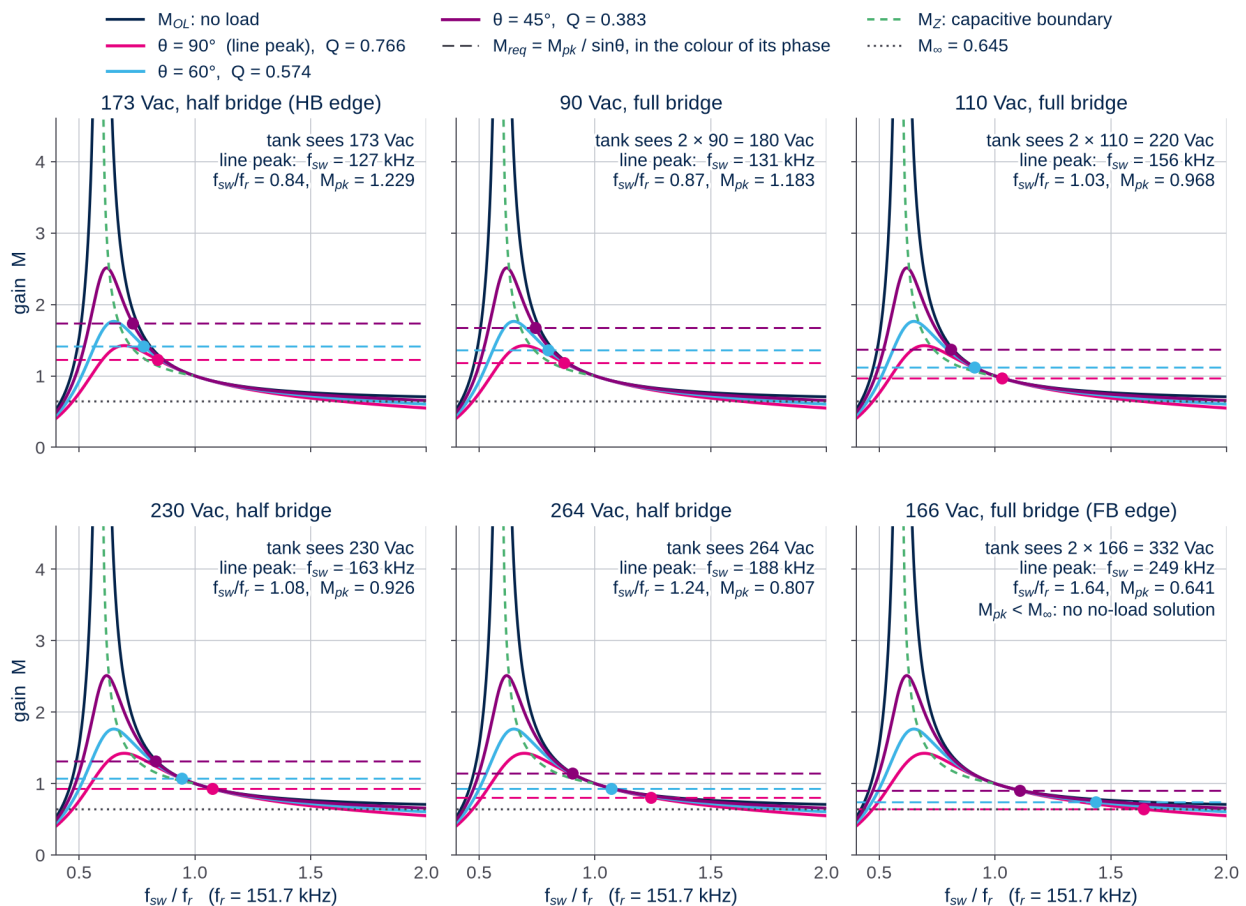


Figure 39: The gain chart of this design at the six input voltages, low to high as the tank sees them. Top left, the HB edge (173 Vac, half bridge): highest required gain, crossings below  $f_r$ . Bottom right, the FB edge (166 Vac, full bridge, so the tank sees 332 Vac): lowest required gain, crossings above  $f_r$ . Each phase is compared with the dashed line of its own colour only.

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| Input voltage                  | $\theta$ | $Q(\theta)$ | $M_{req}(\theta)$ | $f_{sw}/f_r$ | $f_{sw}$  |
|--------------------------------|----------|-------------|-------------------|--------------|-----------|
| 173 Vac, half bridge (HB edge) | 90°      | 0.766       | 1.229             | 0.838        | 127.1 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 1.420             | 0.778        | 118.1 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 1.739             | 0.731        | 110.9 kHz |
| 90 Vac, full bridge            | 90°      | 0.766       | 1.183             | 0.865        | 131.3 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 1.366             | 0.796        | 120.8 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 1.673             | 0.742        | 112.6 kHz |
| 110 Vac, full bridge           | 90°      | 0.766       | 0.968             | 1.030        | 156.4 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 1.118             | 0.912        | 138.3 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 1.369             | 0.810        | 122.9 kHz |
| 230 Vac, half bridge           | 90°      | 0.766       | 0.926             | 1.075        | 163.2 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 1.069             | 0.944        | 143.3 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 1.310             | 0.829        | 125.8 kHz |
| 264 Vac, half bridge           | 90°      | 0.766       | 0.807             | 1.242        | 188.5 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 0.932             | 1.071        | 162.5 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 1.141             | 0.901        | 136.8 kHz |
| 166 Vac, full bridge (FB edge) | 90°      | 0.766       | 0.641             | 1.641        | 249.0 kHz |
|                                | 60°      | 0.574       | 0.740             | 1.435        | 217.8 kHz |
|                                | 45°      | 0.383       | 0.906             | 1.106        | 167.9 kHz |

**Table 11: The marked crossings of Figure 39, at every input voltage.  $Q = Q_{pk} \sin^2 \theta$  and  $M_{req} = M_{pk} / \sin \theta$ ;  $M_{pk}$  scales as  $1/V_{ac,eq}$ , from 1.229 at the HB edge to 0.641 at the FB edge.**

Four readings matter:

- **The HB edge sets the tank.** 173 Vac in half bridge is the lowest voltage the tank ever sees, so its line-peak requirement  $M_{pk} = 1.229$  is the largest of the six. It is met at  $f_{sw}/f_r = 0.838$ , well to the right of  $M_z$ : inductive.
- **The FB edge sets the frequency.** At 166 Vac in full bridge the tank sees 332 Vac, the most it ever sees; the line-peak crossing is 249 kHz, and that, not the mains maximum, is what the oscillator ceiling must clear (Section 7.18).
- **The four mains voltages sit between the edges.** 90 Vac in full bridge puts  $2 \times 90 = 180$  Vac on the tank, only 4 % above the HB edge, so a 90 Vac system runs close to the gain worst case. 110 Vac in full bridge (220 Vac on the tank) and 230 Vac in half bridge (230 Vac on the tank) are within 5 % of each other: morphing makes the two mains systems nearly alike to the tank. 264 Vac in half bridge is still 21 % below what the tank sees at the FB edge.
- **The FB edge also judges  $\lambda$ .** The line-peak requirement there is 0.641 and the no-load floor  $M_{\infty} = 0.645$ ; below it there is no no-load solution and burst mode takes over (Section 4.10).

The six panels are six places on one axis, not six designs. The curves do not depend on input voltage:  $M(f_n, Q)$  is fixed by  $\lambda_{act}$  and  $Q_{pk}$ . **The input voltage enters only through  $M_{req}$ .**

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## 7.7 Which side of resonance this design runs on

With  $n_T = 7.50$ , at four of the six input voltages the tank spends part of every line cycle above  $f_r$ , where the secondary loses zero-current turn-off, so the rectifier body diode and the SR dead time need checking.

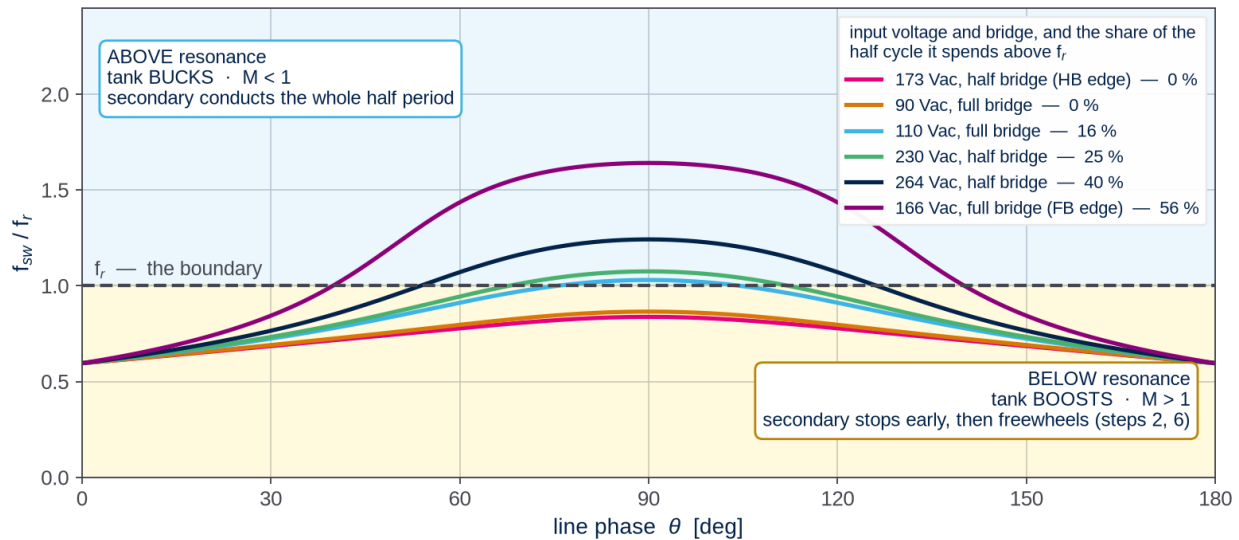


Figure 40: Which side of  $f_r$  the converter is on over a line half cycle, at the six input voltages. Every curve converges on  $f_o$  at the zero crossing. The percentage in each legend entry is the fraction of the half cycle spent above  $f_r$ , without zero-current turn-off.

| Input voltage and bridge       | the tank sees (Vac rms) | peak $f_{sw}$ | side of $f_r$ |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| 173 Vac, half bridge (HB edge) | 173 Vac                 | 127.1 kHz     | below         |
| 90 Vac, full bridge            | 180 Vac                 | 131.3 kHz     | below         |
| 110 Vac, full bridge           | 220 Vac                 | 156.4 kHz     | above         |
| 230 Vac, half bridge           | 230 Vac                 | 163.2 kHz     | above         |
| 264 Vac, half bridge           | 264 Vac                 | 188.5 kHz     | above         |
| 166 Vac, full bridge (FB edge) | 332 Vac                 | 249.0 kHz     | above         |

Table 12: Peak  $f_{sw}$  over the half cycle against  $f_r = 151.7$  kHz. 4 of the 6 input voltages cross into above-resonance operation for part of the cycle.

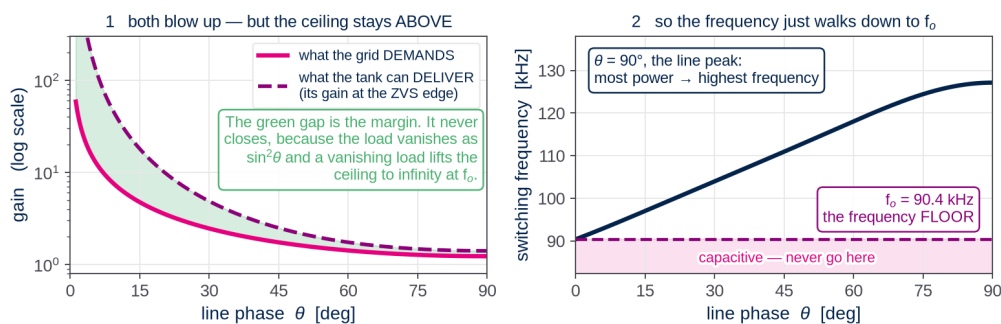


Figure 41: Near the zero crossing the required gain diverges and the load vanishes together, so the operating point converges on  $f_o = 90.4$  kHz (Section 4.2).

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

## 7.8 The currents this design has to carry

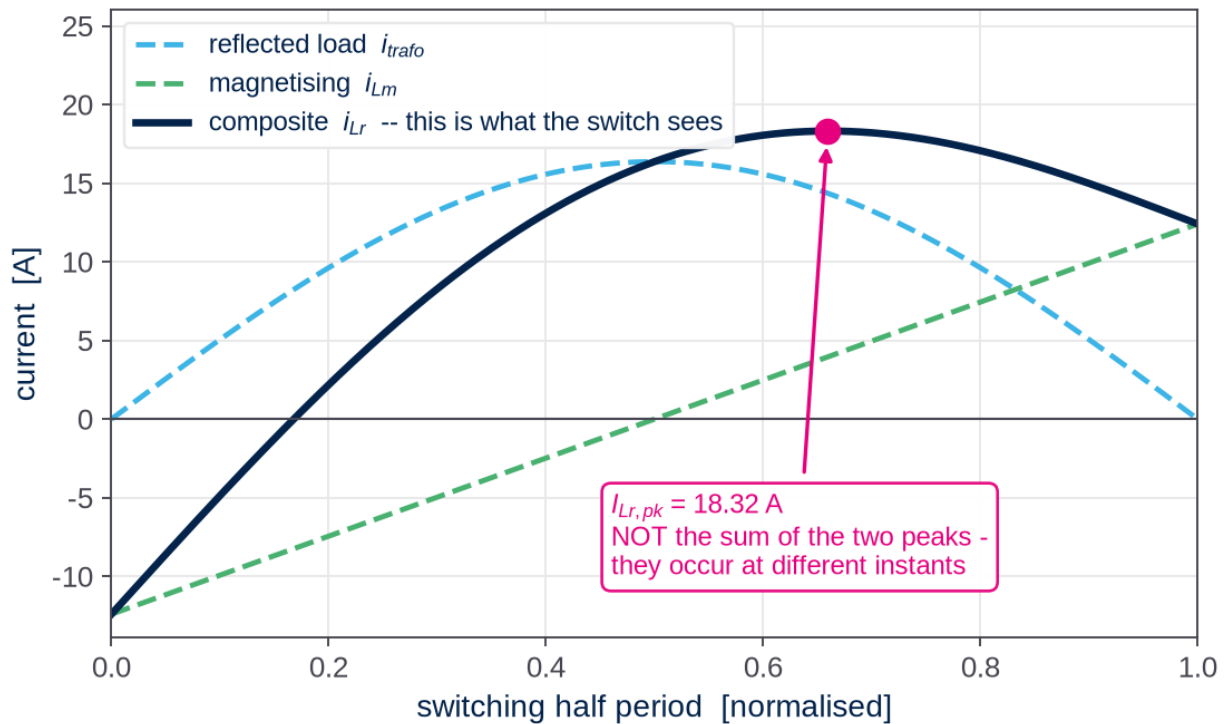
Ratings come from the worst switching cycle and losses from the line-cycle rms, so both are listed. The peaks are read off one cycle at the HB edge, line peak ( $\theta = 90^\circ$  in Table 11). The composite peak is the peak of the sum, because the two components peak at different instants:

$$I_{Lr,pk} = \max_t |i_{Lm}(t) + i_{trafo}(t)| = 18.32 \text{ A} < 12.41 + 16.37 = 28.78 \text{ A}$$

The rms values are the rms of one switching period, averaged in  $I^2$  over the line half cycle by the five-point Simpson rule:

$$I_{lc} = \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^{\pi/2} I_{rms}^2(\theta) d\theta} \simeq \sqrt{\frac{1}{12} \sum_k w_k I_{rms}^2(\theta_k)}, \quad w = \{1, 4, 2, 4, 1\}$$

That is why the line-cycle primary rms, 10.91 A, is lower than the worst cycle's 13.76 A.



**Figure 42: The composite tank current at the HB edge, full load, and why its peak is not the sum of the two component peaks: they occur at different instants. Drawn as the calculation models it: the reflected load current a half sine over the whole switching half period, the magnetising current a linear ramp.**

| Quantity       | Value     | Where it is used                                |
|----------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------|
| $f_{sw}$       | 127.1 kHz | the switching cycle the peaks below are read in |
| $I_{sec,pk}$   | 98.6 A    | secondary rectifier peak                        |
| $I_{trafo,pk}$ | 16.37 A   | reflected load component                        |
| $I_{Lm,pk}$    | 12.41 A   | magnetising component                           |

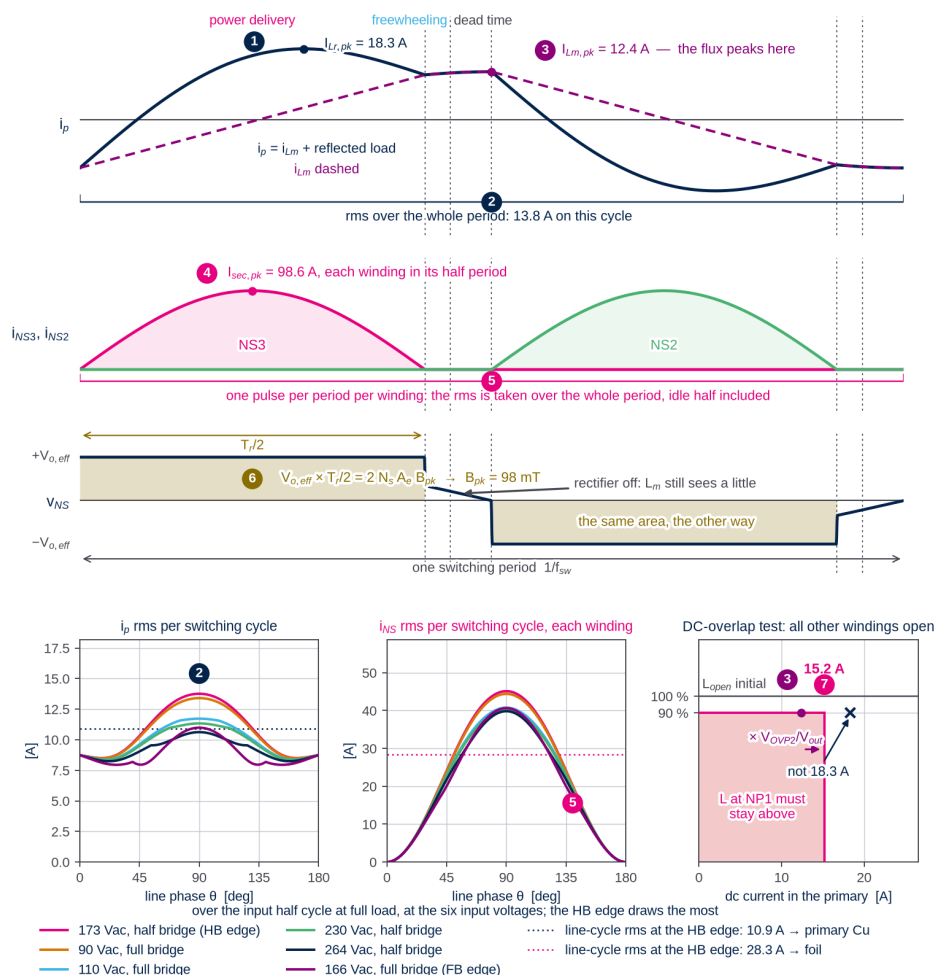
# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

| Quantity                            | Value   | Where it is used                  |
|-------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------|
| composite tank peak                 | 18.32 A | primary device rating, OCP margin |
| $I_{pri,rms}$ (worst cycle)         | 13.76 A | primary rms rating                |
| $I_{pri}$ (line-cycle rms)          | 10.91 A | primary conduction loss           |
| $I_{rect}$ per leg (line-cycle rms) | 28.34 A | secondary conduction loss         |
| $I_{Cout}$ (line-cycle rms)         | 30.24 A | output bank ripple current        |

**Table 13: Currents at the HB edge (173 Vac, half bridge), full load. Peaks and worst-cycle rms are taken in the switching cycle at the line peak,  $\theta = 90^\circ$ ; line-cycle rms values are over the whole line half cycle.**

## 7.9 What the transformer must provide

The tank asks for  $L_r = 11 \mu\text{H}$ ,  $L_m = 20 \mu\text{H}$  and  $n_T = 7.50$ . The transformer is one part: a 15-turn primary and two 2-turn secondaries, NS2 and NS3, joined at the centre tap. NS2 is  $N_{s1}$  of Figure 1 and NS3 is  $N_{s2}$ , so NS3 conducts while S1 and S4 are on. Several units in series (Section 6.21) are not needed here.



**Figure 43: Where each number is read. Top: primary current, the two secondary winding currents and the secondary winding voltage over one switching period at the worst cycle: line peak at the HB edge (173 Vac, half bridge), full load. Lower left and centre: the rms of the two winding currents over the input half cycle at the six input voltages; the HB edge draws the most in both windings, which is why the table is read there. Lower right: the DC-overlap bench test. The circled marks are the rows of Table 4.**

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| Quantity                 | Value                                  | Note                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Turns                    | $N_p$ 15 T; NS2 2 T, NS3 2 T; NAUX 3 T | $n_T = 15 / 2 = 7.5$ ; the auxiliary is ZCD sense only                                    |
| Open-circuit inductance  | 31.0 $\mu$ H                           | $L_r + L_m$ ; across NP1, every other winding open                                        |
| Short-circuit inductance | 11.0 $\mu$ H                           | this is $L_r$ , no separate resonant inductor; across NP1, NS2 and NS3 shorted, NAUX open |
| $A_L$                    | 138 nH                                 | open-circuit inductance / $N_p^2$ ; the core is gapped to it (Section 7.10)               |

**Table 14: What the tank asks of the transformer.**

## 7.10 Choosing the core

Three requirements come before any core is picked: the flux sets the core area, the copper sets the window, and the leakage sets the winding width.

**Core area.** The flux at  $f_r$ , with  $B_{pk}$  held to 0.20 T:

Equation 24, repeated

$$B_{pk} = \frac{V_{o, eff}}{4f_r N_s A_e} \implies A_e \geq \frac{V_{o, eff}}{4f_r N_s B_{max}}$$

$$A_e \geq \frac{25.0 \text{ V}}{4 \times 151.75 \text{ kHz} \times 2 \times 0.20 \text{ T}} = \mathbf{103 \text{ mm}^2}$$

**Copper.** Each winding carries its line-cycle rms current (Table 13) at  $J = 4.5 \text{ A/mm}^2$ . Summed over the windings, that is the copper the window must hold:

Equation 27, repeated

$$A_{cu} = \frac{I_{rms}}{J} \quad \sum_w N_w A_{cu, w} \leq k_u A_N$$

$$\text{NP1: } A_{cu} = \frac{10.91 \text{ A}}{4.5 \text{ A/mm}^2} = 2.43 \text{ mm}^2, \quad \text{NS2: } A_{cu} = \frac{28.34 \text{ A}}{4.5 \text{ A/mm}^2} = 6.30 \text{ mm}^2$$

$$\sum_w N_w A_{cu, w} = 15 \times 2.43 + 4 \times 6.30 = 61.6 \text{ mm}^2 \leq 0.30 A_N \Rightarrow A_N \geq \mathbf{205 \text{ mm}^2}$$

The conductor for each follows from the skin depth.

**Skin depth** at  $f_r$ , with copper at 100 °C ( $\rho = 2.26 \times 10^{-8} \Omega\text{m}$ ):

Equation 28, repeated

$$\delta = \sqrt{\frac{\rho}{\pi f \mu_0}}$$

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$$\delta = \sqrt{\frac{2.26 \times 10^{-8}}{\pi \cdot 151.7 \times 10^3 \cdot 4\pi \times 10^{-7}}} = 0.194 \text{ mm}$$

A conductor thicker than  $2\delta = 0.39 \text{ mm}$  gains little, so the primary is Litz. The standard strand safely inside that is  $d_s = \text{ø}0.10 \text{ mm}$ , 3.9 times smaller than  $2\delta$ . Its copper area and the strand count are Equation 29:

Equation 29, repeated

$$a_s = \frac{\pi d_s^2}{4}, \quad n_s = \left\lceil \frac{A_{cu}}{a_s} \right\rceil$$

$$a_s = \frac{\pi \cdot (0.10)^2}{4} = 0.00785 \text{ mm}^2, \quad n_s = \left\lceil \frac{2.43}{0.00785} \right\rceil = 309$$

The served bundle's outside diameter, with  $k_{litz} = 0.55$ :

Equation 30, repeated

$$d_{litz} = \sqrt{\frac{4A_{cu}}{\pi k_{litz}}}$$

$$d_{litz} = \sqrt{\frac{4 \cdot 2.43}{\pi \cdot 0.55}} = 2.37 \text{ mm}$$

**The secondary is foil.**  $6.30 \text{ mm}^2$  as Litz would be a bundle of  $\text{ø}3.8 \text{ mm}$ , thicker than the whole  $3.0 \text{ mm}$  foil build. At  $t_f = 0.20 \text{ mm}$ , and with  $w_{f,max} = 12.0 \text{ mm}$  assumed as the widest strip worth winding as one, Equation 31 gives

$$w_f = \frac{6.30}{0.20} = 31.5 \text{ mm}, \quad n_f = \left\lceil \frac{31.5}{12.0} \right\rceil = 3 \Rightarrow 3 \times 10.5 \text{ mm}$$

so one turn is **3 strips of 10.5 mm in parallel**, stacked radially.

**What the core must offer.**  $A_e$  of at least  $103 \text{ mm}^2$ ; a window of at least  $61.6/0.30 = 205 \text{ mm}^2$  for the copper of all four windings at  $k_u = 0.30$ ; and a winding width for  $11.85 \text{ mm}$  of primary,  $10.5 \text{ mm}$  of foil and  $2 \times 2.0 \text{ mm}$  of margin tape, with room left between primary and secondary for the separation that sets  $L_{short}$  (Section 6.13).

**The core.** TDK **ETD 49/25/16DG**, N95 (core B66367, coil former B66368) meets all three:  $A_e = 211 \text{ mm}^2$ , 2.0 times what the flux needs;  $A_N = 269 \text{ mm}^2$ , of which the copper takes 76 % at  $k_u = 0.30$ ; and a winding width of  $32.7 \text{ mm}$  that leaves  $6.36 \text{ mm}$  between primary and secondary. The flux alone would allow a core of half this area; the window and the winding width decide, as Section 6.12 expects of a single-stage tank. The gap is distributed on the centre leg, about  $2.2 \text{ mm}$  in total, ground to  $A_L = 138 \text{ nH}$ . Table 15 is the arithmetic.

| Step                                    | Primary NP1                                | Secondary NS2                              |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Line-cycle rms current                  | 10.91 A                                    | 28.34 A                                    |
| Copper area at $J = 4.5 \text{ A/mm}^2$ | $10.91 / 4.5 = \mathbf{2.43 \text{ mm}^2}$ | $28.34 / 4.5 = \mathbf{6.30 \text{ mm}^2}$ |

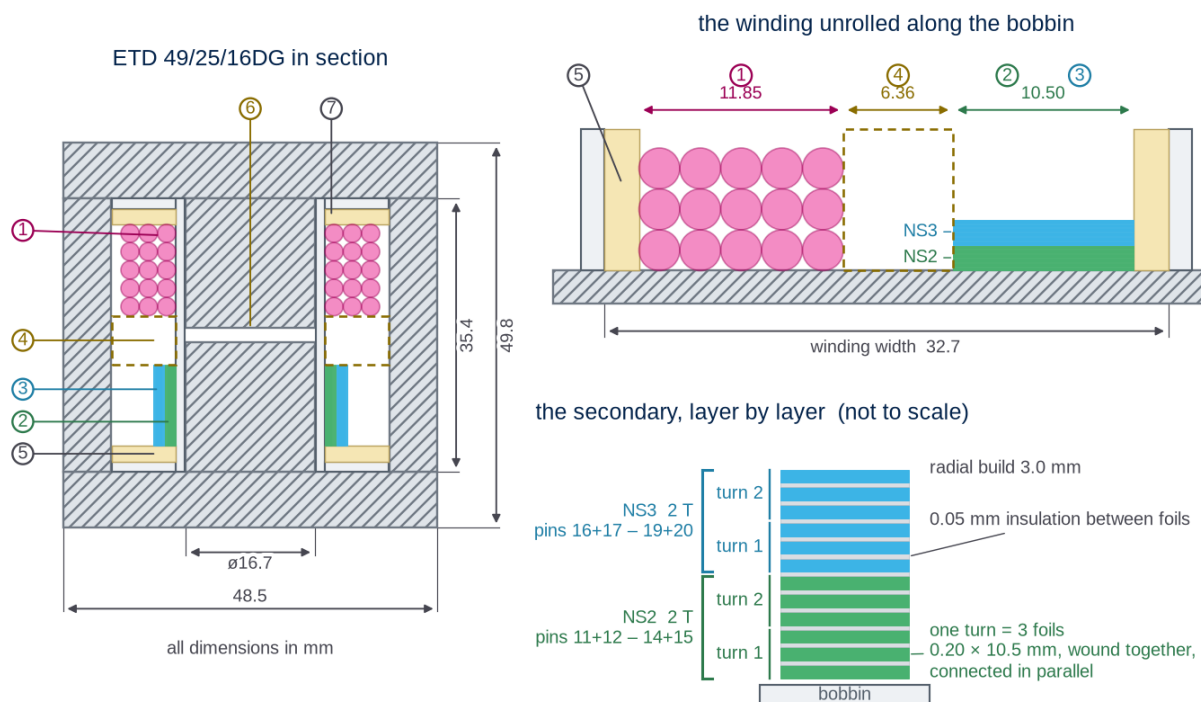
# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

| Step                                             | Primary NP1                                                                                                                                                                                | Secondary NS2                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conductor<br>( $\delta = 0.194$ mm, Equation 28) | Litz of $\varnothing 0.10$ mm strands, each $a_s = 0.00785$ mm <sup>2</sup> (Equation 29):<br>$2.43 / 0.00785 = \mathbf{309 \text{ strands}}$ , bundle $\varnothing 2.37$ mm (Equation 30) | foil 0.20 mm thick: $6.30 / 0.20 = 31.5$ mm wide, made as <b>3 strips of 10.5 mm</b> in parallel |
| Turns                                            | 15, in 3 layers (5/5/5)                                                                                                                                                                    | 2                                                                                                |
| Width on the bobbin                              | $5 \times 2.37 = \mathbf{11.85 \text{ mm}}$                                                                                                                                                | <b>10.5 mm</b>                                                                                   |
| Radial build                                     | $3 \times 2.37 = 7.11$ mm                                                                                                                                                                  | NS2 + NS3: $12 \times (0.20 + 0.05) = 3.0$ mm                                                    |
| Left between the windings                        | $32.7 - 2 \times 2.0 - 11.848 - 10.496 = \mathbf{6.36 \text{ mm}}$                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                  |
| Copper in the window                             | $15 \times 2.43 + 4 \times 6.30 = 61.6$ mm <sup>2</sup> ; at $k_u = 0.30$ that needs 205 mm <sup>2</sup> of window, 76 % of $A_N = 269$ mm <sup>2</sup>                                    |                                                                                                  |

**Table 15: The winding, from current to copper. NS3 is the same as NS2.**

## 7.11 The winding and the pins

Figure 44 shows the section and the winding; Table 16 names each item.



**Figure 44: The core in section (left, to scale), the winding unrolled along the bobbin (top right, to scale) and the secondary layer by layer (bottom right, not to scale). Primary and secondary sit side by side with 6.36 mm between them. The circled numbers are the rows of Table 16.**

| Mark | Item                        | Turns | Conductor, placement                                                                     |
|------|-----------------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | NP1 primary, pins 1+2 - 4+5 | 15 T  | Litz 309 x $\varnothing 0.10$ mm (bundle $\varnothing 2.37$ mm), 3 layers of 5/5/5 turns |

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| Mark | Item                              | Turns | Conductor, placement                                                                          |
|------|-----------------------------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2    | NS2 secondary, pins 11+12 – 14+15 | 2 T   | foil 0.20 × 10.5 mm, 3 foils in parallel per turn; wound directly on the bobbin               |
| 3    | NS3 secondary, pins 16+17 – 19+20 | 2 T   | the same foil, on top of NS2                                                                  |
| 4    | Separation                        | —     | 6.36 mm between primary and secondary; sets $L_{\text{short}}$                                |
| 5    | Margin tape                       | —     | 2.0 mm at each flange, assumed; check the creepage against the safety standard (Section 6.17) |
| 6    | Centre-leg gap                    | —     | about 2.2 mm in total, ground to $A_L = 138 \text{ nH}$                                       |
| 7    | Window                            | —     | $A_N = 269 \text{ mm}^2$ , 62 mm <sup>2</sup> of copper in it                                 |
| —    | NAUX auxiliary, pins 8 – 10       | 3 T   | any wire; ZCD sense only                                                                      |

Table 16: Items of the figure.

**Pins.** The B66368 coil former of the ETD 49/25/16DG core has 20 pins in two rows of 10. NP1 and the ZCD auxiliary take one row, NS2 and NS3 the other, two pins per secondary terminal. The centre tap is made on the board.

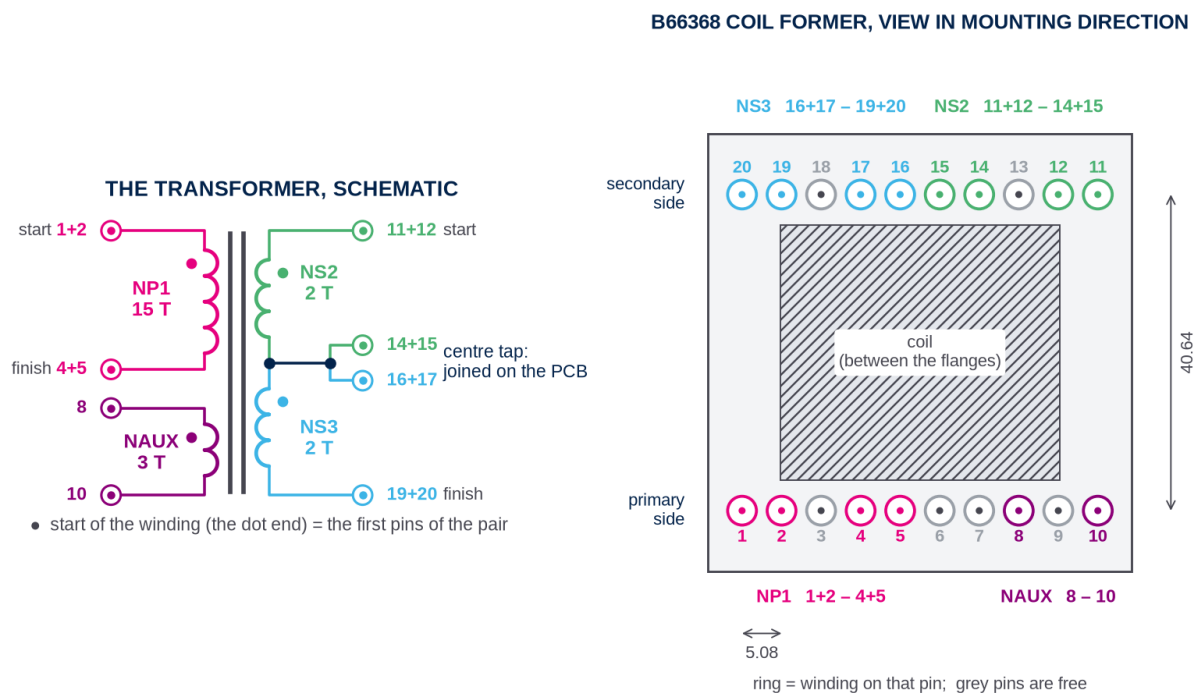


Figure 45: The schematic symbol with its pin numbers, and the same pins on the B66368 coil former (20 pins, pitch 5.08 mm, rows 40.64 mm apart). A ring in a winding's colour marks its pins; grey pins are free. The dot end is the first pin of each pair. The datasheet prints no pin numbers; the numbering shown counts along one row from pin 1 and back along the other, the usual convention. Confirm it against the bobbin drawing before the specification is released; the assignment does not depend on it, only the printed numbers do.

| Winding     | Pins (start – finish) | Turns | Conductor           | Row            |
|-------------|-----------------------|-------|---------------------|----------------|
| NP1 primary | 1+2 – 4+5             | 15 T  | Litz 309 × Ø0.10 mm | front row 1-10 |

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| Winding              | Pins (start – finish)                | Turns | Conductor                          | Row            |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------|-------|------------------------------------|----------------|
| NAUX auxiliary (ZCD) | 8 – 10                               | 3 T   | any wire, sense only               | front row 1-10 |
| NS2 secondary        | 11+12 – 14+15                        | 2 T   | foil 0.20 × 10.5 mm, 3 in parallel | back row 11-20 |
| NS3 secondary        | 16+17 – 19+20                        | 2 T   | the same foil, on top of NS2       | back row 11-20 |
| Centre tap           | 14, 15, 16 and 17, joined on the PCB | —     | —                                  | back row 11-20 |
| Free                 | 3, 6, 7, 9, 13, 18                   | —     | not connected                      | both rows      |

**Table 17: Winding-to-pin assignment.**

**Polarity.** The datasheet asks for ZCD positive while the low-side switch of leg 1 (LOUT1) is on. The primary dot is then negative, so the auxiliary start, pin 8 (the dot), goes to ground and its finish, pin 10, to  $R_{ZCD,H}$ . NS2 and NS3 are wound in the same sense; the tap joins the finish of NS2 to the start of NS3.

## 7.12 Checking the flux, and the specification

**Peak flux density** on the chosen core, at  $f_r$  (Equation 24):

$$B_{pk} = \frac{25.0 \text{ V}}{4 \times 151.75 \text{ kHz} \times 2 \times 211.0 \text{ mm}^2} = \mathbf{98 \text{ mT}}$$

**Magnetising peak**, over  $L_\mu$  (it equals  $i_{\mu,pk}$ ):

**Equation 32, repeated**

$$I_{eq} = \frac{B_{pk} N_p A_e}{L_\mu}$$

$$I_{eq} = \frac{0.0976 \text{ T} \times 15 \times 211.0 \text{ mm}^2}{24.90 \text{ } \mu\text{H}} = \mathbf{12.41 \text{ A}} = i_{\mu,pk}$$

The same current from the output voltage alone (Equation 33), with no core data in it:

$$i_{\mu,pk} = \frac{7.50 \times 25.0 \text{ V}}{4 \times 151.75 \text{ kHz} \times 24.90 \text{ } \mu\text{H}} = \mathbf{12.41 \text{ A}}$$

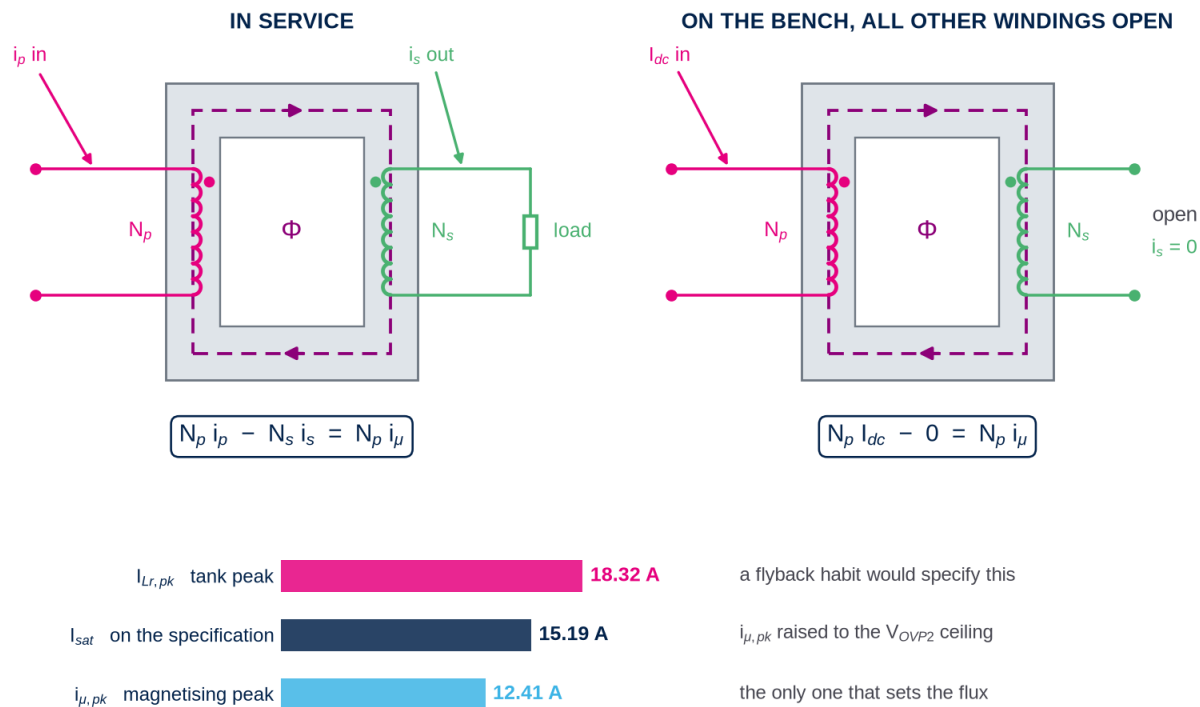
**Saturation test current**, the magnetising peak at the OVP2 output voltage:

**Equation 34, repeated**

$$I_{sat} = I_{eq} \frac{V_{OVP2}}{V_{out}}$$

$$I_{sat} = 12.41 \text{ A} \times \frac{30.61 \text{ V}}{25.0 \text{ V}} = 12.41 \times 1.2244 = \mathbf{15.2 \text{ A}}$$

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**Figure 46: In service the secondary cancels most of the primary ampere-turns; with every other winding open, the whole test current magnetises the core. The design flux is therefore reached at 12.41 A on the bench, not at the 18.32 A tank peak.**

**Why OVP2, in this design's numbers.** OVP1 is set at 28.16 V, 1.126 times the output, and OVP2 at 30.61 V, 1.224 times. At OVP1 the controller keeps switching, so the flux can reach 110 mT with the core still driven; at OVP2 it stops, and 120 mT is the largest flux this core is ever asked to carry. That is the number to hold against the hot  $B_s$  of N95 from the material data. The line on the specification reads: DC overlap, inductance at least 90 % of initial at 16 A (15.2 A rounded up), normal temperature (Table 18).

**How to run it on this part.** LCR meter across the primary (NP1, the pins of Table 17) with both secondaries, the centre tap and the auxiliary winding open. Small signal 100 kHz, 1 V, the same as the leakage test; bias current stepped from zero to past 16 A, inductance recorded at each step. Pass if  $L$  at 16 A is at least 0.9 of  $L$  at zero, where  $L$  at zero is  $L_{open} \approx 31.0 \mu\text{H}$ . Keep each step short: the dc heats the winding through its resistance, and a warm core saturates earlier. A part whose curve knees below 16 A has too little gap or the wrong core, even when  $L_{open}$  is on target; the margin against a hot core is in  $B_{pk}$ , not in the test.

**If there were no OVP2.** The current limit would be the only ceiling: OCP1 trips at 22.92 A, 1.51 times the OVP2-based 15.2 A. At the same  $L_\mu$  that is 180 mT on this core, which has about twice the area the flux target needs. On a core sized to the 0.20 T target it would be 369 mT; holding it to the 245 mT that OVP2 allows would take 1.51 times the core area or  $N_s$ . The rule of thumb of 1.3 times  $i_{\mu,pk}$  would give 16.1 A, near the OVP2 figure by coincidence and with no event behind it.

Reduced to what a supplier can measure, this is the specification sheet.  $L_\mu$  is deliberately absent (Section 6.10).

| Item | Value                             | Condition                                        |
|------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Core | ETD 49/25/16DG, N95, $A_L$ 138 nH | core B66367, coil former B66368; distributed gap |

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| Item                            | Value                                              | Condition                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Turns                           | $N_p$ 15 T; NS2 2 T and NS3 2 T; NAUX 3 T          | two secondary windings, centre tap outside the part                                                                           |
| Open-circuit inductance         | 31.0 $\mu$ H, no more than 4.0 % low (Equation 39) | measured across NP1; every other winding (NS2, NS3, NAUX) open; LCR meter 100 kHz, 1 V                                        |
| Leakage inductance              | 11.0 $\mu$ H $\pm$ 10 %                            | measured across NP1; NS2 and NS3 both shorted, NAUX open; LCR meter 100 kHz, 1 V                                              |
| DC overlap                      | $\geq$ 90 % of initial inductance                  | measured across NP1, every other winding open; dc 16 A overlapped on the 100 kHz, 1 V signal; normal temperature (mark 7)     |
| Primary current                 | 10.9 A rms / 18.3 A pk                             | line-cycle rms (mark 2) and composite peak (mark 1), both at the HB edge (173 Vac, half bridge), full load                    |
| Secondary current, each winding | 28.3 A rms / 99 A pk                               | line-cycle rms (mark 5) and peak (mark 4), both at the HB edge, full load                                                     |
| Core area                       | $A_e \geq 103 \text{ mm}^2$                        | holds $B_{pk}$ at or below 0.20 T at $f_r$ (mark 6)                                                                           |
| Switching frequency             | 127 to 249 kHz                                     | at the line peak, full load, from the HB edge to the FB edge; near the zero crossings it falls towards $f_o = 90 \text{ kHz}$ |

**Table 18: Transformer specification for the worked design.**

## 7.13 The output bank, as sized

Both conditions of Section 6.23; the larger wins. **Ripple**, with  $\Delta v$  as a fraction:

**Equation 36, repeated**

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{P_{out}}{2\pi f_{l,min} \Delta v V_{out}^2}$$

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{657.5 \text{ W}}{2\pi \times 47 \text{ Hz} \times 0.05 \times 625 \text{ V}^2} = \mathbf{71.25 \text{ mF}}$$

**Hold-up**, starting half a ripple below  $V_{out}$ :

**Equation 37, repeated**

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{2P_{out}T_{hold}}{\left(V_{out} - \frac{1}{2}\Delta v_{pp}\right)^2 - V_{o,min}^2}$$

$$C_{out} \geq \frac{2 \times 657.5 \text{ W} \times 0.012 \text{ s}}{24.408^2 - 19^2} = \mathbf{67.22 \text{ mF}} \quad (\text{started at } V_{out} : 59.77 \text{ mF})$$

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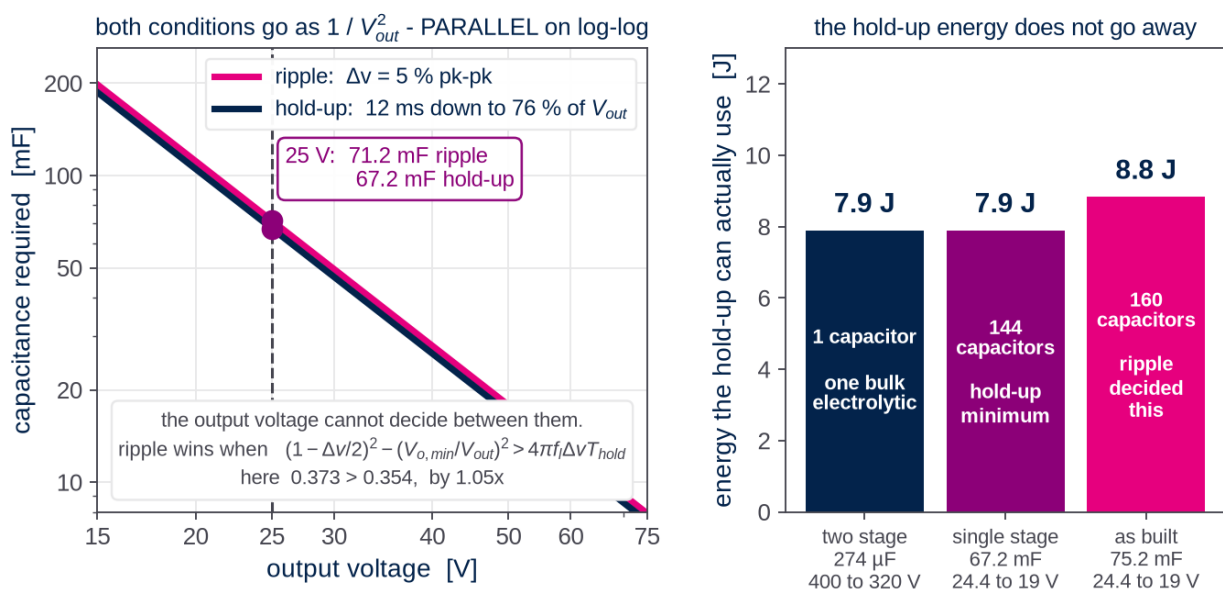
Which wins, at  $k = V_{o,min}/V_{out} = 0.760$ :

Equation 38, repeated

$$\left(1 - \frac{\Delta v}{2}\right)^2 - k^2 > 4\pi f_l \Delta v T_{hold}$$

$$0.373 > 0.354 \Rightarrow \text{ripple decides}$$

The left side is only 5.3 % larger; allow more than 5.2 % ripple and hold-up would decide instead. The bank fitted is the next assembly above 71.2 mF: **470  $\mu$ F  $\times$  160 = 75.2 mF.**



**Figure 47: Left: both conditions fall as  $1/V_{out}^2$ ; at 25 V ripple asks for 71.2 mF and hold-up for 67.2 mF. Right: the same 7.9 J of hold-up energy is a 274  $\mu$ F part on a 400 V bus and 67.2 mF here, 245 times more. That ratio is the price of the architecture.**

| Quantity                            | Value              | Against                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Achieved ripple                     | 1.18 V (4.74 %)    | 5 % allowed                                                                                                                |
| Achieved hold-up                    | 13.42 ms           | 12 ms required at 100 Vac, from the ripple trough down to 19 V — 15.10 ms if started at $V_{out}$ instead of at the trough |
| Ripple current, switching component | 23.8 A rms         | —                                                                                                                          |
| Ripple current, $2f_l$ component    | 18.6 A rms         | orthogonal to the above                                                                                                    |
| Ripple current, total               | <b>30.24 A rms</b> | 0.19 A in each of 160 parts                                                                                                |
| Bank ESR                            | 0.1875 m $\Omega$  | 30 m $\Omega$ each, 160 in parallel                                                                                        |
| Ripple and noise                    | 17.4 mV            | with the 10 $\mu$ F ceramic bypass                                                                                         |

**Table 19: What the selected bank then delivers, and what it has to survive.**

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## 7.14 Where the power goes

The specification allowed 27.3 W of loss, split three ways before any component existed. The device losses computed afterwards need not agree with that split, and here they do not.

| Item                                            | Value          | Note                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Budget</b> — input bridge                    | 5.52 W         | synchronous bridge assumed                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Budget</b> — EMI filter                      | 8.34 W         | —                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Budget</b> — LLC stage                       | 13.42 W        | $\eta_{HB} = 98\%$ of $P_{in,LLC}$                                                                                                                           |
| Primary conduction, standing device             | 9.65 W         | the half-bridge leg that never switches — the hottest single device                                                                                          |
| Primary conduction, the two switching positions | 9.65 W         | S1 and S2 in half bridge, 4.83 W each; conduction only, switching loss not in it                                                                             |
| Secondary rectifiers                            | 5.65 W         | 1.411 W per device, 2 in parallel per leg                                                                                                                    |
| Current-sense resistors                         | 2.86 W         | line-cycle average; 4.54 W at the worst switching cycle                                                                                                      |
| Output capacitor ESR                            | 0.162 W        | all of the ripple current in the switching-frequency ESR; the $2f_i$ part in the higher 120 Hz ESR is not in it ( $\tan\delta$ of the fitted part not known) |
| <b>Itemised total</b>                           | <b>27.97 W</b> | and the magnetics are not in it                                                                                                                              |

Table 20: The budget as assumed, and the device losses as computed. The second block is not a breakdown of the first.

**The standing primary device**, the low-side switch of the idle leg in half-bridge morphing, carries the whole line-cycle rms continuously, with  $R_{DS(on)}$  **hot** at  $k_T = 1.8$  times the 25 °C 45 m $\Omega$  (Section 6.24):

$$P_{mos,dc} = I_{pri}^2 k_T R_{DS(on),25} = (10.915)^2 \cdot 1.8 \cdot 45 \times 10^{-3} = 9.65 \text{ W}$$

**Each secondary rectifier** carries the leg current over the 2 devices in parallel, with  $k_T = 1.9$  on 3.7 m $\Omega$ :

$$P_{SR} = \left(\frac{28.34}{2}\right)^2 \cdot 1.9 \cdot 3.7 \times 10^{-3} = 1.411 \text{ W per device}$$

**The efficiency assumption is optimistic.** The itemised device losses are 28.0 W against the 13.4 W that  $\eta_{HB} = 98\%$  allows, before the transformer. Nothing electrical depends on it; the thermal design does, and that is settled by measurement.

## 7.15 What the semiconductors have to be

Requirements, not part numbers (Section 6.24).

| Item                         | Requirement                                  |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Primary drain-source voltage | $\geq 485 \text{ V}$ , so a 600 V class part |

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| Item                            | Requirement                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary body diode              | fast recovery: a capacitive excursion turns a device on onto the other's conducting body diode (Section 2.8) |
| Primary $R_{DS(on)}$ per device | $\leq 25.2 \text{ m}\Omega$ <b>hot</b> to meet the loss budget                                               |
| Primary $C_{o(tr)}$             | small enough that the tank can swing the node inside 220 ns                                                  |
| Secondary drain-source voltage  | $\geq 80 \text{ V}$ including the centre-tap doubling                                                        |
| Secondary rectifier current     | 28.34 A rms per leg, 98.6 A peak                                                                             |
| Secondary package               | check the lead and clip rating, not only the die                                                             |

**Table 21: Semiconductor requirements for the worked design.**

## 7.16 The voltage loop, as built

The method of Sections 6.26 to 6.33, with this converter's numbers, in the order they are found.

**Step 1 — the output divider**, with  $R_I = 100 \text{ k}\Omega$  chosen:

**Equation 44, repeated**

$$V_{out} = V_R \left( 1 + \frac{R_I}{R_O} \right)$$

$$R_O = \frac{V_R R_I}{V_{out} - V_R} = \frac{2.495 \text{ V} \times 100 \text{ k}\Omega}{25.0 \text{ V} - 2.495 \text{ V}} = 11.09 \text{ k}\Omega \rightarrow \mathbf{11 \text{ k}\Omega}$$

$$V_{out} = 2.495 \text{ V} \times \left( 1 + \frac{100}{11} \right) = \mathbf{25.18 \text{ V}}$$

**Step 2 — the plant.** With  $K_{pwr} = 2K_{HV}/(K_M K_{FF})$ , the slope of Equation 15,  $V_{FB} = K_{pwr} R_{CS} P_{in,LLC} = 0.167 \times 24 \text{ m}\Omega \times 670.9 \text{ W} = 2.689 \text{ V}$  (Equation 15). Then

**Equation 40, repeated**

$$G_{plant}(s) = \frac{v_{out}(s)}{v_{FB}(s)} = \frac{G_o}{s}, \quad G_o = \frac{P_{out}}{V_{out} V_{FB} C_{out}} \quad [\text{rad/s}]$$

$$G_o = \frac{657.5 \text{ W}}{25.0 \text{ V} \times 2.689 \text{ V} \times 75.2 \text{ mF}} = \mathbf{130.1 \text{ rad/s}}, \quad f_{cto} = \frac{130.1}{2\pi} = 20.7 \text{ Hz}$$

**Step 3 — the gain allowed at  $2f_i$** , for 5 % third harmonic:

**Equation 41, repeated**

$$\Delta V_{loop} = \frac{P_{out}}{V_{out}} \frac{1}{2\pi f_i C_{out}}$$

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$$\Delta V_{loop} = \frac{657.5 \text{ W}}{25.0 \text{ V}} \cdot \frac{1}{2\pi \times 47 \text{ Hz} \times 75.2 \text{ mF}} = \mathbf{1.184 \text{ V}}$$

Equation 43, repeated

$$G_{EA}(2f_l) \leq \frac{4 V_{FB} D_3}{\Delta V_{loop}}$$

$$G_{EA}(2f_l) \leq \frac{4 \times 2.689 \text{ V} \times 0.05}{1.184 \text{ V}} = \mathbf{0.4541}$$

**Step 4 — the K factor**, for a target phase margin of 50° (tan 50° = 1.1918) and  $\alpha_v = 1.2$ :

Equation 49, repeated

$$K_v = \frac{1}{2\alpha_v} \left[ (1 + \alpha_v^2) \tan \Phi_M + \sqrt{(1 + \alpha_v^2 \tan \Phi_M)^2 + 4\alpha_v^2} \right]$$

$$K_v = \frac{1}{2 \times 1.2} \left[ (1 + 1.2^2) \times 1.1918 + \sqrt{(1 + 1.2^2 \times 1.1918)^2 + 4 \times 1.2^2} \right] = \mathbf{2.7218}$$

**Step 5 — the compensator gain constant:**

Equation 50, repeated

$$EA_o = \frac{2\pi (2f_l) G_{EA}(2f_l)}{K_v^2}$$

$$EA_o = \frac{2\pi \times 94 \text{ Hz} \times 0.4541}{2.7218^2} = \mathbf{36.20 \text{ rad/s}}$$

**Step 6 — zero and pole**, with  $\Gamma_v = 0.744 \times 264.0 / 173.24 = 1.1338$ :

Equation 51, repeated

$$f_{MB} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_o K_v EA_o}{\Gamma_v}}, \quad f_p = K_v f_{MB}, \quad f_z = \frac{f_{MB}}{K_v}$$

$$f_{MB} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{130.06 \times 2.7218 \times 36.20}{1.1338}} = \mathbf{16.92 \text{ Hz}}$$

$$f_p = 2.7218 \times 16.92 = \mathbf{46.06 \text{ Hz}}, \quad f_z = \frac{16.92}{2.7218} = \mathbf{6.217 \text{ Hz}}$$

**Step 7 — the bias parts**, with the TL431 minimum current 0.8 mA,  $V_Z = 12 \text{ V}$ ,  $V_{Fo} = 1.15 \text{ V}$ ,  $I_{FB,steady} = 150 \text{ }\mu\text{A}$ ,  $I_{FB,max} = 300 \text{ }\mu\text{A}$ ,  $CTR_s = 0.37$ ,  $CTR_m = 0.53$ :

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Equation 45, repeated

$$R_P \leq \frac{V_{Fo}}{I_{min}}$$

$$R_P \leq \frac{1.15 \text{ V}}{0.8 \text{ mA}} = 1.437 \text{ k}\Omega \rightarrow \mathbf{1.3 \text{ k}\Omega} \text{ (rounded down)}$$

Equation 48, repeated

$$R_{B,max} = \frac{V_Z - (V_R + V_{Fo})}{V_{Fo}/R_P + I_{FB,steady}/CTR_s}$$

$$R_{B,min} = \frac{V_Z - (V_R + V_{Fo})}{V_{Fo}/R_P + I_{FB,max}/CTR_m}$$

$$R_{B,max} = \frac{12 - (2.495 + 1.15) \text{ V}}{1.15/1.3 \text{ mA} + 150 \mu\text{A}/0.37} = \frac{8.355 \text{ V}}{0.885 \text{ mA} + 0.405 \text{ mA}} = \mathbf{6.48 \text{ k}\Omega}$$

$$R_{B,min} = \frac{8.355 \text{ V}}{0.885 \text{ mA} + 300 \mu\text{A}/0.53} = \mathbf{5.76 \text{ k}\Omega} \rightarrow R_B = \mathbf{6.2 \text{ k}\Omega}$$

**Step 8 — the compensation parts**, with  $R_{FB} = 35 \text{ k}\Omega$ ,  $C_{opto} = 3 \text{ nF}$  and the high-frequency pole placed at 1000 Hz:

Equation 52, repeated

$$C_{Fo} = \frac{f_z}{f_p} \cdot \frac{CTR_s R_{FB}}{R_I R_B E A_o}, \quad C_F = C_{Fo} \left( \frac{f_p}{f_z} - 1 \right)$$

$$R_F = \frac{1}{2\pi f_z C_F}, \quad C_{fx} = \frac{1}{2\pi f_{pHF} R_{FB}} - C_{opto}$$

$$C_{Fo} = \frac{6.217}{46.06} \cdot \frac{0.37 \times 35 \text{ k}\Omega}{100 \text{ k}\Omega \times 6.2 \text{ k}\Omega \times 36.20} = 77.9 \text{ nF} \rightarrow \mathbf{82 \text{ nF}}$$

$$C_F = 82 \text{ nF} \times \left( \frac{46.06}{6.217} - 1 \right) = 526 \text{ nF} \rightarrow \mathbf{560 \text{ nF}}$$

$$R_F = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 6.217 \text{ Hz} \times 560 \text{ nF}} = 45.7 \text{ k}\Omega \rightarrow \mathbf{47 \text{ k}\Omega}$$

$$C_{fx} = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 1000 \text{ Hz} \times 35 \text{ k}\Omega} - 3 \text{ nF} = 1.547 \text{ nF} \rightarrow \mathbf{1.55 \text{ nF}}$$

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Step 9 — what the standard parts give:

Equation 47, repeated

$$EA_o = \frac{CTR R_{FB}}{(C_F + C_{Fo}) R_I R_B} \quad [\text{rad/s}], \quad f_z = \frac{1}{2\pi R_F C_F}$$

$$f_p = \frac{1}{2\pi R_F C_{ser}}, \quad C_{ser} = \frac{C_F C_{Fo}}{C_F + C_{Fo}}, \quad f_{px} = \frac{1}{2\pi R_{FB} (C_{opto} + C_{fx})}$$

$$EA_o = \frac{0.37 \times 35 \text{ k}\Omega}{(560 + 82) \text{ nF} \times 100 \text{ k}\Omega \times 6.2 \text{ k}\Omega} = \mathbf{32.53 \text{ rad/s}}$$

$$f_z = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 47 \text{ k}\Omega \times 560 \text{ nF}} = \mathbf{6.047 \text{ Hz}}$$

$$C_{ser} = \frac{560 \times 82}{560 + 82} \text{ nF} = 71.5 \text{ nF}, \quad f_p = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 47 \text{ k}\Omega \times 71.5 \text{ nF}} = \mathbf{47.34 \text{ Hz}}$$

$$f_{px} = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 35 \text{ k}\Omega \times (3 + 1.55) \text{ nF}} = \mathbf{999 \text{ Hz}}$$

Step 10 — crossover and phase margin.  $G_o EA_o = 4231$ , so the iteration starts at  $\omega_c = 65.0 \text{ rad/s}$  and settles at

Equation 54, repeated

$$\omega_c \leftarrow \sqrt{G_o EA_o A(\omega_c)}, \quad \text{starting from } \omega_c = \sqrt{G_o EA_o}$$

$$\omega_c = \mathbf{110.4 \text{ rad/s}}, \quad f_c = \frac{110.4}{2\pi} = \mathbf{17.57 \text{ Hz}}, \quad |T(\omega_c)| = 1.0003 \quad (\text{check : } 1)$$

Equation 55, repeated

$$\Phi_M = \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_z} - \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_p} - \arctan \frac{\omega_c}{\omega_{px}}$$

$$\Phi_M = \arctan \frac{110.4}{38.0} - \arctan \frac{110.4}{297.5} - \arctan \frac{110.4}{6279} = 71.0^\circ - 20.4^\circ - 1.0^\circ = \mathbf{49.6^\circ}$$

Step 11 — the gain margin:

Equation 56, repeated

$$f_{180} = \sqrt{f_p f_{px} - f_z (f_p + f_{px})}, \quad GM = -20 \log_{10} |T(f_{180})|$$

$$f_{180} = \sqrt{47.34 \times 999 - 6.047 \times (47.34 + 999)} \text{ Hz} = \mathbf{202 \text{ Hz}}$$

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$$|T(f_{180})| = 0.0196, \quad GM = -20\log_{10} 0.0196 = \mathbf{34.2 \text{ dB}}$$

**Step 12 — the third harmonic of the built loop**, at  $2f_l = 94 \text{ Hz}$  ( $\omega = 590.6 \text{ rad/s}$ ):

$$G_{EA}(2f_l) = \frac{32.53}{590.6} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{1 + (590.6/38.0)^2}}{\sqrt{1 + (590.6/297.5)^2} \sqrt{1 + (590.6/6279)^2}} = \mathbf{0.3843} \quad (\leq 0.4541)$$

**Equation 42, repeated**

$$D_3 = \frac{G_{EA}(2f_l) \Delta V_{loop}}{4 V_{FB}}$$

$$D_3 = \frac{0.3843 \times 1.184 \text{ V}}{4 \times 2.689 \text{ V}} = \mathbf{4.23 \%} \quad (\text{budget } 5 \%)$$

**Step 13 — the feedback ripple at the burst point**, with burst entry at 75 W:

**Equation 57, repeated**

$$\Delta V_{FB} = \frac{P_{in,BM}}{V_{out}} \frac{1}{2\pi f_l C_{out}} G_{EA}(2f_l)$$

$$\Delta V_{FB} = \frac{75 \text{ W}}{25.0 \text{ V}} \cdot \frac{1}{2\pi \times 47 \text{ Hz} \times 75.2 \text{ mF}} \times 0.3843 = \mathbf{51.9 \text{ mV}}$$

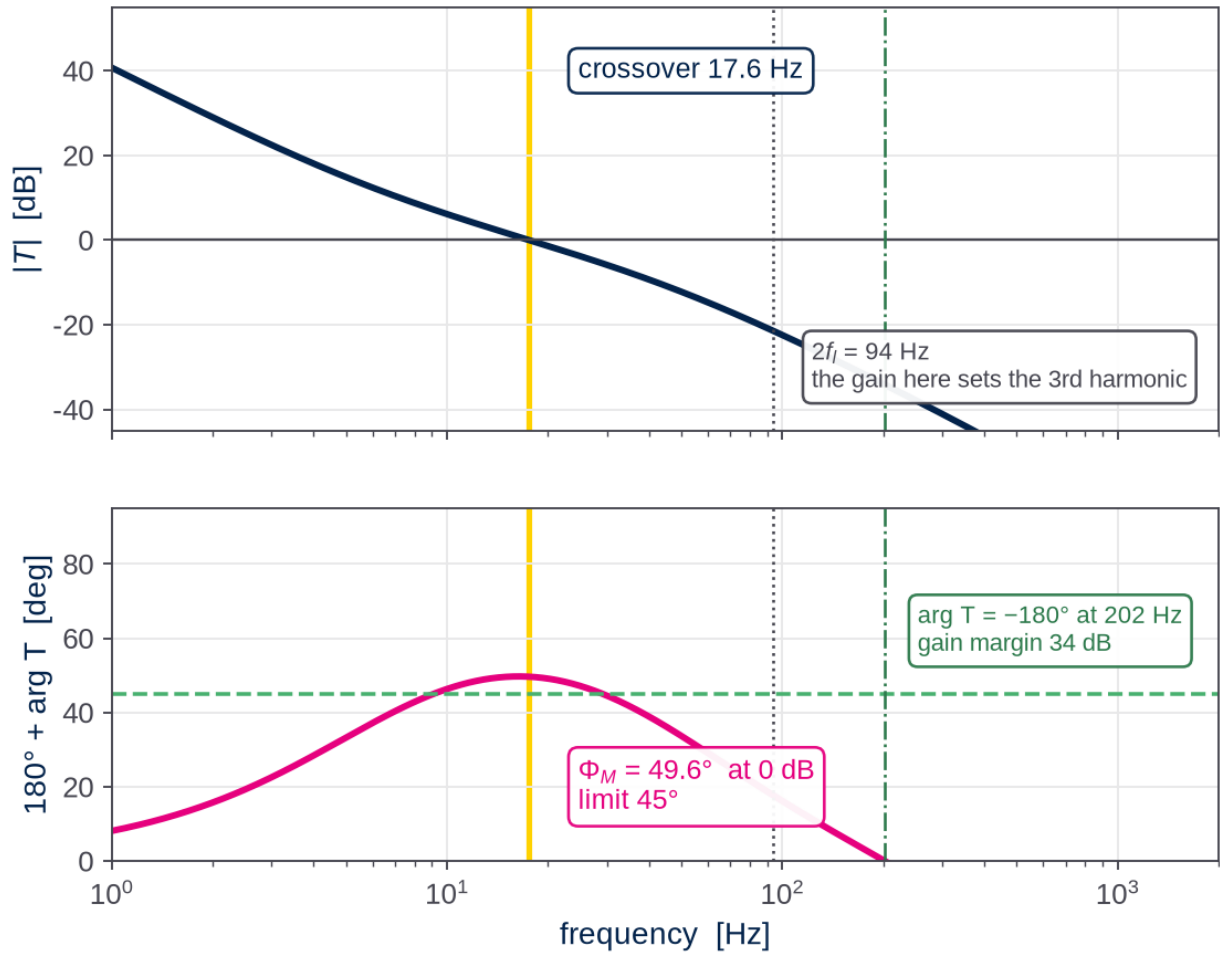
**Equation 58, repeated**

$$\Delta R_{BM} = \frac{\Delta V_{FB}}{2 \times 0.01 \text{ V/k}\Omega}$$

$$\Delta R_{BM} = \frac{51.9 \text{ mV}}{2 \times 0.01 \text{ V/k}\Omega} = \mathbf{2.60 \text{ k}\Omega}, \quad R_{BM} = 30 - 2.60 = \mathbf{27.4 \text{ k}\Omega}$$

The fitted 30 k $\Omega$  is kept for now: the burst entry it is set from is an assumption (Table 6), so  $R_{BM}$  is traded against this ripple once the standby power has been measured (Appendix 10.4).

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**Figure 48:**  $|T|$  and  $180^\circ + \arg T$  of the loop as built. The second trace is the phase margin only at the crossover; the gain margin is read at  $f_{180^\circ}$ .

| Quantity                                | Value                                  | Against                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Divider $R_I / R_O$                     | 100 / 11 k $\Omega$                    | regulates to 25.18 V                                                                          |
| Bias $R_P, R_B$                         | 1.3 k $\Omega$ , 6.2 k $\Omega$        | $R_P \leq 1.44$ k $\Omega$ ; $R_B$ in 5.76 to 6.48 k $\Omega$                                 |
| Compensation $C_{F0}, C_F, R_F, C_{fx}$ | 82 nF, 560 nF, 47 k $\Omega$ , 1.55 nF | zero 6.05 Hz, pole 47.3 Hz, pole 999 Hz                                                       |
| Crossover $f_c$                         | 17.57 Hz                               | the 15 to 20 Hz this topology lands in                                                        |
| Phase margin                            | 49.6°                                  | target 50°, floor 45°                                                                         |
| Gain margin                             | 34.2 dB at 202 Hz                      | 6 dB floor, 10 dB comfortable                                                                 |
| Third harmonic on the input current     | 4.23 %                                 | budget 5 %                                                                                    |
| Feedback ripple at the burst point      | 52 mV                                  | clears the burst threshold if $R_{BM}$ moves from the fitted 30 k $\Omega$ to 27.4 k $\Omega$ |

**Table 22:** The voltage loop, as built.

## 7.17 The parts around the controller

The results; the following sections derive each value in the order it has to be done.

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| Part             | Value                            | Result                                                      |
|------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| $C_T / R_T$      | 470 pF / 11 kΩ                   | $f_{\text{Min}}$ 92.2 kHz, $f_{\text{Max}}$ 319.6 kHz       |
| $R_{\text{CS}}$  | 24.0 mΩ (120 mΩ × 5 in parallel) | OCP1 at 1.251 × the composite peak                          |
| $R_{\text{CFG}}$ | 30 kΩ                            | $V_{\text{BO}}$ 120 V peak (84.8 Vac rms), morphing enabled |
| $R_{\text{BM}}$  | 30 kΩ                            | burst-mode entry point                                      |
| ZCD divider      | 330 kΩ / 19 kΩ                   | OVP1 28.16 V, OVP2 30.61 V                                  |
| $C_{\text{in}}$  | 2200 nF film                     | about 3.2 nF/W — there is no bulk capacitor                 |
| Compensation     | 82 nF / 560 nF / 47 kΩ / 1.55 nF | $f_c$ 17.57 Hz, $\Phi_M$ 49.64°                             |

Table 23: Controller network for the worked design.

### 7.18 The oscillator: $C_T$ first, then $R_T$

The VCO charges  $C_T$  from  $V_{\text{ref}}/R_T$  plus the error-amplifier current  $I_{\text{EA}}$  up to  $V_{\text{ref}} = 1.5$  V, then adds a fixed idle time:

Equation 60

$$\frac{T_{\text{sw}}}{2} = \frac{C_T V_{\text{ref}}}{\frac{V_{\text{ref}}}{R_T} + I_{\text{EA}}} + T_{\text{idle}}$$

$I_{\text{EA}}$  is the only control input. More current, higher frequency, less power.  $C_T$  is chosen first because it sets the span,  $R_T$  after it because it sets the floor:

Equation 61

$$C_{T,\text{max}} = \frac{I_{\text{EA,max}}}{2V_{\text{ref}}} \cdot \frac{(1 - 2T_{\text{idle}}f_{\text{sw,max,op}})(1 - 2T_{\text{idle}}f_{\text{sw,min}})}{f_{\text{sw,max,op}} - f_{\text{sw,min}}}, \quad C_{T,\text{min}} = \frac{1}{R_{T,\text{max}}} \left( \frac{1}{2f_{\text{sw,min}}} - T_{\text{idle}} \right)$$

Equation 62

$$R_{T,\text{ceil}} = \frac{1}{C_T} \left( \frac{1}{2f_{\text{sw,min}}} - T_{\text{idle}} \right)$$

with  $f_{\text{sw,min}} = f_o = 90.4$  kHz;  $f_{\text{sw,max,op}} = 249.0$  kHz, the highest frequency the converter actually runs at (the full-bridge edge at the line peak), not the 225 kHz specification;  $I_{\text{EA,max}} = 400$  μA,  $V_{\text{ref}} = 1.5$  V and  $T_{\text{idle}} = 250$  ns:

$$C_{T,\text{max}} = \frac{400 \times 10^{-6}}{2 \cdot 1.5} \cdot \frac{(1 - 2 \cdot 250 \times 10^{-9} \cdot 249.0 \times 10^3)(1 - 2 \cdot 250 \times 10^{-9} \cdot 90.4 \times 10^3)}{(249.0 - 90.4) \times 10^3} = 703 \text{ pF}$$

and the floor condition,  $f_{\text{Min}}$  brought down to  $f_o$  with  $R_T$  at its 30 kΩ maximum, gives  $C_{T,\text{min}} = 176$  pF. The datasheet allows 270 to 1000 pF, so the window is 270 to 703 pF, and the part is taken from its middle:  $C_T = 470$  pF, C0G. Then

$$R_{T,\text{ceil}} = \frac{1}{470 \times 10^{-12}} \left( \frac{1}{2 \cdot 90.4 \times 10^3} - 250 \times 10^{-9} \right) = 11.24 \text{ kΩ} \rightarrow 11 \text{ kΩ}$$

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**$R_{T,ceil}$  is a maximum.**  $f_{Min}$  falls as  $R_T$  grows, so rounding up drops the clamp below  $f_o$ . Round it **down**.

The selected pair produces

**Equation 63**

$$f_{Min} = \frac{1}{2(C_T R_T + T_{idle})}, \quad f_{Max} = \frac{1}{2 \left( \frac{C_T}{\frac{I_{EA,max}}{V_{ref}} + \frac{1}{R_T}} + T_{idle} \right)}$$

$f_{Min} = 1/[2(470 \text{ pF} \times 11 \text{ k}\Omega + 0.25 \text{ }\mu\text{s})] = \mathbf{92.25 \text{ kHz}}$ , which must clear  $f_o$ .

| Quantity  | Value              | Limit                                                                         | Margin        |
|-----------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| $f_{Min}$ | 92.2 kHz           | above $f_o = 90.4 \text{ kHz}$                                                | 1.021         |
| $f_{Max}$ | 319.6 kHz          | above the highest operating $f_{sw} = 249.0 \text{ kHz}$ (FB edge, line peak) | 1.283         |
| $f_{SU}$  | 503.5 kHz          | below the 675 kHz silicon ceiling                                             | 1.341         |
| $R_T C_T$ | 5.17 $\mu\text{s}$ | 2.5 to 12 $\mu\text{s}$                                                       | 2.068 / 2.321 |
| $R_T$     | 11 k $\Omega$      | 5 to 30 k $\Omega$                                                            | 2.200 / 2.727 |
| $C_T$     | 470 pF             | 270 to 1000 pF                                                                | 1.741 / 2.128 |

**Table 24: Oscillator: what the two parts produce, and the limits each result has to clear.**

**$T_{idle}$  is the weakest number in this chapter.** The draft datasheet implies 700 ns in its frequency expressions and 350 ns in its  $C_{T,max}$  expression, and its Table 2 back-solves to about 250 ns; this design uses 250 ns. At 700 ns  $f_{Min}$  would be 85.2 kHz, below  $f_o$ , and  $f_{Max}$  248.2 kHz against the 249.0 kHz the FB edge needs. Measure it first.

## 7.19 The current-sense resistor, which sets three things at once

Two conditions, the smaller wins:

**Equation 64**

$$R_{CS,max1} = \frac{16.8 \text{ }\Omega \cdot \text{W}}{P_{in}} \quad R_{CS,max2} = \frac{0.55 \text{ V}}{I_{Lr,pk}}$$

The first is the maximum-power law (Section 4.6), the second the OCP1 trip point. The first is written with  $P_{in}$ , as the datasheet writes it, not with the  $P_{in,LLC}$  the pin senses; that is 2 % conservative:

$$R_{CS,max1} = \frac{16.8}{684.8} = 0.02453 \text{ }\Omega = 24.53 \text{ m}\Omega, \quad R_{CS,max2} = \frac{0.55}{18.32} = 0.03003 \text{ }\Omega = 30.03 \text{ m}\Omega$$

so the power law limits. Dissipation at the worst switching cycle fixes how many resistors share it:

## Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

$$P_{CS} = I_{pri,rms}^2 R_{CS} = (13.76)^2 \cdot 24.0 \times 10^{-3} = 4.54 \text{ W} \Rightarrow N = 5 \text{ in parallel}$$

5 × 120 mΩ in parallel give **R<sub>CS</sub> = 24.0 mΩ**.

R<sub>CS</sub> sits in the bridge return, so R<sub>CS,max2</sub> uses the composite peak. I<sub>trafo,pk</sub> = 16.37 A instead of I<sub>Lr,pk</sub> = 18.32 A would loosen the over-current protection by about 12 %.

| Result                                   | Value                      | Against                                                         |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Maximum input power                      | 700.0 W                    | P <sub>in</sub> = 684.8 W                                       |
| OCP1 trip                                | 22.92 A                    | composite peak 18.32 A, margin 1.251                            |
| OCP2 trip                                | 31.25 A                    | switching stops at once; restart after 50 μs at f <sub>su</sub> |
| Sense dissipation, worst switching cycle | 4.54 W total, 0.909 W each | 1 W parts, margin 1.100                                         |

**Table 25: What the selected R<sub>CS</sub> then fixes.**

### 7.20 Burst mode: one resistor, read once at power-up

**Equation 65**

$$R_{BM} = 16.7 \frac{\text{k}\Omega}{\text{V}^2} R_{CS} P_{in,BM}, \quad V_{BM,eq} = 0.01 \frac{\text{V}}{\text{k}\Omega} R_{BM} + 0.5 \text{ V}$$

Burst starts at P<sub>in,BM</sub> = 11 % × 684.8 W = 75.3 W:

$$R_{BM} = 16.7 \cdot 24.0 \times 10^{-3} \cdot 75.3 = 30.1 \text{ k}\Omega \rightarrow 30 \text{ k}\Omega, \quad V_{BM,eq} = 0.01 \times 30 + 0.5 = 0.800 \text{ V}$$

Valid range 15 to 140 kΩ; tied to ground, burst mode is off. Check this threshold against the feedback ripple (Section 6.33) or the converter chatters in and out of burst.

### 7.21 Brown-out and bridge configuration: the CFG pin

One resistor, two jobs, both read at power-up:

**Equation 66**

$$V_{BO,pk} = R_{CFG} \times 4 \frac{\text{V}}{\text{k}\Omega}, \quad V_{BO,rms} = \frac{V_{BO,pk}}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Brown-out is compared against the *peak* of the mains, so the √2 is easy to drop. Brown-out just below the lowest input voltage:

$$R_{CFG,max} = \frac{\sqrt{2} \cdot 90}{4} = 31.82 \text{ k}\Omega \rightarrow 30 \text{ k}\Omega$$

That is a maximum, so it rounds down; the selected part sets

## Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

$$V_{BO,rms} = \frac{30 \cdot 4}{\sqrt{2}} = 84.85 \text{ Vac}$$

against a 90 Vac minimum, margin 1.061. Rounding up would stop the converter starting at the lowest input voltage.

| R <sub>CFG</sub> | LOUT2  | Configuration                                                      |
|------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 15 kΩ            | open   | morphing, fixed brown-out: off below 60 V peak, on above 70 V peak |
| 15 to 47 kΩ      | open   | <b>morphing, adjustable brown-out — this design</b>                |
| 47 to 100 kΩ     | open   | fixed full bridge                                                  |
| 15 kΩ            | to GND | fixed half bridge, split C <sub>r</sub> , fixed brown-out          |
| 15 to 100 kΩ     | to GND | fixed half bridge, split C <sub>r</sub> , adjustable brown-out     |

**Table 26: What R<sub>CFG</sub> and LOUT2 select together. The 235 and 245 V thresholds are fixed inside the IC and cannot be moved.**

For universal input the window is 15 kΩ to 31.8 kΩ; the 47 kΩ morphing limit never applies. Hang nothing on LOUT2: a pull-down under about 8 kΩ reads as fixed half bridge.

### 7.22 Output sensing and over-voltage: the ZCD divider

The divider ratio alone sets both over-voltage thresholds; the absolute values only set the bias current:

#### Equation 67

$$R_{ZCD,L} = \frac{2.3 \text{ V}}{I_{bias}}, \quad R_{ZCD,H} = R_{ZCD,L} \left( \frac{n_{aux}}{n_{sec}} \frac{V_{OVP1,out}}{2.3 \text{ V}} - 1 \right)$$

#### Equation 68

$$V_{OVP1} = \frac{2.3 \text{ V}}{n_{aux}/n_{sec}} \left( \frac{R_{ZCD,H}}{R_{ZCD,L}} + 1 \right), \quad V_{OVP2} = \frac{2.5}{2.3} V_{OVP1}$$

OVP1 10 % above the output is 27.50 V. The lower resistor comes from the bias current, 120 μA, the upper from the ratio, with  $n_{aux}/n_{sec} = 1.5$ :

$$R_{ZCD,L} = \frac{2.3}{120 \times 10^{-6}} = 19.17 \text{ kΩ} \rightarrow 19 \text{ kΩ}$$

$$R_{ZCD,H} = 19 \left( \frac{1.5 \cdot 27.5}{2.3} - 1 \right) = 321.8 \text{ kΩ} \rightarrow 330 \text{ kΩ}$$

The upper resistor is the *next E24 value above* the calculation, so OVP1 lands clear of the ripple crest. The fitted pair gives

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$$V_{OVP1} = \frac{2.3}{1.5} \left( \frac{330}{19} + 1 \right) = 28.16 \text{ V}, \quad V_{OVP2} = \frac{2.5}{2.3} \cdot 28.16 = 30.61 \text{ V}$$

Start-up hands over to the loop when the ZCD pin reaches 1.36 V, the datasheet's start-up end threshold. Through the same divider that is 1.36/2.3 of the OVP1 output voltage: 16.65 V of output.

Swapping the two resistors makes OVP1 trip below a volt of output, so the converter never starts. Reversed winding polarity makes the bridge hard switch from the first pulse.

The ceiling that the 25 V  $V_{CC}$  rating puts on the turns ratio applies only when the auxiliary winding supplies  $V_{CC}$ . Here it senses only (37.5 V nominal, 45.9 V at OVP2), so the only constraint is whole turns.

## 7.23 HVSU and $V_{CC}$

- **HVSU connects ahead of the bridge**, on the ac side, through one 1000 V diode per line; behind the bridge X-capacitor discharge and brown-out detection both stop working.
- The  $V_{CC}$  capacitor must hold the IC from  $V_{CCon} = 17 \text{ V}$  to  $V_{CCoff} = 8 \text{ V}$  until the supply takes over; the start-up unit stops 120 ms after  $V_{CCon}$  regardless.
- A diode between a linear regulator and the pin keeps the start-up current out of the regulator. 100 nF at the pin.

## 7.24 Controller pin rules

| Pin          | Rule                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ISEN         | No filter and no series resistor. The maximum-power law and the over-current threshold share this pin.                                 |
| CFG, BM      | No capacitor. Both are strapped at power-up. An out-of-range CFG resistor latches the controller off.                                  |
| DRV_EN, RT   | No capacitor. Both are sampled briefly every few milliseconds and a capacitor is read as a fault.                                      |
| LOUT2        | No pull-down if morphing is used. A few kilohms to ground reads as a fixed half bridge.                                                |
| HVSU         | Connect ahead of the input bridge, on the ac side. Behind the bridge, both X-capacitor discharge and brown-out detection stop working. |
| ZCD          | Auxiliary winding polarity must make ZCD positive when the low side of leg 1 is on. Reversed, the bridge hard switches.                |
| HOUTx, LOUTx | Logic-level outputs, not gate drivers. External half-bridge drivers are required.                                                      |

**Table 27: Pin rules that must not be broken.**

## 7.25 Protections, and where each threshold is set

Each threshold is fixed by a resistor already chosen, so a change made for one reason moves a threshold set for another.

| Protection                        | Set by                       | This design                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brown-out, on the rectified mains | $R_{CFG}$ , read at power-up | $V_{BO}$ 120 V peak = 84.8 Vac rms, clear of the 90 Vac minimum by 1.061 |

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| Protection                                                     | Set by                                                                                                                        | This design                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First-level over-current, OCP1: raises the switching frequency | $R_{CS}$ — the same resistor as the maximum-power law                                                                         | 22.92 A against a composite peak of 18.32 A, a margin of 1.251             |
| Second-level over-current, OCP2                                | $R_{CS}$ , fixed ratio to OCP1                                                                                                | 31.25 A                                                                    |
| Output over-voltage, OVP1                                      | the ZCD divider on the auxiliary winding                                                                                      | 28.16 V, above the ripple crest and below OVP2                             |
| Second-level over-voltage, OVP2                                | the same divider                                                                                                              | 30.61 V                                                                    |
| Capacitive-mode protection                                     | internal, on the ISEN pin: ACP-soft raises the frequency, ACP-hard stops for 50 $\mu$ s and restarts at the maximum frequency | the last line of defence only — the frequency floor $f_{Min}$ is the first |
| Burst mode at light load                                       | $R_{BM}$ , read at power-up                                                                                                   | 30 k $\Omega$ ; the $2f_i$ feedback ripple is 52 mV, so see Section 6.33   |
| Loss of ZVS at the worst corner                                | not a protection — a design margin                                                                                            | swept, not estimated; Section 6.5                                          |

Table 28: Protections and the component that sets each one.

## 7.26 System design rules

The same material as a checklist.

- **Design the tank at the equivalent range**, 173.2 to 332.3 Vac, not at the mains range.
- **Expect  $\lambda$  near 0.5**. A two-stage inductance ratio cannot reach the gain at the lowest input voltage.
- **Keep  $f_{Min}$  above  $f_o$** ; the anti-capacitive protection is the last line, not the first.
- **Size the output bank from ripple and hold-up**, take the larger, then check the rms ripple current separately.
- **Crossover in the tens of hertz**; handle the surviving feedback ripple with  $R_{BM}$ , not a faster loop.
- **Measure both morphing edges** at full and light load.
- **Check the turns ratio as  $nV_{o,eff}$**  never as a bare ratio.
- **Judge over-current on the composite tank peak**.
- **Include the  $2f_i$  component** in the capacitor ripple current; judge a centre tap at the output node.
- **Carry  $\sqrt{d}$  into the secondary rms**; dropping it overstates the loss by about 26 % here.
- **Put  $L_{open}$  and  $L_{short}$  on the transformer drawing** beside the turns.
- **ESR at each current component's own frequency**: switching and  $2f_i$ .
- **Recheck ZVS after raising  $L_m$** .
- **Verify ZVS by sweeping the selected tank**; the closed form has no fixed error sign.
- **Record calculated and selected values separately**, and make every downstream check read the selected one.

## 7.27 What to measure first on hardware

In order; the first four decide whether the design is sound.

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- **$f_{sw}(\theta)$  over a line half cycle.** It settles  $T_{idle}$  and both oscillator clamps, the thinnest margin in the design.
- **Cold start into the full 75.2 mF bank.** The start-up window is finite and this risk is new to the architecture.
- **ZVS at the half-bridge edge** ( $245 V_{pk}$ , full load): calculated 460 ns against 220 ns. Then the worst point of the sweep, 25 % load, at the FB edge (166 Vac in full bridge, which the tank sees as 332 Vac), 401 ns, which is the figure this design is held to.
- **Switching frequency at the full-bridge edge** ( $235 V_{pk}$ , full load): calculated 249.0 kHz; it must not hit the VCO ceiling.
- **Input current and THD at 90 Vac, full load:** the zero-crossing dead zone.
- **Output ripple against what the load tolerates.**
- **Ripple current and temperature rise in the bank:** 30.24 A rms calculated, 0.19 A per part.
- **Device temperatures, in half-bridge morphing** above  $245 V_{pk}$ , where the standing device dissipates most. This decides the accepted loss-budget shortfall.
- **Feedback ripple against the burst threshold** at light load.
- **An ac dropout at the ripple trough:** output still above 19 V after 12 ms.
- **A step across the morphing band,** both directions.

## 8 List of symbols

The symbols used in this note. The controller's own electrical parameters are in its datasheet.

| Symbol                                          | Meaning                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The tank and its gain</b>                    |                                                                                                                                                                   |
| $C_r, L_r, L_m$                                 | resonant capacitor, series inductance and magnetising inductance of the tank model                                                                                |
| $Z_0, Z_{0,design}$                             | characteristic impedance $\sqrt{L_r/C_r}$ ; the value the tank is designed to, $R_{ac} Q_{ZVS}$                                                                   |
| $Z_{in}$                                        | input impedance the bridge drives; $\arg Z_{in} = 0$ is the capacitive boundary                                                                                   |
| $f_r, f_0$                                      | series resonance, and the lower resonance with $L_m$ included                                                                                                     |
| $f_{sw}, f_n$                                   | switching frequency, and the same normalised to $f_r$                                                                                                             |
| $f_{sw,max}, f_{sw,min}$                        | the specified maximum switching frequency, an input to $\lambda$ ; and the lowest frequency the oscillator must reach, $f_0$ in this design                       |
| $f_{sw,max,op}$                                 | the highest switching frequency the converter actually runs at (the full-bridge edge at the line peak); the oscillator span is sized to it                        |
| $T_{sw}, T_r$                                   | switching period $1/f_{sw}$ , and the resonant period $1/f_r$                                                                                                     |
| $\lambda, m$                                    | $L_r/L_m$ , and $(L_r+L_m)/L_r = 1 + 1/\lambda$                                                                                                                   |
| $\lambda_{act}, \lambda_{req}$                  | the $\lambda$ of the selected parts, and the $\lambda$ the design asked for                                                                                       |
| $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_{TD}, \lambda_3$ | the four candidate $\lambda$ : minimum gain, the same with the frequency ceiling, the dead-time condition, and the minimum-frequency condition; the largest binds |
| $Q, Q_{pk}, Q_{ZVS}$                            | quality factor $Z_0/R_{ac}$ ; its value at the line peak; the cap the ZVS condition puts on it                                                                    |
| $R_{ac}$                                        | the rectifier and load as one resistance at the fundamental                                                                                                       |
| $v_{RI}, v_{RI}^F, i_{RI}$                      | the square voltage at the rectifier input, referred to the primary; its fundamental; and the sine current the tank delivers into the rectifier                    |

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| Symbol                                     | Meaning                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $M$                                        | tank gain, $n V_{o,eff}$ over the drive                                                                                            |
| $M_{req}, M_{pk}$                          | the gain the operating point demands, and its value at the line peak                                                               |
| $M_{min}, M_{max}$                         | in the classic LLC procedure: the gain range the tank must cover, from the input range and the output tolerance                    |
| $M_{low}, M_{high}$                        | the required gain at the low and the high equivalent corner                                                                        |
| $M_{OL}, M_{\infty}$                       | the gain curve at no load ( $Q = 0$ , output open), and the floor $1/(1+\lambda)$ it flattens onto                                 |
| $M_Z$                                      | the gain on the capacitive/inductive boundary ( $\arg Z_{in} = 0$ ), traced as $Q$ varies; a little to the right of the gain peaks |
| $x, u, q$                                  | the substitutions that turn the gain equation into a cubic: $1/f_n^2$ , $\sin^2\theta$ , and $Q_{pk}^2 u^2$                        |
| $d$                                        | conduction ratio $f_{sw}/f_r$ of the secondary, 1 above resonance                                                                  |
| $n, n_T$                                   | equivalent-model turns ratio, and the physical (wound) turns ratio                                                                 |
| $N_{rect}$                                 | devices in the secondary conduction path: 1 centre tap, 2 full bridge                                                              |
| $V_{drive}$                                | the amplitude the bridge applies to the tank: the rectified mains in full bridge, half of it in half bridge                        |
| $V_{refl}$                                 | reflected output voltage $n V_{o,eff}$                                                                                             |
| $V_{o,eff}$                                | $V_{out} + N_{rect} V_f$                                                                                                           |
| $V_f$                                      | forward drop of one secondary rectifier                                                                                            |
| <b>The mains, and power factor</b>         |                                                                                                                                    |
| $\theta$                                   | line phase angle                                                                                                                   |
| $f_l, f_{l,min}, \omega_l$                 | line frequency, its lowest specified value, and $2\pi f_l$                                                                         |
| $v_{ac}, V_{ac}, I_{ac}$                   | the instantaneous mains voltage, and the rms voltage and current drawn                                                             |
| $I_{1,rms}$                                | the rms of the input current's fundamental alone                                                                                   |
| $p_{in}(t), P$                             | instantaneous and average input power                                                                                              |
| $v_{in}(\theta), i_{in}(\theta)$           | the rectified mains voltage and the current drawn from it, over the line half cycle                                                |
| PF, THD                                    | power factor, and total harmonic distortion of the input current                                                                   |
| $\phi_1, D$                                | displacement angle of the fundamental, and the distortion factor $I_{1,rms}/I_{ac}$                                                |
| $D_3$                                      | third harmonic on the input current, as a fraction of the fundamental                                                              |
| $V_{in}, V_{pk}$                           | the rail the bridge works from, and the peak of the mains                                                                          |
| $V_{bus}$                                  | the regulated dc bus between the two stages of a two-stage converter                                                               |
| $V_{ac,eq}, V_{ac,eq,low}, V_{ac,eq,high}$ | equivalent input voltage the tank sees after morphing, and its value at the two morphing thresholds                                |
| $V_{eq,min}, V_{eq,max}$                   | the lowest equivalent input (the HB edge) and the mains maximum, as the ST tool's margin factor $\Gamma_v$ uses them               |
| <b>Power and loss</b>                      |                                                                                                                                    |

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| Symbol                                           | Meaning                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $P_{in}, P_{out}$                                | input power, output power                                                                                                                 |
| $P_{LLC}, P_{EMI}, P_{BR}$                       | the three budgeted losses: the LLC stage, the EMI filter, the input bridge                                                                |
| $P_{in,LLC}$                                     | power into the tank, $P_{out}/\eta_{HB}$                                                                                                  |
| $\eta_{HB}$                                      | assumed efficiency of the LLC stage                                                                                                       |
| $P_{mos,dc}$                                     | conduction loss of the primary device that stands on in half-bridge morphing                                                              |
| $P_{SR}, P_{SR,leg}$                             | secondary rectifier loss, per device and per rectifier leg                                                                                |
| $P_{CS}$                                         | dissipation in the current-sense resistors                                                                                                |
| $P_{budget}$                                     | the loss a device position is allowed, before parts are chosen                                                                            |
| $E, C, V, V_{min}$                               | the energy a capacitance $C$ gives up between two voltages, in the hold-up expression                                                     |
| <b>Currents and times of one switching cycle</b> |                                                                                                                                           |
| $i_{Lr}, I_{Lr,pk}$                              | tank current, and its peak: reflected load plus magnetising                                                                               |
| $i_{trafo}, I_{trafo,pk}$                        | the reflected load current alone, and its peak                                                                                            |
| $i_{Lm}, I_{Lm,pk}$                              | magnetising current of the tank model, and its peak                                                                                       |
| $i_{\mu}, i_{\mu,pk}$                            | magnetising current of the physical transformer, and its peak                                                                             |
| $i_p, i_s$                                       | the instantaneous primary and secondary winding currents                                                                                  |
| $I_{sec,pk}$                                     | peak secondary current per rectifier leg                                                                                                  |
| $I_{pri,rms}$                                    | primary rms over the worst switching cycle                                                                                                |
| $I_{lc}, I_{pri}, I_{rect}$                      | a line-cycle rms: the rms of each switching period, averaged in $I^2$ over the line half cycle; for the primary and for one rectifier leg |
| $I_{Cout}, I_{out}$                              | ripple current in the output bank, and the load current                                                                                   |
| $t_D, T_{ZC}, T_{ZC,min}$                        | bridge dead time; the time the tank current takes to reach zero after the gates turn off, and its smallest value over the operating space |
| $T_T$                                            | the swing time: how long the bridge node takes to cross the rail in the dead time                                                         |
| $v_d, v_d^F, V_{ds}$                             | bridge mid-point voltage, its fundamental, and a device's drain-source voltage                                                            |
| $v_A, v_B$                                       | the two bridge mid-points A and B against 0; $v_d = v_A - v_B$                                                                            |
| $i_{S1}$                                         | drain current of S1, positive drain to source                                                                                             |
| $S_1, S_2, S_3, S_4, D_1, D_2$                   | the four bridge switches, and the two secondary rectifiers                                                                                |
| $i_{D1}, i_{D2}, i_D$                            | the current in each secondary rectifier, forward; $i_D$ is either of them                                                                 |
| <b>The transformer and its core</b>              |                                                                                                                                           |
| $B(t), B_{pk}, B_{max}$                          | flux density, its peak, and the ceiling the design keeps under                                                                            |
| $N$                                              | turns of the winding a voltage is applied to, in Faraday's law                                                                            |
| $A_e, A_{min}$                                   | core effective area, and its narrowest section                                                                                            |
| $A_N$                                            | winding window area of the coil former                                                                                                    |

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| Symbol                             | Meaning                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $A_L, g, \mu_0$                    | inductance factor of the gapped core, the total centre-leg gap, and the permeability of free space                                                                                             |
| $N_p, N_s, N_x$                    | primary turns, secondary turns per winding, number of units in the assembly                                                                                                                    |
| $N_{s1}, N_{s2}$                   | the upper and lower halves of the centre-tapped secondary (NS2 and NS3 in the design example)                                                                                                  |
| $i_{NS}, i_{NS2}, i_{NS3}, V_{NS}$ | in the design example: the current of a secondary winding, named by its winding, and the voltage across one                                                                                    |
| $N_{aux}, n_{aux}/n_{sec}$         | auxiliary winding turns, and its turns ratio to one secondary                                                                                                                                  |
| $L_{open}, L_{short}$              | inductance across the primary with every other winding open; and with every secondary shorted and the auxiliary open                                                                           |
| $I_{dc}$                           | the dc current the DC-overlap test overlaps on the LCR signal                                                                                                                                  |
| $I_{p,pk}, L_p$                    | in the flyback comparison only: the primary peak current and the primary inductance of a flyback                                                                                               |
| $\Phi, \Phi_p, \Phi_s$             | in the flyback comparison: the core flux, and the flux the primary and the secondary ampere-turns would set up alone                                                                           |
| $B_s$                              | saturation flux density of the core material, from the material data at temperature                                                                                                            |
| $L_\mu, L_{L1}, L_{L2}$            | physical magnetising inductance and the two leakage inductances                                                                                                                                |
| $L_1, L_2$                         | the open-circuit inductance measured at the primary and at one secondary                                                                                                                       |
| $L, \Delta L$                      | an inductance and the change of it a tolerance allows                                                                                                                                          |
| $I_{eq}, I_{sat}$                  | open-circuit current that reproduces the operating flux; the DC-overlap test current                                                                                                           |
| <b>The copper</b>                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| $A_{cu}, J, I_{rms}$               | copper cross-section one winding needs, the current density it is sized to, and the rms current of that winding; $I_{rms}(\theta)$ is its rms over one switching period at line phase $\theta$ |
| $N_w, A_{cu,w}$                    | turns and copper area of winding w, in the sum over all the windings                                                                                                                           |
| $k_u$                              | window utilisation: the share of $A_N$ that ends up copper                                                                                                                                     |
| $\delta, \rho, f$                  | skin depth, the resistivity of copper at the working temperature, and the frequency the depth is evaluated at                                                                                  |
| $d_s, a_s, n_s$                    | Litz strand diameter, the copper cross-section of one strand, and the number of strands a winding needs                                                                                        |
| $d_{litz}, k_{litz}$               | outside diameter of the served bundle, and the share of that area which is copper                                                                                                              |
| $t_f, w_f, w_{f,max}, n_f$         | foil thickness, the width one turn needs, the widest single strip assumed, and the number of strips in parallel                                                                                |
| <b>Semiconductors</b>              |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| $R_{DS(on)}, R_{DS(on),25}, k_T$   | on-resistance, its 25 °C headline value, and the multiplier from 25 °C to $T_{j,max}$                                                                                                          |
| $T_j, T_{j,max}, T_a$              | junction temperature, its rating, and ambient temperature                                                                                                                                      |
| $C_{oss}, C_{o(tr)}, Q_{oss}$      | the small-signal and the time-related output capacitance of a MOSFET, and the charge the time-related one stands for                                                                           |

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| Symbol                                        | Meaning                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The controller and its network</b>         |                                                                                                                                                           |
| $V_{FB}, V_{FB}$                              | feedback voltage above its 0.5 V offset at rated power, and its small-signal part                                                                         |
| $V_{OS}, K_{HV}, K_M, K_{FF}$                 | the offset and the three internal gains of the feedback law, quoted from the datasheet block diagram                                                      |
| $K_{pwr}$                                     | gain of the power law, $V_{FB} = K_{pwr} R_{CS} P_{in,LLC}$                                                                                               |
| $R_{CS}, R_{CS,max1}, R_{CS,max2}$            | current-sense resistor, and the two conditions that bound it: the maximum-power law and the OCP1 trip                                                     |
| $I_{OCP1}, I_{OCP2}$                          | over-current thresholds set by $R_{CS}$                                                                                                                   |
| $C_T, R_T$                                    | oscillator timing capacitor and resistor                                                                                                                  |
| $C_{T,min}, C_{T,max}, R_{T,ceil}, R_{T,max}$ | the window those two have to be chosen inside                                                                                                             |
| $V_{ref}, I_{EA}, I_{EA,max}$                 | the oscillator reference, the error-amplifier current that is the only control input, and its maximum                                                     |
| $f_{Min}, f_{Max}, f_{SU}$                    | oscillator floor, ceiling and start-up frequency set by $R_T, C_T$ and $T_{idle}$                                                                         |
| $T_{idle}$                                    | oscillator idle time                                                                                                                                      |
| $R_{BM}, r_{BM}, V_{BM,eq}, P_{in,BM}$        | burst-mode resistor, the fraction of the rated input power $P_{in}$ burst starts at, the equivalent FB threshold, and the input power that corresponds to |
| $R_{CFG}, R_{CFG,max}$                        | configuration resistor, and the largest value the lowest input voltage allows                                                                             |
| $V_{BO}, V_{BO,pk}, V_{BO,rms}$               | brown-out threshold, as a mains peak and as an rms voltage                                                                                                |
| $R_{ZCD,H}, R_{ZCD,L}, I_{bias}$              | the ZCD divider, and the current it is designed to draw                                                                                                   |
| $V_{OVP1}, V_{OVP2}, V_{OVP1,out}$            | the two over-voltage thresholds, and the output voltage OVP1 is aimed at                                                                                  |
| $V_{CC}, V_{CCon}, V_{CCoff}$                 | the IC supply, and the two thresholds of its under-voltage lockout                                                                                        |
| <b>The voltage loop</b>                       |                                                                                                                                                           |
| $G_{plant}(s), G_{EA}(s), T(s)$               | plant $v_{out}/v_{FB}$ , compensator $-v_{FB}/v_{out}$ (the feedback sign taken out), and loop gain $T = \frac{G_{plant} G_{EA}}$                         |
| $G_o, EA_o$                                   | gain constant of the plant integrator and of the compensator, in rad/s                                                                                    |
| $\omega_z, \omega_p, \omega_{px}, \omega_c$   | compensator zero, pole, high-frequency pole, and the crossover, in rad/s                                                                                  |
| $f_z, f_p, f_{px}, f_{180}$                   | the same zero and poles in hertz, and the frequency where $\arg T = -180^\circ$                                                                           |
| $f_c, \Phi_M, GM$                             | loop crossover frequency, phase margin, gain margin                                                                                                       |
| $f_{cto}$                                     | where the bare plant integrator would cross 0 dB, $G_o/2\pi$                                                                                              |
| $f_{pHF}, f_{MB}$                             | the high-frequency pole chosen for $C_{fx}$ , and the centre frequency the K-factor method places the zero and the pole around                            |
| $K_v, \Gamma_v, \alpha_v$                     | K factor of the Type II compensator, and the input-voltage margin factor and weighting constant it is built from                                          |
| $Z_f$                                         | feedback impedance of the compensator, $C_{F0}$ in parallel with $R_F + C_F$                                                                              |
| $v_K$                                         | small-signal voltage at the TL431 cathode                                                                                                                 |

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| Symbol                                   | Meaning                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $R_i, R_o$                               | output divider of the compensator                                                                                                                |
| $C_{Fo}, C_F, R_F, C_{fx}$               | compensator parts: the two capacitors and the resistor of the TL431 network, and the FB-pin capacitor                                            |
| $C_{opto}, C_{ser}$                      | the optocoupler's own output capacitance, and $C_F + C_{Fo}$ in series                                                                           |
| $R_B, R_{B,max}, R_{B,min}, R_P, R_{FB}$ | optocoupler LED resistor and the window it has to sit in, the TL431 bias resistor, and the pull-up inside the FB pin                             |
| $CTR, CTR_s, CTR_m, i_{LED}$             | optocoupler current transfer ratio, its value at the steady-state and at the maximum LED current, and the LED current itself                     |
| $i_{FB}$                                 | small-signal current the optocoupler sinks from the FB pin, $CTR i_{LED}$                                                                        |
| $I_{FB,steady}, I_{FB,max}, I_{min}$     | FB-pin current at steady state and at maximum, and the least current the TL431 needs to stay in regulation                                       |
| $V_R, V_Z, V_{Fo}$                       | TL431 reference, the regulated rail that feeds the LED, and the LED forward drop                                                                 |
| $V_{out}, i_{out}, V_C$                  | small-signal output voltage and the current the converter delivers into the bank; the voltage on a capacitor in a waveform                       |
| $\Delta V_{loop}, \Delta V_{FB}$         | $2f_l$ output ripple seen by the loop, and the ripple it leaves on the FB pin                                                                    |
| <b>The output, and hold-up</b>           |                                                                                                                                                  |
| $C_{out}, C_{in}$                        | output capacitor bank, input film capacitor                                                                                                      |
| $V_{out}, I_{out}, R_L$                  | output voltage and load current; the load as a resistance                                                                                        |
| $\Delta v, \Delta v_{pp}$                | allowed and achieved $2f_l$ output ripple                                                                                                        |
| $T_{hold}, t_{hold}, V_{o,min}$          | required and achieved hold-up time, and the lowest output allowed at its end                                                                     |
| ESR                                      | equivalent series resistance of the bank, taken at the switching frequency                                                                       |
| <b>Verification margins</b>              |                                                                                                                                                  |
| $k, X, X_{act}, X_{req}$                 | a verification margin $X_{act}/X_{req}$ , where X is whatever quantity the row is about; every k in this note is $\geq 1$ when the design passes |
| $k_{floor}, k_{ceil}$                    | how far $f_{Min}$ clears $f_o$ , and how far $f_{Max}$ clears the highest operating frequency                                                    |
| $k_{Ploss}$                              | the loss budget of a device position over the loss computed for it                                                                               |
| $w_k, \theta_k$                          | the weights and the nodes of the five-point Simpson rule the line-cycle rms values are integrated with                                           |

**Table 29: Symbols.**

## 9 References

- STMicroelectronics, *L6790A LLC-PFC controller*, preliminary datasheet, 30 April 2026. **Draft.**
- STMicroelectronics, *EVL6790\_670W* evaluation board schematics.
- Infineon Technologies, *LLC Converter Design Note*, AN 2013-03, V1.0, March 2013.
- Infineon Technologies, *Resonant LLC converter: operation and design*, AN 2012-09, V1.0, September 2012.
- onsemi (formerly Fairchild), *Half-bridge LLC resonant converter design using FSFR-series Fairchild power switch*, AN-4151.

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- Monolithic Power Systems, *Understanding LLC operation*, part 2.
- Toshiba Electronic Devices & Storage, *Power factor correction (PFC) circuits*, application note.
- Toshiba Electronic Devices & Storage, *Resonant circuits and soft switching*, application note, 12 November 2019.
- ROHM Semiconductor, TechWeb, *LLC operating regions* (region framing of Figure 12).
- W. Wenbo et al., *A single-stage 1.65 kW ac-dc LLC converter*, IEEE ECCE.
- onsemi, *The TL431 in the control of switching power supplies*, TND381-D (compensator design with a TL431 and an optocoupler).

## 10 Errata and open items

Everything here is worked around rather than solved, and most of it only the released datasheet or a prototype can close. Re-read it before a production release.

### 10.1 Datasheet: the draft is not self-consistent

| Item                            | What the draft says                                                                                                                                                   | What is used here, and why                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Oscillator idle time $T_{idle}$ | Section 5.3.2 implies 700 ns in the frequency expressions and 350 ns in the $C_{T,max}$ expression; Table 2 (recommended operating range) back-solves to about 250 ns | <b>250 ns.</b> The two clamps bracket the operating range at 250 ns and stop doing so at 700 ns, so this is a measurement, not a rounding |
| Brown-out expression            | $V_{BO} = \min(60\text{ V}, R_{CFG} \cdot 4\text{ V/k}\Omega)$ — read literally this is 60 V for every resistor, which contradicts the configuration table            | Read as $R_{CFG} \cdot 4\text{ V/k}\Omega$ with 15 k $\Omega$ as the floor. That is the only reading consistent with the table            |
| Brown-out units                 | the threshold is a <i>peak</i> voltage; board notes and design tools quote rms                                                                                        | Converted explicitly wherever it is compared ( $\sqrt{2} = 1.414$ )                                                                       |
| Thermal resistance              | TBD                                                                                                                                                                   | No junction temperature can be predicted from the datasheet alone; the loss budget is checked against measured rise instead               |
| ZCD absolute maximum            | lower limit given as TBD                                                                                                                                              | The divider is sized from the OVP thresholds only                                                                                         |
| Driver naming in Section 5.3.1  | LOUT1 and LOUT2 are transposed in one sentence against the block diagram and the configuration table                                                                  | The block diagram and the table are taken as correct: LOUT2 is the pin that is strapped and held high in half bridge                      |

**Table 30: Points where the draft datasheet contradicts itself or leaves a value open. Every one of them must be re-checked against the released document.**

### 10.2 Traps in the obvious way of building a design sheet

Places where the obvious way to set up a design sheet gives a plausible wrong number that nothing flags.

| Where                  | The trap                                                                        | Consequence if missed                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Equivalent input range | taking the maximum from the ac maximum instead of the full-bridge morphing edge | The frequency corner is never evaluated. Here it is the difference between 264 and 332.3 Vac equivalent, and it also sets $\lambda$ |

# Single-Stage PFC LLC Converter Design

| Where                                     | The trap                                                                                    | Consequence if missed                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\lambda$ from the minimum-gain condition | the same corner again, one step earlier                                                     | The required $\lambda$ comes out far too small — a factor of over a hundred in one case — and $L_m$ far too large                                |
| Line-cycle rms currents                   | evaluating one phase, usually $\theta = \pi/4$ , and calling it the line-cycle value        | The output bank ripple current and the rectifier loss are both understated. A Simpson rule over the half cycle costs nothing and is exact enough |
| Secondary rms above resonance             | squaring a full half sine when the current is truncated                                     | Up to 8 % at the high corner. Below resonance the factor is exactly 1, which is why it can sit unnoticed for a long time                         |
| Primary device rating                     | rating on the reflected load current $I_{trafo,pk}$                                         | About 12 % under-rated — the switch carries the <i>composite</i> tank current                                                                    |
| Loss and thermal resistance               | computing loss from the 25 °C $R_{DS(on)}$ and then asking for a heatsink that holds 125 °C | The required thermal resistance comes out only about half as demanding as it really is                                                           |
| ZVS check                                 | the closed-form shortcut, at the design Q and with the design $\lambda$                     | An error of tens of per cent whose sign nothing fixes; on this tank 36 % conservative. Optimistic is the dangerous direction                     |
| Selected versus calculated                | a check that reads the calculated value while the board carries the selected one            | Every downstream margin is reported for a design that was not built                                                                              |

**Table 31: Traps that produce a plausible wrong number.**

## 10.3 Constants used here without a derivation

- The  **$\pi^2/8$**  in the dead-time form of the  $\lambda$  condition. It behaves like a correction for the fundamental content of a square wave, but no source states it. It is indicative; the binding check is the ZVS sweep.
- The **exponent 5** in the closed-form ZVS shortcut. This is a fitted number, and it is the main reason the shortcut errs unpredictably near the boundary.
- The **0.744** in the input-voltage margin factor of the compensator design. It scales the crossover target and nothing downstream is sensitive to it at the percent level.
- The  **$K_V$  expression** (Equation 49) is the ST tool's as written. With  $\alpha_v = 1$  it gives 2.675 for a 50° target, not Venable's  $\tan(45^\circ + \Phi_M/2) = 2.748$ ; the tool does not say what  $\alpha_v$  weights. The phase margin is therefore taken from the fitted parts (Equation 55), not from  $K_V$ .
- The **16.8  $\Omega \cdot W$**  maximum-power constant follows from the feedback span and the multiplier gain (2.8 V / 0.167); it is listed because those gains are draft values.

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## 10.4 Open items in this design

| Item                             | State                                                                                                      | What closes it                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $T_{idle}$                       | three values, 250, 350 and 700 ns                                                                          | Measure $f_{sw}(\theta)$ on the first board                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Primary conduction loss          | 0.311 against the budget — <b>not met, and accepted</b>                                                    | No single 600 V device meets a 3 W budget in the standing position. Whether it needs a heatsink is a thermal measurement, not a calculation                                                                     |
| Secondary loss budget            | 1.063 — essentially exhausted                                                                              | One more device in parallel per leg recovers it; the decision waits on the measured temperature                                                                                                                 |
| Transformer inductance tolerance | the tank tolerates a 4.0 % fall in open-circuit inductance and the usual specification asks for $\pm 10$ % | $R_T$ stays at 11 k $\Omega$ until the first board. A lower $R_T$ covers $\pm 10$ % but widens the zero-crossing dead zone; choose after measuring $f_{sw}(\theta)$ and the input-current THD at 90 and 230 Vac |
| Output bank volume and height    | 75.2 mF, 160 parts                                                                                         | A mechanical question, not an electrical one, and it can send the whole architecture back to the output voltage                                                                                                 |
| Standby power                    | burst entry assumed at 75 W                                                                                | Measure, then trade $R_{BM}$ against the feedback ripple                                                                                                                                                        |
| Efficiency assumption            | $\eta_{HB} = 98$ % assumed                                                                                 | Optimistic. Taking 95 % instead moves $R_{CS}$ and $R_{ac}$ by about 3 %, so nothing downstream is sensitive — but it should be replaced by a measurement                                                       |

Table 32: What is not settled, and what would settle it.

**Every cross-check here is a consistency check, not a correctness check.** Three implementations agreeing means they implement the same equations, not that the equations describe the hardware. The first prototype is the correctness check.